

CBC 22201/13/0006/2627



Committed to
Nari Shakti Vandan

#NariShaktiVandan

We feel safe



13.9+ lakh women received assistance at One Stop Centres

Safety, now just a call away



99+ lakh women received support through the 181 helpline

I feel safe at my workplace



Safe workplaces across 1.6+ lakh institutions with SHE-Box



Government of India

IRAN CAPS HORMUZ TRANSIT AT 15 SHIPS DAILY | OVER 200 KILLED IN LEBANON

GOVT ASSURES SUPPLY STABILITY

Peace on paper, war on ground: Truce falters with Israeli bloodshed in Beirut

Energy security in focus as India activates Gulf diplomacy

CEASEFIRE EXPOSES GAPS IN SCOPE, ENFORCEMENT AND INTENT

Faishankar's UAE visit, Puri's Qatar trip signal India's strategic push

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: A tentative ceasefire in the Iran war staggered Thursday under the weight of Israel's bombardment of Beirut, Tehran's continued chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz, and uncertainty over whether talks expected on Saturday can find common ground.

The fragile two-week ceasefire between the US and Iran was meant to pause escalation and open a narrow diplomatic window. Instead, it has exposed deep ambiguities over scope, enforcement and intent. Conflicting claims over Lebanon, uncertainty surrounding the Strait of Hormuz and continued military actions have all undermined confidence in the agreement. As delegations prepare to meet in Islamabad, the gap between what was agreed and what is unfolding on the ground is widening.

Iran and the US — which both declared victory after Tuesday night's ceasefire announcement — appeared to apply pressure.

President Donald Trump,



People march while taking part in a protest against the US-Israeli war with Iran, and against conflict in Lebanon

HEZBOLLAH CHIEF'S NEPHEW ALI YUSUF HARSHI KILLED IN ISRAELI STRIKES ON BEIRUT

meanwhile, warned that US forces would hit Iran harder than before if it did not fulfill the agreement.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian also issued a sharp

warning over Israel's military actions in Lebanon, saying Tehran remains ready to respond and that continued strikes risk derailing ongoing diplomatic efforts.

"Our hands remain on the trigger," Pezeshkian said, as he condemned Israel's operations as a breach of the ceasefire framework and cautioned that such actions could under-

KEY POINTS

- » 'Hands remain on trigger': Iranian President Pezeshkian warns Israel
- » Trump warns harsher US strikes if Iran breaches deal
- » Tehran signals ceasefire conditional, not permanent reset
- » Iran accuses Israel of violating ceasefire terms
- » Netanyahu and Trump deny any violation occurred
- » Reports suggest Iran deployed sea mines in Hormuz
- » Oil prices surge; Brent near \$98, up 35%
- » Around 230 oil tankers await Hormuz clearance
- » Ship passage requires Iranian approval and strict protocol

Israel's war crimes: The Beirut story

BEIRUT: Israeli airstrikes on Lebanon, particularly in Beirut, have drawn sharp international scrutiny, with allegations of war crimes intensifying as the civilian toll rises. Alongside mass casualties, Israel has also carried out targeted killings of senior Hezbollah figures, which it cites as justification for its operations.

The large-scale bombardment on April 8 saw Israeli forces strike more than 100 locations across Beirut, southern Lebanon and the Bekaa Valley within minutes, leaving at least 250 people dead and over 1,100 injured, according to Lebanese authorities.

Continued on P4

In today's paper

...

CITY

HEAT BACK ON AFTER RAINY PAUSE

3

NATION

ASSAM: 30 INJURED IN VIOLENCE

5

EDIT

CLICK, DELIVER, REPEAT

7

INTERNATIONAL

'CHINA DINT SUPPORT IRAN'

8

BUSINESS

SENSEX TANKS 931 POINTS

10

SPORT

LSG BEAT KKR IN IPL

12

Assam, Puducherry log record turnout; Kerala surpasses 2021 polling percentage

MPOST BUREAU

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM/GUWAHATI: Assam recorded a voter turnout of 85.64 per cent while Kerala crossed 78 per cent in Assembly elections held on Thursday, according to the Election Commission's latest figures, reflecting strong public participation as incumbent governments in both states seek a third consecutive term.

In Puducherry, polling reached a historic high of 89.87 per cent across its 30 constituencies, the highest since elections began in the Union Territory in 1964 after its merger with India. The coastal region, located about 165 km from Chennai, witnessed enthusiastic participation as voters turned out in large numbers.

In Assam, where 722 candidates are contesting across 126 constituencies, over 2.5 crore voters were eligible to vote. The turnout surpassed the 82.04 per cent recorded in the



A woman shows her ink-marked finger after casting a vote in the by-election to the Dharmanagar Assembly constituency, in North Tripura district

2021 Assembly elections. Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma described the participation as "historic", saying the outcome of the election was already visible "in the hope, pride, and happiness on the faces of our people".

Congress leader Gaurav Gogoi, also in the fray, said the high turnout reflected a desire for change. "It is for a new and greater Assam," he said, calling for

Continued on P4

ROBOTIC CARE REACHES FRONTLINES

Indigenous 'Vimana', 'Operion' to enable life-saving battlefield surgeries

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare on Thursday introduced a set of indigenous robotic technologies aimed at strengthening emergency medical response for injured security personnel, particularly in combat zones. The systems, unveiled at the third SMRSC Global Robotic Surgery Conference at Bharat Mandapam, are designed to deliver life-saving surgical care in challenging and time-sensitive conditions.

Launched by Union Minister of State for Health Pratap Rao Jadhav, the initiatives include Project Vimana and Project Operion, both developed to address gaps in critical care delivery during emergencies. The minister said the innovations signal India's growing capabilities in advanced medical technologies



HOW IT WORKS

» Drone delivers Project Vimana to injured soldier

- » Medics quickly deploy the robotic unit
- » Remote surgeon connects via command centre
- » Surgeon controls robotic arms in real time
- » Life-saving procedures performed immediately
- » Project Operion enables mobile operating setup if needed
- » Patient stabilised, then evacuated or treated further

and reflect progress in domestic research and development.

Project Vimana, the central feature of the launch, focuses on reducing delays between injury and treatment, often referred to as the "golden hour." Developed by SS Innovations International, the

system is transported to forward areas using a heavy-lift autonomous drone. Once deployed, surgeons stationed at a remote command centre can conduct procedures using robotic controls.

According to Dr Sudhir Srivastava, founder,

Continued on P4

DEMANDS ED PROBE

TMC alleges Rs 1,000 cr poll deal between Humayun Kabir and BJP

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: A fresh political controversy erupted on Thursday after Trinamool Congress (TMC) released a purported sting video alleging that a Rs 1,000 crore election deal had taken place between Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP) founder Humayun Kabir and several top BJP leaders, including Suwendu Adhikari.

The ruling party also alleged that the video captured conversations where Kabir took the name of the Prime Minister's Office (PMO). TMC has therefore alleged that somebody from the PMO might have been involved in the scam. It demanded a thorough probe by the Enforcement Directorate (ED), describing the matter as "extremely serious". TMC claimed it was a conspiracy to

THE ALLEGATIONS

- » TMC released a purported sting video claiming AJUP founder Humayun Kabir struck a Rs 1,000 crore election deal with BJP leaders, including Suwendu Adhikari, to influence post-election power-sharing in West Bengal
- » Humayun Kabir claimed the video was AI-generated by TMC
- » The video allegedly mentions the Prime Minister's Office, prompting TMC to suggest possible involvement from a PMO official and demand an ED investigation
- » The video shows a man resembling Kabir discussing advance payment of Rs 200 crore, aiming to secure 70-80 Assembly seats for his party and 100-120 for BJP post-elections
- » Senior TMC leaders called the video a "major revelation" and a potential conspiracy to topple Mamata Banerjee's government

topple the Mamata Banerjee government.

The video shared by TMC showed a man resembling Kabir discussing a deal worth Rs 1,000 crore, including mention of an advance payment of Rs 200 crore. He was found

demanding Rs 1,000 crore from the BJP for the Bengal Assembly polls in lieu of supporting post-elections.

During a Press conference, senior TMC leaders Firhad Hakim, Aroop Biswas and Kunal Ghosh

Continued on P4

UMBRELLAS OUT



People take a stroll during rainfall, in Shimla, Himachal Pradesh, on Thursday

CBSE asks schools to start third language in 7 days

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) has directed all affiliated schools to introduce a third language in Class 6 from the 2026-27 academic session, calling the move "urgent and mandatory" in a circular issued on April 9. Schools have been given a seven-day deadline to comply.

In its notice, the board said some institutions had already begun implementing the third language, referred to as R3, and instructed the rest to act immediately. "All remaining schools are hereby directed to ensure compliance within 7 days from the date of issuance of this circular," CBSE stated.

Schools have been asked to begin teaching the additional language without delay, even if official textbooks are not yet available. "The textbooks for R3 will be made available shortly. However, schools are directed to start teaching R3 from Class 6 immediately, using locally available books or materials," the circular said.

The board also required schools to formally declare the third language they intend to offer and update the information on the OASIS portal. Implementation will be monitored by CBSE's regional offices.

CBSE clarified that early adoption will influence future subject options. "Only those R3 languages which are introduced in Class 6 by a school will be available as options in Classes 9 and 10 for that school," the notice said.

The directive follows recommendations from the National Curriculum Framework for School Education 2023, which promotes multilingual learning through a three-language model. Under this framework, students study a regional

Continued on P4

TWO APPREHENDED; CCTV FOOTAGE BEING SCANNED

Man chased, brutally stabbed in public toilet in Ashok Vihar

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: An alleged road rage incident took a fatal turn when a 27-year-old factory worker was chased down by assailants and stabbed multiple times inside a public toilet in northwest Delhi's Ashok Vihar area, police said on Thursday.

According to police, the incident took place on Wednesday night, when witnesses saw the victim, Santosh Kumar, running into a public toilet in a desperate bid to save his life, with his attackers hot on his heels.

"A PCR call was received at 6:23 pm on April 8 regarding a man being stabbed inside the compound of a Sulabh Sauchalaya located at the fish market in Wazirpur Industrial Area," a senior police officer said.

A police team rushed to the spot and found the victim



lying in a pool of blood inside the toilet premises. The victim, originally from Nepal, was residing in Macchi Market area, the official said.

Preliminary inquiry revealed that the incident stemmed from an altercation between the victim and a motorcycle rider. The verbal

TAKEAWAYS

- » A PCR call was received at 6:23 pm regarding a man being stabbed inside the compound of a Sulabh Sauchalaya located in Wazirpur Industrial Area: Police
- » A police team rushed to the spot and found the victim, originally from Nepal, lying in a pool of blood inside the toilet

spat soon escalated into a physical scuffle, during which the accused, along with an associate, allegedly attacked Santosh with a knife.

Police sources said in a desperate attempt to save himself, the injured victim ran towards the nearby public toilet and tried to latch the door from

inside. Eyewitness accounts suggest he tried to take refuge inside the public toilet and shut the door to prevent his attackers from entering. However, he was chased down, overpowered, and stabbed multiple times.

Santosh collapsed on the spot, where he later succumbed to his injuries, police said.

A case under sections 103(1) (murder) and 3(5) (common intentions) was registered at Ashok Vihar police station and an investigation was taken up.

During the probe, police arrested one accused identified as Tanish (19), a resident of CSA Colony in Macchi Market area, and apprehended a juvenile allegedly involved in the incident.

Police said the motorcycle used by the accused, which they had abandoned while fleeing after the attack, was recovered near the crime scene.

Family members expressed shock after 27-year-old Santosh was stabbed twice, allegedly in a road rage attack. His uncle said he may have fled into a toilet. Police are scanning CCTV and tracking suspects now.

877-page chargesheet filed in Janakpuri pit death case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has filed an 877-page chargesheet in the Janakpuri pit death case, naming three accused and detailing alleged lapses linked to the execution of a construction project, an official said on Thursday.

The chargesheet was submitted before a court on April 7, police said, adding that the case was registered on February 6.

According to a police statement, the accused are Himanshu Gupta (45), a suspended director of the main contractor company, KKS PUN Private Limited, Rajesh Kumar (47), a sub-contractor associated with the project and Yogesh (23), a labourer deployed at the site.

The accident took place on the night of February 5 when Kamal Dhyani, a resident of Kailashpuri, was returning home from his office in Rohini and fell into a 15-foot-deep pit dug by the Delhi Jal Board in the Janakpuri area.

A police officer said the



deceased worked at a call centre for a private bank.

The 877-page chargesheet includes detailed findings on the role and responsibilities of the accused persons, contractual arrangements, and on-site conditions and coordinations at the time of the incident.

Police said the probe examined multiple aspects, including compliance with safety norms, labour deployment, and execution practices adopted during the course of the work. Statements of witnesses, technical assessments, and documentary evidence form part of the voluminous chargesheet, the officer said.

Himanshu Gupta, as a senior functionary of the con-

tracting firm, was alleged to be responsible for overall supervision and ensuring adherence to safety protocols, while Rajesh Kumar, the sub-contractor, allegedly handled execution at the ground level.

Yogesh, a worker engaged at the site, has also been named in the incident.

A source in the police said that they investigated the matter thoroughly, and during the enquiry, it emerged that the labourer who was present there had knowledge about the entire matter, and he even informed his supervisor, who further informed Gupta about the matter. "Even knowing about the incident, no one bothered to inform the police as multiple police teams and Dhyani's family members were searching for him," the source said.

Police acted swiftly on the missing person report, traced the victim's last location, launched a search, and continue investigating possible accomplices, with more arrests likely and a supplementary chargesheet pending.

Illegal gun trade on Instagram busted in Noida

3 apprehended with 11 firearms

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: Police in Noida have busted an illegal arms trafficking racket operating through social media, arresting three persons, including a minor, from Sector 14, officials said on Wednesday.

The accused—Abhishek (21) of Sorkha village and Sameer (20) of Sector 125, both Class 10 pass-outs—along with a juvenile, were apprehended with five pistols and six country-made firearms (tamachas).

Officials said the gang had been active for nearly 18 months, using Instagram to reach buyers through coded posts and private chats.

During interrogation, the accused said pistols were sold for about Rs 45,000 and country-made weapons for around Rs 10,000. Police suspect nearly 50 firearms were supplied across Noida and adjoining areas.

Additional DCP Manisha Singh said efforts are underway to trace the wider network. An FIR has been registered under the Arms Act.

Family alleges 50-yr-old man beaten to death for opposing petrol theft

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 50-year-old man who was thrashed by neighbours for opposing petrol theft from parked bikes in outer north Delhi's Narela succumbed to his injuries days after the attack, officials said on Thursday.

The victim, identified as Rajendra, worked as a contractual employee for the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD).

According to police, the incident occurred on the night of March 30 in Bankener village while a religious event was taking place nearby, and many people had parked their vehicles outside the deceased's house. Police said after receiving a PCR call, a team rushed to the spot and admitted the injured to Raja Harishchandra Hospital.

While Rajendra's wife and children were discharged after treatment, Rajendra's condition deteriorated the next day, and he was referred to LNJP Hospital.

He succumbed to his injuries on April 8 during treatment, said the police.

Rajendra's son Rohit alleged that a man and his two sons



“A man, his 2 sons were stealing petrol from a parked bike outside their house. When the victim objected, an altercation broke out

were stealing petrol from one of the parked bikes outside their house. When his father objected, an altercation broke out, which soon turned violent; the accused allegedly threatened to set the motorcycle on fire, he said. "They attacked my husband, my sons, and me," Rajendra's wife alleged.

A senior police officer said the body has been sent for the postmortem.

"We are investigating the incident. Further action will be taken after the postmortem reports," the officer said.

Kejriwal can't seek judge's recusal for attending 'legal seminar' by Akhil Bharatiya Adhivakta Parishad: CBI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Former chief minister Arvind Kejriwal and other discharged accused in the liquor policy case cannot seek the recusal of Justice Swarna Kanta Sharma merely because she attended a "legal seminar" by the Akhil Bharatiya Adhivakta Parishad as it does not demonstrate any ideological association, the CBI has told the Delhi High Court.

In a reply filed to applications by the AAP leader and others seeking the judge's recusal from hearing the Central Bureau of Investigation's (CBI)

challenge to the trial court's discharge order, the agency highlighted that several sitting Supreme Court judges, including Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, and high court judges, have attended functions by the RSS-affiliated confederation of lawyers, and if their plea is accepted, all of them would have to recuse from hearing any case involving politically exposed persons as accused.

The CBI asserted that making "unscrupulous" and "sweeping" allegations of bias over attending legal seminars, which had no political topic, was an attempt to scan-



'He has sought Justice Sharma's recusal, citing a reasonable apprehension of lack of impartiality'

dalise and lower the court's authority and interfere with

Police busts trafficking-prostitution racket; eight women including 17-year-old rescued

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police rescued eight women, including a minor, after it busted an alleged human trafficking and prostitution racket operating in central Delhi's Sadanand Marg area, an official said on Thursday.

A raid was conducted on the night of April 8 following specific input regarding immoral activities at a building near Ajmeri Gate.

"Acting on the tip-off,

a team from Kamla Market police station, along with other units conducted a raid at the suspected premises," an officer said.

During the raid, police found multiple women and some men inside the premises. Upon verification, it was established that the location was being used for organised prostitution and trafficking. Eight women were rescued, including a 17-year-old girl who had

been trafficked from West Bengal, police said.

They said the minor disclosed that she had been brought to Delhi by a woman identified as Alia alias Pinki and later handed over to a couple who were allegedly running the illegal operation. The police said the racket trafficked women from various states including West Bengal and Assam, and even Nepal, and engaged them

in immoral activities. Two Nepal residents, Gopi Ram Parihar alias Suraj and Luma Kant Pandey, were arrested from the spot. Police said they worked as managers, handling cash transactions and coordinating activities. Officials seized Rs 1.97 lakh in cash, foreign currency, other incriminating materials, and narcotics during the operation, while efforts continue to nab absconding main operators.

MP0ST

DDA conducts demolition drive in south Delhi's Sainik Farm

NEW DELHI: In a major crackdown, DDA on Thursday carried out an anti-encroachment drive demolishing 23 farmhouses in the affluent Sainik Farm area of south Delhi, officials said.

According to the Delhi Development Authority (DDA), the action forms part of ongoing efforts to protect "ecological assets" at Tilapth Valley Biodiversity Park and Maidangarhi village.

"To secure government land and enhance the green area of the biodiversity park by removing unauthorised constructions within the park boundary. A demolition drive was successfully carried out on 9 April 2026 at Tilapth Valley Biodiversity Park and Maidangarhi village," DDA in a statement said.

Approximately 70 per cent of the affected area, about 83 acres, was recovered, and around 12 acres of land, comprising 23 farmhouses, were successfully demolished and cleared, the statement added.

"Around three acres of land, involving 7 farmhouses, could not be cleared due to active judicial stay orders issued by the High Court," the statement further said.

According to the Resident Welfare Association, the drive targeted two residential plots located on Western Avenue.

"This is a completely illegal action. They came around 5 am and carried out the drive despite us having a stay order from the court. This is a private land, and DDA does not have a clear demarcation of the Khasra number of this plot," Hardeep Singh Bhalla, president of the Western Avenue Residents' Welfare Association (WARWA), alleged.

While the government is talking about regularising unauthorised colonies, the DDA is taking action against the residents in the area, Bhalla said.

PTI

Gzb boy dies after gaming café altercation turns violent; minors apprehended: Cops

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: A 16-year-old boy was allegedly murdered by a minor following a prolonged dispute over video games at a café in the Loni area of Ghaziabad, police said on Thursday.

The victim, Faizan, a resident of Arya Nagar, was attacked around 11 am on Wednesday at a gaming café near Naipura Chowk, barely 500 metres from his house. He was stabbed twice in the abdomen during a violent altercation.

Faizan was first taken to a nearby hospital and later referred to Guru Teg Bahadur Hospital in East Delhi, where



Tensions peaked on Tuesday when a café altercation turned physical; despite intervention, the hostility lingered

he succumbed to his injuries later in the evening.

Police have apprehended two minors, aged 14 and 16, in connection with the case. Both will be produced before the Juvenile Justice Board.

Investigators said the accused and the victim had been involved in an ongoing feud for over a month, largely fuelled by repeated verbal taunts during gaming sessions

at the café. Faizan had reportedly been a regular visitor for nearly two years and frequently played Tekken 3.

The dispute is believed to have begun around six weeks ago after Faizan lost a match to the 14-year-old accused, following which both started exchanging taunts. About a month ago, the accused confronted Faizan at a roadside momo stall where he worked,

leading to a heated argument.

Tensions escalated further on Tuesday, a day before the incident, when another altercation at the café turned physical. Although bystanders intervened, the hostility persisted.

On Wednesday, the argument resumed and quickly turned violent. According to Deputy Commissioner of Police (Rural) Surendra Nath Tiwari, a 16-year-old associate allegedly fetched a knife from a nearby house and handed it to the 14-year-old, who then stabbed Faizan.

Faizan's father, a daily-wage labourer, was at work at the time and learnt of his son's death hours later.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Thursday granted six days of interim bail to 2020 Delhi riots accused Khalid Saifi to attend family functions scheduled this month.

Additional Sessions Judge Sameer Bajpai was hearing the bail application filed by Saifi, the founder of United Against Hate, seeking two weeks of interim bail to attend weddings of his niece and nephew and allowed his plea to attend the family functions.

In an order today, the court said, "The Barat and Nikah of the nephew of the applicant will take place on April 16, 2026

and the Nikah of the niece and reception of both his niece and nephew will be on April 19, 2026, and as these functions are important, the court can grant the desired relief to the applicant for attending these functions only."

Opposing the bail application, the Special Public Prosecutor Anirudh Mishra submitted that the accused has been misusing the process of court by seeking the same relief again and again on the same grounds.

"The applicant obtained interim bail previously on two occasions i.e. on October 13, 2025 and then again on January 29, 2026 on the same

grounds i.e. marriage ceremony in the family and cannot be allowed to take this liberty again and again," he contended before the court.

After considering the submissions, the court observed that some of the ceremonies mentioned in the application, such as Haldi, Bhat and Challa rituals, did not require the Saifi's presence.

However, the court held that the Nikah ceremonies and reception scheduled on April 16 and 19 were significant family events warranting limited relief. Court granted Saifi interim bail on Rs 20,000 bond, restricting movement and contact.

DIGITAL ARREST' AND INVESTMENT SCAMS EXPOSED

Mule account network linked to ₹3.3 cr cyber fraud busted

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: University of Delhi is expected to begin undergraduate admissions for the 2026 session in May alongside Common University Entrance Test. CSAS registration will likely start in June after results. Admissions will follow the CSAS process, including registration, preference submission and multiple allocation rounds, with efforts to improve efficiency and accessibility.

MP0ST

NEW DELHI: The Cyber Cell of the Delhi Police has busted a mule bank account network allegedly used to facilitate "digital arrest" cyber frauds, arresting one accused in connection with cheating transactions amounting to about Rs 3.3 crore.

The accused have been identified as Javed (49) and Saleem (49), both residents of

Sainik Farm in New Delhi.

The action was carried out under the special anti-cyber-crime drive, Operation Cy-Hawk 4.0, aimed at dismantling organised cyber fraud syndicates operating through layered banking channels.

The case came to light during scrutiny of complaints received on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal. Investigators detected a series of suspicious transactions



routed through an ICICI Bank account within the jurisdiction of the New Delhi district.

Preliminary inquiry revealed that the account was used to receive funds cheated

“The case came to light during scrutiny of complaints received on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal

from victims through "digital arrest" scams and fraudulent investment schemes.

The account was registered in the name of a company, "Saleem Javed Rule The

Rolls Since 1960," operating from Khan Market.

According to police, the business was earlier associated with the eatery brand Khan Chacha, founded by the accused persons' father, Haji Banda Hasan. In 2020, the accused launched a new brand under the present name for restaurant and catering activities.

Further verification revealed that at least 21 complaints from across the coun-

try were linked to the account, involving cheated funds estimated at Rs 3.3 crore. Investigators believe the account functioned as a mule account to receive and route proceeds of cyber fraud.

An FIR was registered on April 6 under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. Police arrested one accused, traced another, and uncovered Rs 54 lakh fraud routed via shared accounts; investigation continues.

Degrees day at GGSIPU: 26,649 graduate, CM and L-G attend

Degrees must go beyond textbook knowledge: L-G | Youth to drive developed India: CM

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: A powerful call to look beyond textbooks and embrace innovation marked the 18th convocation of Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University, where 26,649 degrees were conferred in the presence of Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, setting the tone for a new generation of nation-builders.

Addressing the gathering, the Lieutenant Governor said that a convocation is not merely the culmination of academic efforts but the beginning of a larger journey. He urged students to rise above conventional learning and adapt to a rapidly changing world. "Degrees must go beyond textbook knowledge," he said, adding that graduates today are entering an era shaped by artificial intelligence and sustainable innovation. Emphasising the need for critical thinking, he noted, "Logical thinking is the real strength in the age of AI and innovation."

Highlighting the broader



national vision, Sandhu said India's progress towards becoming a developed nation by 2047 would depend on its youth. He called upon graduates to become problem-solvers capable of addressing challenges in urban development, public health and governance, while also invoking the teachings of Guru Gobind Singh to underline the role of education in service and justice.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, in her address, described the convocation as a reflection of years of dedication by students and their families. "Today's graduates are the real drivers of 'Viksit Bharat'. Your talent and capability will take the country to new heights on the global stage," she said. She also stressed that education must serve a larger societal purpose beyond personal success.

Praising the university's strides in emerging domains, Gupta highlighted advancements in artificial intelligence, robotics, data science and design innovation. She noted the role of the Atal Incubation Centre in supporting over 170 start-ups, enabling youth to transition from job seekers to job creators. Outlining the government's focus on education, she said Delhi's education budget has

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Addressing the gathering, the Lieutenant Governor said that a convocation is not merely the culmination of academic efforts but the beginning of a larger journey
- » CM Rekha Gupta, in her address, described the convocation as a reflection of years of dedication by students and their families

increased to Rs.19,326 crore. "Our aim is not just to make schools smarter, but to ensure world-class facilities in higher education as well," she added. The ceremony was attended by Vice-Chancellor Prof. Mahesh Verma and Yogesh Singh, among others. Notably, women accounted for 70% of PhD recipients, while 76 gold medals and six memorial awards were also presented.

CAG health audit: Assembly sets July 31 deadline for ATR

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a decisive push to convert audit findings into real-world reforms, the Delhi Legislative Assembly has set a strict July 31, 2026 deadline for departments to act on key gaps flagged in the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) audit of the Capital's public health system. The move signals a shift from observation to enforcement, with a clear focus on strengthening hospitals, expanding coverage, and ensuring accountability in healthcare delivery.

The directive, issued by the Delhi Legislative Assembly Secretariat, mandates all concerned departments to implement recommendations of the Public Accounts Committee (PAC) outlined in its First Report based on the CAG audit of Public Health Infrastructure and Management of Health Services for the year ending March 31, 2022. Departments must submit a detailed Action Taken Report by July 31, reflecting the status of implementation as of June 30. The order follows the formal adoption of the report by the Assembly, underlining a more structured compliance mechanism. A formal communication has also been sent to

the Health Minister and the Secretary (Health), seeking a comprehensive and time-bound response to the findings.

Emphasising the larger objective, Speaker Vijender Gupta said, "Strengthening public hospitals, expanding insurance coverage, and investing in preventive healthcare are essential measures."

He added that "efficient delivery of health services is a cornerstone of sound governance and a vital commitment to the people of Delhi."

Highlighting the need for inclusivity, Gupta noted that policies must cater not only to residents but also to migrants seeking livelihood, education, or medical care in the city. "Affordable and quality medical services must be available irrespective of a person's state of origin," he stressed.

The PAC report undertakes a detailed review of public health infrastructure, service delivery, and management systems, calling for improved institutional frameworks, better resource allocation, and enhanced accountability. Gupta further observed that "healthcare is not merely about structures and policies, but about safeguarding the dignity and well being of every citizen."

Bomb threat triggers massive security drill

NEW DELHI: A bomb threat email sent to the Delhi Legislative Assembly on Thursday triggered a massive security drill across key government establishments and public locations, officials said. The email landed in multiple government and other inboxes at 8.14 am, including those linked to the Assembly. The letter carried the threat of possible blasts at the Assembly, Secretariat, certain schools and a metro station at different times during the day, they said. Acting swiftly, the Delhi Police, along with bomb disposal squads and dog units, launched extensive anti-sabotage checks in the Assembly premises, the Secretariat, schools and metro stations. "The email appears to be a hoax, but all standard security protocols are being followed to ensure public safety," a police officer said.

Reset: Heat back on after RAINY PAUSE



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Temperatures in Delhi began rising on Thursday after several days of rain and below-normal readings, with the maximum temperature settling at 30.8 degrees Celsius and further increase expected over the next few days amid forecasts of strong surface winds.

The India Meteorological Department has forecast a minimum temperature of around 17 degrees Celsius and a maximum of about 33 degrees Celsius for Friday, along with strong surface winds during the daytime.

Meanwhile, station-wise, Safdarjung, the city's base station, recorded a maximum temperature of 30.8 degrees Celsius, 4.3 degrees below normal, while Palam logged 29.6 degrees Celsius, 5.9 degrees below normal. Lodhi Road recorded 30.6 degrees Celsius, Ridge 31.0 degrees Celsius and Ayanagar 30.5 degrees Celsius.

Minimum temperatures also remained below normal across stations, with Safdarjung

recording 16.3 degrees Celsius, Palam 14.6 degrees Celsius, Lodhi Road 15.2 degrees Celsius, Ridge 14.5 degrees Celsius and Ayanagar 16.2 degrees Celsius. Rainfall activity was minimal, with Palam recording a cumulative 1.2 mm till 8.30 am, while other stations largely reported no rainfall or only trace amounts.

Weather experts said temperatures are now expected to rise steadily. "We are expecting a rise in the maximum temperatures over the northwest parts of the country by 6 to 8 degrees Celsius over the western Himalayan region and by 8 to 10 degrees Celsius over the north plains of northwest India. From tomorrow onwards, we are expecting clear skies," an IMD official said.

The city's air quality stood in the 'moderate' category, with the Air Quality Index (AQI) recorded at 101.

According to CPCB standards, an AQI of 0-50 is considered 'good', 51-100 'satisfactory', 101-200 'moderate', 201-300 'poor', 301-400 'very poor', and 401-500 'severe'.

Biogas plant to come up at Ghazipur dairy farm to manage cattle waste

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has given administrative approval for setting up a 300 tonnes-per-day biogas plant at the Ghazipur dairy farm, officials said on Thursday, adding that the proposal will be placed before the House later this month. The House meeting is expected to be held on April 24, where the project is expected to be tabled for further consideration. According to officials, the proposed plant will come up on around five acres of land. "The tender will be issued in the next few days and the proposal will be tabled in the next House meeting," an official said.

The plan is part of wider efforts to manage waste generated by dairy colonies across the capital. It includes biogas plants at Ghazipur and Bhalwa dairies, 75 tonnes-per-day facilities at Masoodpur and Madanpur Khadar, a 100 TPD plant at Sarita Vihar, and a 200 TPD plant at Mangolpuri near the Outer Ring Road. Additional units proposed include a 100 TPD plant at Pitampura, 200 TPD plants each at Rohini and Sagarpur, and a 50 TPD unit at Khajuri Khas. Officials said the MCD and Delhi government have been asked to work with the National Dairy Development Board to handle waste from dairies and cow shelters. PII

Rs 4.5 crore facelift rolls out in Rajouri Garden

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a fresh push to upgrade basic civic infrastructure, Delhi Cabinet Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa on Thursday launched development works worth Rs 4.5 crore in the Rajouri Garden Assembly constituency, covering Khayala, Vishnu Garden and adjoining areas.

The projects, rolled out under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, aim to address long-standing civic issues by focusing on expansion of water supply lines, construction of sewage networks, development of roads and drains, installation of toilet blocks, and enhancement of greenery in



parcs. Officials said the initiative is expected to significantly improve basic amenities in these neighbourhoods, where resi-

dents have long flagged concerns over poor road conditions, inadequate drainage and limited sanitation infrastructure.

Govt eyes revamped e-portal for faster delivery of citizen services

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is preparing to launch e-District 2.0 portal, an updated AI based platform for faster and efficient delivery of citizen services, officials said on Thursday. The number of services may also go up in the updated version. The existing e-District facility offers 453 services related to various departments, they said.

The new portal will have AI enabled chatbot to provide answers to the queries of the people and ensuring efficient handling of applications. The government is also exploring

The existing e-District facility offers 453 services related to various departments

the use of blockchain technology for enhanced data security and transparency, said a senior officer. The e-District provides end-to-end integrated solution to various services availed through this portal. It also provides online verification of various certificates issued by multiple departments. The documents of the user are permanently stored in the

database and can be accessed by them while using the online facility repeatedly.

The e-District 2.0 website will have an improved user-friendly interface, faster processing, timeline discipline and better backend integration, said the officer.

Under the e-governance push, the Delhi government has also expanded the common services centres (CSCs) to 7,000 across the city.

These centres are providing 75 key e-District services like issuing of caste, birth, death and income certificates and other documents to the people in their neighbourhoods.

CSR fuels MCD's clean sweep drive

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi strengthened its sanitation infrastructure with the induction of new vehicles and equipment under a Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiative supported by Indraprastha Gas Limited.

MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar flagged off the fleet at a ceremony held in Saket, aimed at improving waste management services in the South Zone. The addition includes one CNG tipper, 25 electric rickshaws, 15 cycle rickshaws, and 65 wheelbarrows, expected to enhance on-ground sanitation efficiency while promoting eco-friendly practices.

Senior officials, including South Zone Deputy Commissioner Rakesh Kumar and IGL's CSR Head Amit Dixit, were present, along with representatives from resident welfare associations, NGOs, and local communities.

Addressing the gathering, Khirwar acknowledged the contribution of IGL and partner organisations, noting that such collaborations play a crucial role in strengthening civic

age lines, development of a key road along with an associated drain, and inauguration of a public toilet complex.

Highlighting the broader vision, Sirsa said, "This year, the Delhi Government is committed in infrastructure development works. Under the leadership of Hon'ble Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, a provision of Rs.32,000 crore has been made to give a new direction to the capital. This is just the beginning."

He emphasised that achieving the vision of a "Viksit Delhi" would require sustained efforts to ensure clean, organised and modern infrastructure across all areas. Local residents welcomed the projects, expressing hope for improved living conditions.



services. He urged citizens to actively participate in maintaining cleanliness and emphasised waste segregation at the household level.

Highlighting future goals, the Commissioner encouraged RWAs to transform residential areas into zero-waste colonies, assuring financial incentives and institutional support from the civic body.

The event witnessed participation from over 100 attendees, including students, who presented cultural performances centred on community engagement. The programme concluded with a vote of thanks, reiterating the need for sustained public involvement in ensuring a cleaner urban environment.

MCD's digital push: App launched, 500 students get SCHOLARSHIPS

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi on Thursday rolled out a web application for its schools and disbursed scholarships to 500 meritorious students, marking a push towards digital integration and student support.

Mayor Raja Iqbal Singh transferred Rs 1,000 each directly into students' bank accounts in a single-click initiative, with funding support from Sungrow. The event was attended by Standing Committee Chairperson Satya Sharma, Education Committee Chairman Yogesh Verma, and senior officials from the education department.

The newly launched web app will cover 1,514 MCD schools, enabling parents to track attendance, homework, and academic progress remotely. Officials said the platform aims to strengthen transparency and parental engagement in school education.

Addressing the gather-



ing, the Mayor said that civic schools are playing a crucial role in shaping the nation's future, adding that continuous reforms are being introduced for students' holistic development. He also urged teachers to remain committed to quality education.

Sharma highlighted the role of educators in strengthening the system, while Yogesh Verma underscored the use of technology, including QR-based access, to modernise school administration. He also noted the launch of 24 Nigam-SHRI schools and acknowledged corporate support in promoting student welfare.

Bureaucratic rejig: 33 DANICS, IAS officers moved

NEW DELHI: In a bureaucratic reshuffle, the Delhi government has transferred 33 IAS and DANICS cadre officers, giving charge of additional chief secretary power and administrative reform to Prashant Goyal.

Goyal, 1993 batch IAS officer of Arunachal Pradesh-Goa-Mizoram-Union Territories (AGMUT) cadre, has been relieved of the charge of Finan-

cial Commissioner, a Services department order issued on Wednesday said.

G Narendra Kumar, 1989 batch IAS officer awaiting posting, will be the new Financial Commissioner of Delhi. Soumya Saurabh (IAS,2014) will handle the additional charge of special secretary (industries) along with her current posting as district magistrate of North West Delhi, it said.

Sonika Singh (IAS,2015), special secretary cum private secretary of Delhi Lt Governor, has been transferred as Commissioner DDA, the order said.

Delhi, Andaman and Nicobar Islands Civil Service (DANICS) cadre officer of 2006 batch holding the post of additional director (social Welfare) has been transferred to the post of additional commissioner

(GST), Harshit Jain (DANICS, 2014), joint director (education) will look after preparatory activities related to Census 2027, it added.

The reshuffle also involved an administrative shake up, with transfers and postings involving Sub-Divisional Magistrates (SDMs), Additional District Magistrates (ADMs) and District Magistrates (DMs) across districts. PII

MONSOON COUNTDOWN

CM sets June 30 drain-clean deadline to curb waterlogging

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: With the monsoon approaching, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday set a strict June 30 deadline for desilting of drains and called for seamless coordination among multiple civic agencies to tackle the city's recurring waterlogging crisis.

Chairing a high-level review meeting at the Secretariat, the Chief Minister directed departments to complete pre-monsoon preparations on time and ensure special arrangements



at identified flooding hotspots. Stressing a collective approach, she said, "This cannot continue," referring to past instances of

blame-shifting among agencies, and warned that any negligence would invite strict action.

The meeting was attended by

Chief Secretary Rajeev Verma and senior officials from PWD, MCD, DMRC, NDMC, DDA and the Delhi Cantonment Board, who presented their action plans for drain cleaning, repairs and infrastructure upgrades.

Highlighting key priorities, Gupta emphasised that desilting must be completed before the onset of heavy rains and that removed silt should be transported to designated sites to prevent re-entry into drains. She also flagged the issue of garbage clogging drain inlets across mar-

kets and residential areas, often leading to severe water accumulation on roads.

Pointing to a successful intervention, the Chief Minister said, "Replicate Minto Road model across Delhi," noting that the stretch, once notorious for flooding, remained free of waterlogging last monsoon due to sustained monitoring and timely action.

Gupta also directed departments to adopt modern machinery to handle waterlogging more efficiently and reduce reliance on pumps. She underlined that a

long-term solution lies in building robust drainage infrastructure rather than depending on temporary measures.

"Until we ensure clean, organised and modern systems, the problem will persist," she noted, calling for a scientific and structured drainage plan.

Reinforcing accountability, the Chief Minister instructed officials to maintain constant coordination with ground staff during the monsoon, adding that she will personally conduct field inspections across the city.

SEEKS COORDINATED ACTION

SC asks states to treat rising child trafficking cases as grave

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has voiced grave concern over rising cases of child trafficking, saying gangs are operating across the country and if States and Union territories do not take immediate action, thing will go beyond control. The court said only the state government and its home department can act vigilantly in this regard.

“As a court we can monitor, but ultimately the action has to be on the part of the state gov-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The court said only the state govt and its home department can act vigilantly in this regard
- » As a court we can monitor, but ultimately the action has to be on the part of the state government,

the police, and other agencies. Therefore, this is our humble request

- » The bench was irked over the “lackadaisical” approach of several states and UTs in implementing a 2025 judgment aimed at dismantling organised trafficking networks

ernment, the police, and other agencies. Therefore, this is our humble request”, a bench com-

prising Justices JB Pardiwala and K V Viswanathan said during the hearing of a plea

on Wednesday. The bench was irked over the “lackadaisical” approach of several states and UTs in implementing a 2025 judgment aimed at dismantling organised trafficking networks. Justice Viswanathan said the retrieval of children in some cases proves the problem can be tackled, but it requires a level of political and administrative will which is lacking at present.

The verdict, delivered on April 15, 2025, had mandated several institutional reforms, including completion of trials in trafficking cases within six

months on a day-to-day basis. It had also directed strengthening of Anti-Human Trafficking Units (AHTUs) and improving investigation standards.

Besides asking for setting up of state-level committees to monitor vulnerable trafficking hotspots, it had asked the authorities to treat missing children cases as trafficking unless proven otherwise.

Earlier, the bench had termed the compliance reports filed by a few states as “nothing but an eye wash.”

Jal Shakti Ministry reviews states’ progress on river rejuvenation

NEW DELHI: The Jal Shakti Ministry on Thursday reviewed the progress made by states on river rejuvenation and pollution abatement, with a focus on implementation of action plans for polluted river stretches and functioning of sewage treatment infrastructure. The review, undertaken at the 21st meeting (part-II) of the Central Monitoring Committee (CMC), was chaired by V L Kantha Rao, secretary, Department of Water Resources, River Development and Ganga Rejuvenation.

The committee undertook a detailed review of progress in Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Sikkim, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Tripura, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu, Maharashtra, Goa and Himachal Pradesh, officials said.

The committee reviewed the implementation status of action plans for polluted river stretches, including progress of sewage treatment plants (STPs) and common effluent treatment plants (CETPs), functioning and compliance status of existing sewage treatment infrastructure, and solid waste management interventions, the ministry said in a statement. Issues related to environmental flows, floodplain regulation, submission of action plans for management of pollution in coastal areas and functioning of River Rejuvenation Committees (RRCs) were also reviewed, it added.

Emphasising the need to bridge the gap between sewage generation and treatment, Kantha Rao said optimal utilisation and compliance of exist-

ing STPs, along with expeditious completion of ongoing projects, remain critical for achieving sustained improvements in river water quality. He advised states to enhance reuse of treated wastewater, adopt a reuse of treated water policy where not done so far, strengthen floodplain zoning, improve monitoring mechanisms, and ensure timely submission of monthly progress reports. The meeting was attended by Zaigham Ali Khan, joint secretary, National River Conservation Directorate, Anup Kumar Srivastava, executive director (technical), National Mission for Clean Ganga, senior officials from the ministry, the Central Pollution Control Board, and representatives of state governments and state pollution control boards.

AGENCIES

From Page 1 Peace on paper

return to the way things were before the war.

Under the ceasefire terms, Iran will allow no more than 15 vessels per day to transit the Strait of Hormuz, a senior Iranian source told Russian news agency TASS ahead of talks in Islamabad. Each passage will require Iran’s approval and compliance with a specific protocol.

“Under the current ceasefire, fewer than 15 ships per day are permitted to transit the Strait of Hormuz. This movement is strictly contingent upon Iran’s approval and the enforcement of a specific protocol. This new regulatory framework, operating under the supervision of the IRGC, has been officially communicated to regional parties. There will be no return to the pre-war status quo,” the source said.

The Strait handles roughly a fifth of the world’s seaborne crude oil trade. Iran has seabed a financial condition to the ceasefire as well. Tehran is demanding that its blocked overseas assets be unfrozen before the two-week period is up.

Tehran is also insisting that the end of the war be formally recognised through a United Nations Security Council resolution on its own terms, and has warned of consequences if that does not happen.

And there was disagreement over whether the ceasefire deal included a pause in fighting between Israel and Hezbollah. Israel on Wednesday pounded Beirut with airstrikes, resulting in the deadliest day in Lebanon since the war began on February 28.

Questions also remain over what will happen to Iran’s stockpile of enriched uranium at the heart of tensions, how and when normal traffic will resume through the strait, and what happens to Iran’s ability to launch future missile attacks and support armed proxies in the region.

Iran’s parliament speaker, Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf, warned Thursday that continued Israeli attacks on the Iran-backed Hezbollah militant group in Lebanon would bring “explicit costs and STRONG responses” in a social media post.

Qalibaf has been discussed as a possible negotiator who could meet US Vice President JD Vance this weekend in Islamabad. The White House has said Vance would lead the delegation for talks starting Saturday.

Iran said Israel was violating the ceasefire agreement. Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and Trump have said it was not. Netanyahu said Israel will continue striking Hezbollah “with force, precision and determination.”

Lebanon’s health ministry said at least 203 people were killed and more than 1,000 wounded in Israeli strikes in central Beirut and other areas of Lebanon on Wednesday, which joined the war in support of Tehran.

The death toll was the highest for a single day in Lebanon during more than five weeks of renewed war between Israel and Hezbollah. Israel said Thursday it killed an aide to Hezbollah leader Naim Kassem, Ali Yusuf Harshi. Hezbollah did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

A New York-based think tank warned the ceasefire “hovers on the verge of collapse.”

“Even if Lebanon was formally outside the deal, the scale of Israel’s strikes was likely to be viewed as escalatory,” the Soufan Centre wrote in an analysis. “Israel’s strikes can be understood both as an effort to drive a wedge between Iran and its proxies and as a response to being

allegedly sidelined in the original ceasefire discussions.”

Lebanon’s state-run National News Agency reported that an Israeli strike overnight killed at least seven people in southern Lebanon. The Israeli military did not immediately acknowledge the strike.

Semiofficial news agencies in Iran published a chart Thursday suggesting the country’s paramilitary Revolutionary Guard put sea mines into the Strait of Hormuz during the war — a message that may be intended to pressure the United States.

The chart, released by the ISNA news agency and Tasmim, showed a large circle marked “danger zone” in Farsi over the route ships take through the strait, through which 20 per cent of all traded oil and natural gas once passed.

Only a trickle of ships have transited since the war began after several were attacked and Iran threatened to hit any that it deemed connected to the US or Israel. Ships appeared to continue to avoid the strait even after the ceasefire.

The chart suggested that ships travel through waters closer to Iran’s mainland near Larak Island, a route that some ships were observed taking during the war. It was dated from February 28 until April 9, and it was unclear if the Guard had cleared any mines since then.

Iran’s deputy foreign minister, Saeed Khatibzadeh, told the BBC that his country will allow ships to pass through the strait in accordance with “international norms and international law” once the United States ends its “aggression” in the Middle East and Israel stops attacking Lebanon.

The head of the United Arab Emirates’ major oil company, Sultan al-Jaber, said some 230 ships loaded with oil were waiting to get through the strait and must be allowed “to navigate this corridor without condition.”

The Strait’s de facto closure has caused oil prices to skyrocket — affecting the cost of gasoline, food and other basics far beyond the Middle East. Oil prices fell on news of the ceasefire Wednesday, but began to climb as uncertainty over the deal grew. The spot price of Brent crude, the international standard, was around USD 98 on Thursday, up about 35 per cent since the war began.

Points to address in talks include whether Iran will be allowed to formalise a system of charging ships to use the strait. That would upend decades of free transit through what has been treated as an international waterway.

The fate of Iran’s missile and nuclear programmes — which the US and Israel sought to eliminate in going to war — also remained unclear. The US insists Iran must never be able to build nuclear weapons and wants to remove Tehran’s stockpile of highly enriched uranium, which could be used to build them. Iran insists its programme is peaceful.

Trump warned that US warships and troops will remain around Iran “until such time as the REAL AGREEMENT reached is fully complied with.”

Israel’s war crimes

Hospitals were overwhelmed as victims, including women and children, were pulled from rubble following strikes on residential neighbourhoods.

Witnesses and local officials said several of the targeted areas were purely civilian, contradicting Israeli claims that the sites housed Hezbollah infrastructure. In central Beirut, bombs hit busy commercial and residential districts during peak hours, with no prior warning issued to residents.

The scale and nature of the attacks have drawn sharp international concern. The United Nations human rights office said some of the strikes may amount to violations of international humanitarian law, particularly due to the high number of civilian casualties and damage to civilian infrastructure.

UN Human Rights Chief Volker Türk described the scenes as “horrific” and called for independent investigations into possible war crimes. Separately, rights groups argued that the strikes appeared “indiscriminate or disproportionate”, key criteria used in determining war crimes under international law.

Specific incidents have intensified scrutiny. Strikes reportedly damaged a hospital near Tyre, hit an ambulance, and killed mourners at a funeral, raising concerns over attacks on protected civilian sites. Earlier in March, a “double-tap” drone strike on displaced civilians in Beirut also drew condemnation after hitting rescuers responding to an initial blast.

Israel has defended its actions, stating that the strikes were aimed at Hezbollah’s command centres, weapons depots and operatives embedded within civilian areas. Israel also highlighted targeted killings of senior Hezbollah figures, including leader Naim Qassem, his nephew Ali Yusuf Harshi, southern commander Hajj Yusuf Ismail Hashem and chief of staff Haytham Ali Tabatabaai.

Officials, including Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, have said operations would continue with “force, precision and determination.”

Israeli authorities have also argued that Lebanon was not covered under a separate US-Iran ceasefire announced hours before the strikes, framing the offensive as part of its ongoing war against Hezbollah.

Despite these claims, the humanitarian impact has been severe. More than one million people have been displaced across Lebanon, with shelters overwhelmed and shortages of food, medicine and basic services worsening conditions.

Medical workers described chaotic scenes, with mass casualties arriving within minutes and limited capacity to treat the injured. The latest strikes have pushed the overall death toll in Lebanon into the thousands since the conflict escalated earlier this year.

International condemnation has intensified. A group of more than 60 countries raised concerns at the United Nations, warning that attacks on civilians and peacekeepers could constitute war crimes and demanding accountability.

Several governments and humanitarian organisations have called for an immediate ceasefire and independent investigations, as the strikes have further undermined already fragile diplomatic efforts in the region.

Energy security

briefing in the national capital. Officials from key ministries, including Petroleum and Natural Gas, External Affairs, and Chemicals and Fertilisers, outlined a comprehensive response strategy to mitigate the impact of disruptions linked to tensions around the Strait of Hormuz during the briefing at the National Media Centre.

MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal further said that continuous efforts are being made by the ministry to assist Indian citizens living in the region. In Tehran, the Indian Embassy has helped evacuate 2,170 Indians from Iran to Armenia and Azerbaijan. Across West Asia, Indian missions have remained

operational throughout the day to assist citizens.

Officials also stated that although there are disruptions in international supply chains, mainly due to shortages of active pharmaceutical ingredients (APIs) and essential solvents, there has been no significant price hike for drugs in India. It was noted during the briefing that collective measures, such as reducing customs duties to nil on 40 types of petrochemical products, have helped stabilise the pharmaceutical industry.

Further, officials highlighted that key raw materials like propylene, ammonia, and methanol continue to be available due to domestic production and coordination with government-owned companies. Propylene, an important input used in manufacturing medicines such as ibuprofen, is supplied by refineries managed by Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited, while methanol is sourced with support from Assam Petrochemicals and Gujarat Narmada Valley Fertilisers and Chemicals.

Addressing the press, Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary (Marketing and Oil Refinery) in the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, responded to concerns over fuel availability, assuring that there is no shortage of petrol, diesel, or LPG across the country. She said domestic LPG deliveries remain stable, with over 51.5 lakh cylinders delivered on April 8 alone, adding that Delivery Authentication Code (DAC)-based distribution has risen to around 92 per cent, helping curb diversion.

She further noted that a key indicator of supply resilience was that over 1.06 lakh 5 kg free trade LPG cylinders were sold on April 8, exceeding the average daily sales in February, which stood at 77,000. More than 18,000 people have also voluntarily given up their LPG connections for piped natural gas (PNG).

Sharma added that to manage demand and ensure equitable distribution, the government has taken several steps, including extending the interval between LPG bookings and prioritising supply to essential sectors such as hospitals and schools. State governments have also been authorised to act against hoarding or black marketing under the Essential Commodities Act.

On the energy front, she confirmed that all refineries are operating at high capacity with adequate crude inventories. Retail fuel prices have been kept stable despite rising global crude rates, aided by a Rs 10 per litre cut in excise duty on petrol and diesel. Additional kerosene allocations and increased coal supplies are also being used to ease pressure on LPG demand.

On maritime activity, officials said operations have not been affected, with Indian vessels continuing to traverse the Gulf region successfully. The ship Green Asha, carrying liquefied petroleum gas, passed through the Strait of Hormuz and reached Jawaharlal Nehru Port without incident, demonstrating the effectiveness of the surveillance mechanisms put in place by the government.

Officials added that despite ongoing geopolitical tensions, India’s combined approach of diplomacy, logistics management, and coordinated policy measures has helped maintain stability.

TMC alleges Rs 1K crore poll

alleged that several prominent BJP figures are referenced in the purported conversation. Among those named are Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, West Bengal BJP leader Suwendu Adhikari, and even

the PMO.

TMC leaders described the video as a “major revelation”, hinting at it being a “larger political conspiracy”, particularly in the run-up to the West Bengal elections. The ruling party has also urged the ED to investigate the alleged financial transactions, insisting that claims involving such large sums require an impartial probe.

“BJP can get around 100 to 110 or 120 seats. BJP will not get 148 seats. Every time I had a discussion with Suwendu Adhikari, I told him the same, and he agreed with me. I have been told if I can get 70-80 seats, I will be the deputy chief minister,” the person resembling Kabir is heard telling a man (not seen on camera) during the 19-minute conversation.

The unidentified man was also heard asking that to achieve the purpose (of drawing the Muslim voters) the Muslim electors in Bengal need to be “gumraah” (mislead). The man resembling Kabir said in the video that if the Babri-like mosque will be set up or not is a matter of time. Muslims in Bengal were with him, he claimed.

“I told him, I also told Suwendu I need money. To bring the Muslim voters to my side, I have to spend around Rs. 3-4 crore. The Trinamool does not give much money (to the contestants). The candidates I field will be educated ones. It is important to bring Muslim candidates forward. But I need money,” the person resembling Kabir was heard saying in the video footage.

The man resembling Kabir was heard saying in Hindi, the English translation of which would be “If you give me Rs 1,000 crore, you will benefit. I will get 70-80 seats; you will get around 100-120. Mamata Banerjee’s seats will come down to less than 100. After the polls, I will tell my people that the BJP is in power in the Centre. In the three terms that Mamata Banerjee was chief minister, there has been no development for the Muslim community...all the Muslims have full faith in me.” Firhad Hakim, during the Press conference, said: “Are we fools that anyone can play with our religious sentiments? I know this person. I had announced his suspension from this very place. Muslims of Bengal should not be considered as fools.”

Trinamool spokesperson and Belaghata nominee Kunal Ghosh said the central agencies should probe all the people named in the video and asked that the person in the PMO who was allegedly involved must be interrogated immediately. “Who is the officer in the PMO who is involved in these shady deals? This man should be interrogated immediately. What role did the other leaders named have played? From where is this man getting funds to hire choppers for his campaign?” asked Ghosh.

Kabir’s party has entered into an alliance with Asaduddin Owaisi’s AIMIM and has fielded candidates in over 100 of Bengal’s 294 Assembly seats. Later in the day, Kabir told the media that it was an AI-generated video done by TMC. He also threatened to file a Rs 2,000 crore defamation suit if they fail to prove its authenticity.

Assam, Puducherry

“accurate counting of votes” and the security of electronic voting machines.

The contest in Assam is primarily between the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party, which is aiming to retain power for a third term, and the Congress, which is seeking to return to office after being ousted in 2016.

Kerala, with 883 candidates contesting in 140 constituencies and a voter base of 2.71 crore, recorded

a turnout of 78.27 per cent, higher than the 74.06 per cent registered in 2021. The state’s electoral contest continues to be dominated by the CPI(M)-led Left Democratic Front and the Congress-led United Democratic Front, with the BJP-led NDA attempting to expand its presence.

CPI(M) leader C N Mohanan said the rise in turnout could benefit the Left, citing efforts by party workers to mobilise voters. BJP leader K S Shaiju attributed the increase to greater participation by women voters, suggesting it could work in his party’s favour. Congress leader Deepthi Mary Varghese said trends linked to higher turnout often benefit the UDF, but added that the reasons would need closer examination.

Kerala Chief Electoral Officer Rathan U Kelkar expressed optimism that turnout could reach 90 per cent once final figures are compiled.

Polling in Puducherry, where the Congress-led alliance is attempting to unseat the AINRC-led government, remained largely peaceful. An innovative feature drew attention at a model polling booth in the Raj Bhavan constituency, where a robot welcomed voters with flower petals at the VOC Government Higher Secondary School.

Across the three regions, polling was largely orderly, though officials reported isolated incidents in Assam. Seven individuals were detained in connection with election-related violence at two locations, and minor clashes at several booths led to some injuries after voting began in the morning. Prominent figures, including Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan and his Assam counterpart Himanta Biswa Sarma, cast their votes. Malayalam film actors Mammootty and Mohanlal were also among those who participated in the electoral process.

The elections mark the first phase of a broader electoral exercise covering four states and one Union Territory. While voting in Kerala and Assam concluded on Thursday, West Bengal will vote in two phases on April 23 and April 29, and Tamil Nadu will go to the polls in a single phase on April 23. Counting of votes for all states and the Union Territory is scheduled for May 4.

The elections are unfolding amid concerns over a potential LPG shortage linked to the ongoing West Asia conflict. The issue featured prominently in campaign discussions, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and other BJP leaders assuring stable supply, while opposition parties raised concerns about possible disruptions.

‘Vimana’, ‘Operion’

chairman and chief executive officer of SS Innovations International, the system is equipped with dual seven-degree-of-freedom robotic arms and specialised instruments. It allows surgeons to perform procedures such as haemorrhage control, chest decompression, removal of shrapnel, and wound repair from a distance. “This innovation represents a paradigm shift in emergency response, transforming how critical care can be delivered in high-risk, time-sensitive scenarios,” he said.

Complementing this is Project Operion, a mobile operating room platform designed for deployment across diverse environments, including hospitals, remote areas, and disaster zones. Built on a wheeled chassis with overhead-integrated robotic systems, the platform eliminates conventional spatial limitations by suspending surgical components from above.

Srivastava said the design

enables 360-degree access for clinicians and allows real-time adjustments during procedures. The system also integrates telesurgery capabilities with low-latency connectivity, enabling expert surgeons to operate from distant locations. He noted that the platform can be used in defence settings, humanitarian missions, and rural health-care delivery.

The company also showcased SSI Avtara, a humanoid robotic system intended to support operations across sectors such as healthcare, logistics, disaster response, and industry.

Speaking to reporters, Chief Technology Officer Rama Krishna Reddy said the technologies could be supplied to the armed forces within a short timeframe once regulatory approvals are secured. Srivastava added that advancements in robotic systems are expected to make such surgeries more affordable for patients over time.

The launch highlights efforts to integrate robotics into emergency medicine, with a focus on improving access and reducing response times in critical situations.

India, US set

The framework seeks to promote reciprocal trade, improve market access, and strengthen supply chain resilience through measures such as expanded preferential access, stricter rules of origin, and efforts to address non-tariff barriers across sectors. During his visit, Gor held a series of meetings with senior US officials, including Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, whom he described as “a true leader who’s done an incredible job in handling complex economic issues.”

He also met Deputy Secretary of State Christopher Landau to discuss commercial diplomacy in South and Central Asia, particularly in areas such as artificial intelligence, emerging technologies, infrastructure development, and critical minerals. Gor noted that Landau is looking forward to visiting India, Uzbekistan and Kazakhstan.

Talks with Under Secretary of State Jacob Helberg focused on energy cooperation, including next steps on “Pax Silica” and strengthening secure supply chains for critical technologies. “Big things ahead for the US and India as it relates to Pax Silica,” Gor said.

In addition, Gor met Under Secretary of State for Public Diplomacy Sarah Rogers to discuss initiatives aimed at building partnerships and delivering tangible outcomes.

Earlier this week, Gor also met India’s Ambassador to the US, Vinay Mohan Kwatra, who said both sides are working actively to achieve the strategic objectives set by their leaders.

Misri, currently on a three-day visit to Washington, held meetings with senior Commerce Department officials and is scheduled to meet Landau and Under Secretary of State for Political Affairs Allison Hooker.

Separately, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal had recently met Greer on the sidelines of a WTO ministerial meeting in Cameroon, where both sides reviewed next steps in the bilateral trade agreement negotiations and discussed ways to expand economic cooperation.

CBSE asks

or mother tongue, a second language such as English or another Indian language, and a third additional language.

According to CBSE, the initiative aims to foster linguistic skills, cultural awareness, and national integration, with strict monitoring to ensure timely rollout.

PM CALLS FOR TMC-MUKT BENGAL

CAKEWALK FOR SUNETRA PAWAR

Bengal: Modi whets BJP's election pitch

MPOST BUREAU

KOLKATA: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday sharpened the BJP's poll pitch in West Bengal, bringing "industrial decay" and "infiltration menace" to the forefront of his campaign discourse while offering a "six-point guarantee" to the people as an antidote to the "sins" committed by the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC dispensation.

Speaking at three rallies in the state, the venues of two of which formed the state's industrial hotspots and the third comprising its tribal belt, the PM remarked that the "vessel of Trinamool's sins was full" and advocated for a Trinamool-mukt Bengal to ensure the state's development.

"Investments cannot be ushered in when an atmosphere of fear prevails. It can only happen when there is trust," Modi said, canvassing for BJP candidates in the backyard of LoP Suwendu Adhikari.

Underlining "six Modi guarantees" for the people, the Prime Minister said the BJP, after coming to power, will replace the TMC's "reign of fear" with BJP's "trust".

Modi pledged to bring about changes in the governance "system" and make public servants accountable to citizens for their actions, stating his second guarantee.

"The BJP will reopen all files on corruption and crimes committed against women in Bengal, which the TMC has suppressed," he added, spelling out his "third guarantee".

"All leaders, irrespective of their positions in government, who are involved in corruption, will be in jail," he added as the fourth.

While pledging that government facilities and scheme benefits will be made available to all refugees who took shel-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi holds a musical instrument 'ektara' during a public rally in support of BJP candidates ahead of the West Bengal Assembly elections, at Suri in Birbhum, Thursday

ter in India as per provisions of law, Modi asserted that "infiltrators won't be allowed to stay in this country", stating his fifth guarantee.

"Once the BJP government is formed, we will immediately implement the 7th Pay Commission in Bengal for state employees, teachers and those working in related sectors," he said, defining his final guarantee.

Citing BJP's 2021 state election performance in Purba Medinipur, where it bagged 15 of the 16 assembly seats, Modi claimed the state is now following the path shown by the district five years ago.

"The Nandigram results from last time will be repeated in Bhanipur," he said, referring to Adhikari's victory over Mamata Banerjee in 2021.

Adhikari is pitted against the incumbent CM at her bastion in Bhanipur this time.

The PM promised the people that the BJP would make the state self-reliant in fisheries and the seafood sector.

Later, while addressing a rally in Asansol, a region known for its

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Underlining 'six Modi guarantees' for the people, the PM said the BJP, after coming to power, will replace the TMC's 'reign of fear' with BJP's 'trust'
- » Modi pledged to bring about changes in the governance 'system' and make public servants accountable to citizens

premium coal production and mining activities, the PM assured abolition of "cut-money culture and syndicate Raj of the TMC" in Bengal, alleging that mafia Raj spanning across illegal extraction of coal and sand has cast a stranglehold on the people of the state.

"A regime change in Bengal is now cast in stone," the Prime Minister said, adding, "This is not merely an election to change the government, it's an opportunity to return industrial prowess to Asansol."

Speaking in Suri, the district headquarters of Birbhum in his final rally of the day, Modi accused the TMC of unleashing 'maha jungle raj' by referring to the Bagtui village carnage of 2022, in which around 10 women and children were burnt alive in the district.

He intensified the BJP's infiltration plank for the upcoming polls and referred to last week's gherao of judicial officers in Malda to slam the TMC administration and reiterate his conviction of getting the country rid of "illegal entrants".

"I stand before you today to make this promise: Once there is a change of guard in state power following these elections, I will initiate a special inquiry against the facilitators of infiltration in this state and put them behind bars," Modi declared.

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI/PUNE: The Opposition Congress on Thursday opted out of the bypoll to the Baramati assembly seat in Maharashtra at the last moment, giving a virtual walkover to ruling NCP candidate and Deputy CM Sunetra Pawar though a contest will still take place as 22 other nominees remain in the fray.

After initially appearing firm to contest the April 23 bypoll, necessitated due to the death of former Deputy Chief Minister and sitting Baramati MLA Ajit Pawar, the husband of Sunetra, the Congress withdrew its candidate in the wake of calls from ruling allies Nationalist Congress Party, BJP and also its Opposition partner NCP (SP).

Addressing a press conference in Mumbai, state Congress president Harshwardhan Sapkal sought to frame the decision to climbdown as a move rooted in Maharashtra's political culture and decorum and referred to the death of Ajit Pawar in an air



SUNETRA PAWAR FILE PIC

crash just over two months ago. "The decision was taken to maintain the state's political culture, decorum and dialogue. We are taking two steps back since the bypoll is taking place immediately after the tragic demise of Ajit Pawar. Even though Ajit Pawar started his political career with the Congress, he had joined hands with the BJP for the sake of power," Sapkal said. "The Congress is withdrawing from the Baramati bypoll, but not supporting any candidate," the MPCC president maintained.

Soon after his announcement, Congress candidate Akash More withdrew his nomination from the high-

The decision was taken to maintain the state's political culture, decorum and dialogue

profile assembly seat, a Pawar family bastion in Pune district, just before end of the deadline. "As per directions from the party leadership, I have withdrawn my nomination," More told reporters in Baramati.

Sapkal made it clear his party's decision had nothing to do with Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis, a BJP leader, speaking to him with a request for an unopposed election of Sunetra Pawar from the seat won by her husband eight times in the past.

The MPCC president said Sunetra Pawar had spoken to him three times over phone and even met Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge in New Delhi to seek withdrawal

of the party candidate.

Sapkal also disclosed that NCP leaders Chhagan Bhujbal and Dhananjay Munde spoke to him over phone requesting withdrawal of the Congress candidate from fray. Another NCP minister Makrand Patil met him with a delegation of party leaders and made the same request.

Putting up a brave face, the state Congress chief asserted his party will prepare for a bigger fight in the 2029 assembly polls and expressed confidence about winning the Pawar family pocketborough.

"I am categorically stating that there will be a Congress candidate in Baramati in 2029 who will be elected," he insisted.

Despite the Congress opting out, the Baramati assembly seat will still see a contest as 22 other candidates remain in the fray. However, none of them is likely to pose any significant challenge to Sunetra Pawar, whose election from the seat appears a mere formality.

Poll official found dead in Assam

TEZPUR: A poll official was found dead in Assam's Sonitpur district on Thursday amid assembly elections in the state, officials said.

Deben Horo (45) was deputed as the second polling officer in the Naduar constituency, they said.

"Horo was deputed in polling station no 230 in Dolapani I.P. School. He was found unconscious in his bed this morning. He was taken to a nearby hospital by ambulance, but he was pronounced dead by the doctors," an official said.

The cause of death is yet to be confirmed, though doctors suspect an underlying medical condition led to it, he said.

Horo hailed from Doldopi Kachari Gaon in the Chariduar revenue circle. He was an assistant teacher at a government school, officials said. The incident did not affect polling, which began at the booth at the scheduled time of 7 am. A reserve personnel was deputed in Horo's place, they said.

MPOST

Ponda bypoll cancelled: AAP alleges 'conspiracy'

PANAJI: The cancellation of the Ponda Assembly bypoll in Goa was due to a "political conspiracy" between the Election Commission of India and BJP, the Aam Aadmi Party alleged on Thursday.

The Bombay High Court on Wednesday quashed the ECI's notification for the bypoll a day ahead of polling, citing violation of Representation of the People Act as the legislature's term is set to expire in less than a year.

The bypoll, scheduled for Thursday, was cancelled even though postal ballots had already been cast. The HC also refused to stay its judgement.

The bypoll was necessitated by the death of sitting BJP MLA Ravi Naik on October 15, 2025. Goa AAP president Valmiki

Naik alleged the bypoll notification was deliberately delayed by the ECI to ensure the tenure of the new MLA would be less than a year. Assembly polls are due in the state in March next year.

While asserting that his party respects the HC verdict, Naik said: "Why did the ECI delay in announcing the bypoll date? We are apprehensive as voters of Ponda will not have a legislator to represent them for 16 months (time period from the day when seat fell vacant to the assembly polls in March.)"

Two voters from Ponda had filed a petition in the HC demanding cancellation of the election. "The Advocate General of Goa argued in support of the petitioners," he further said.

MPOST

GUWAHATI/SILCHAR/DIBRUGARH (ASSAM): Around 30 people were injured and seven arrested in connection with poll-related violence in Assam on Thursday, officials said.

A senior police officer said that the Congress candidate in Patharkandi constituency in Sribhumi district, Kartik Sena Sinha, allegedly entered the Rangamati polling booth and started an argument with the presiding officer. "He claimed fake electors cast genuine people's votes. When the presiding officer denied the charge, he broke the EVM. Following this, supporters of Congress and the BJP started a fight," he added. Sinha is locked in a direct contest with Assam minister

and BJP candidate Krishnendu Paul.

"In the clash, around 25 people were injured, of whom two are serious. They have been sent to Karimganj Civil Hospital for treatment," the officer said. Sribhumi Senior Superintendent of Police Leena Doley reached the spot and reviewed the situation.

Voting was halted at the polling station for about three hours due to the disturbances. It resumed after election officials replaced the EVM.

"Sinha left the place, and no arrest has been made yet. Further investigation is underway," the officer said.

In another incident, three leaders of Assam Jatiya Parishad (AJP) were injured in

a clash with BJP supporters at Khowang constituency in Dibrugarh district, another police officer said.

"According to reports, AJP alleged that BJP was running an IT cell at a house in the area. A group of AJP workers reached there along with the police. After some time, AJP leaders Samudra Barua, Swakhyar Borgohain and Chitramal Handique also went there," he added.

Following a heated exchange of words, the AJP workers and BJP activists got involved in a physical brawl, in which the three AJP leaders were injured, the officer said.

Besides, minor clashes have also been reported in many polling booths across several districts.

MPOST

HIGHEST IN BENGAL

SIR: Nearly 74,775 names removed in Samserganj

SOUMITRA NANDI

VOTER PURGE

- » Metiaburuz has accounted for 39,579 removals, while Canning Purba, Basanti and Gosaba witnessed the removal of several thousand voters
- » In Murshidabad, Lalgola saw 55420 deletions, Raghunathgan (46,100), Farrakka (38,222), while Suti had 37,965

KOLKATA: The supplementary list published by the Election Commission of India (ECI) on Thursday has revealed that Samserganj in Murshidabad witnessed the removal of around 74,775 names, among the highest figures in the state.

District-wise data released by the poll body late on Monday night showed that Murshidabad recorded the largest number of deletions from the adjudication list, with a total of 4,55,137 names removed.

In Murshidabad, Lalgola saw 55420 deletions, Raghunathganj had more than 46,100 names struck off, Farrakka accounted for 38,222 deletions, while Suti witnessed 37,965. Similar large-scale exclusions

names have been struck off, pushing the cumulative deletion figure to 90,83,345.

In Malda, particularly in Sujapur, 26,829 voters were removed, marking one of the district's most notable figures. In North Dinajpur, the scale of deletion has also been substantial, with Chopra recording 27,898 deletions and Islampur losing more than 15,000 names from the rolls. In South 24-Parganas, Metiaburuz has accounted for 39,579 removals, while Canning Purba, Basanti and Gosaba also witnessed the removal of several thousand voters. Bhangar reported around 2,183 deletions, which is comparatively lower.

In Kolkata, Kolkata Port accounted for 13,395 deletions while Chowringhee accounted for 10,424 deletions. In Bhow-

anipore, 3,893 electors have been removed, in Belegghata this number is 9532, Entally 9092 while in Ballygunge the number is 6174. Maniktala had the lowest number of electors struck off with 733.

In West Burdwan, Asansol North, Kulti and Barabani each saw between 10,000 and 14,000 names deleted, while Raniganj recorded over 10,000 exclusions.

Overall, the data suggests that several constituencies across the state have seen voter deletions ranging from 30,000 to 70,000, with Murshidabad and Malda among the hardest-hit districts. Political observers say the scale of exclusions in these minority-dominated belts has already intensified the debate over the electoral roll revision process.

Minor protests in Kerala over bogus vote allegations

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: Assembly polling across Kerala progressed largely peacefully, but protests were reported at several booths on Thursday over allegations of bogus voting.

A minor scuffle broke out between Congress and BJP activists at Manalur in Thrissur district after UDF candidate T N Prathapan arrived in the area. According to police, BJP activists prevented people accompanying Prathapan from entering the booth premises, leading to the scuffle.

In Wadakkancherry, also in Thrissur district, a voter, Sajeev, was unable to cast his vote after election officials informed him that his vote had already been recorded as a postal ballot.

This triggered protests by BJP activists, prompting police intervention.

Although election officials offered to allow him to cast a tender vote, he declined.

BJP candidate T S Ullas Babu later arrived at the booth and staged a protest.

A similar incident occurred in Kuttiady, Kozhikode district, where a woman was denied the right to vote after it was found that her vote had already been cast as a postal ballot.

At Malampuzha and Shoranur in Palakkad district, Thrikkariapur in Kasaragod, and Vattiyoorkavu in Thiruvananthapuram, complaints emerged that votes had been cast in the names of original voters, leading to protests.

The affected voters were later permitted to cast tender votes.

In Kalpetta, Wayanad, a polling agent was removed after it was found that she was simultaneously working as an ASHA worker.

In a separate incident in Uduma, Kasaragod, a Congress agent was caught using "smart spectacles" inside a polling booth.

At a polling booth in Badaje, Manjeshwar, Kasaragod, a defect was noticed in a voting machine that recorded more votes than were actually polled.



Women's Bill: Stalin says proposal amid polls raises serious suspicion

CHENNAI: Chief Minister M K Stalin on Thursday alleged that the proposed amendment to ensure 33 per cent reservation for women in the midst of polls in states including Tamil Nadu appeared to be yet another political manoeuvre aimed at shaping electoral narratives.

Stalin alleged the timing for the proposed amendment led to serious suspicion.

"Why push such a far-reaching decision in the middle of state elections. This appears to be yet another political manoeuvre aimed at shaping electoral narratives, much like earlier attempts to influence women voters ahead of the 2024 Parliament elections," he alleged in a statement titled "This is not reform, this is reengineering power."

Why push such a far-reaching decision in the middle of state elections

Further, he said: "Let me be unequivocal: we strongly support 33 per cent reservation for women. Our support is absolute. But it must be implemented without increasing seats and without punishing states that acted responsibly. If the intent is genuine, nothing prevents immediate implementation within the existing framework"

Demanding fair delimitation, he alleged there was complete opacity on the basis for

delimitation and asked would the exercise rely on 1971 figures from a pre-population control era or the 2021 Census. "Conflicting signals and vague assurances only deepen suspicion." This move would also impose a massive financial burden on states, forcing them to expand or rebuild Legislative Assemblies, all without proper consultation.

"This is a direct assault on cooperative federalism. This is not reform, it is a unilateral, politically driven exercise designed to concentrate power, weaken Parliament, marginalise the South, and undermine social justice," he alleged. "The nation deserves answers: why this undue haste, why shift the goalposts, and who truly stands to benefit?"

AGENCIES

Kerala: Young mother casts vote after hours-long wait over bandaged finger

'Different finger can be inked only if person does not have left index finger'

THRISSUR (KERALA): A young mother in this central district, initially denied the right to vote due to an injured left index finger, finally cast her ballot toward the end of polling in the Kerala Assembly elections on Thursday after a prolonged wait following CEO's intervention.

She held up her bandaged finger, now inked blue, and said she was able to vote after hours of waiting.

Akshaya cast her vote at around 6.15 pm, having arrived at the booth near Kurkancheri at 1.30 pm.

"I don't want anyone else to have such an experience," she told reporters.

She claimed that the presiding officer initially denied her permission to vote, saying that a different finger can be inked only if a person does not have a left index finger.

Referring to the incident in an 'X' post, the office of the Chief Electoral Officer of Kerala said that Akshaya was allowed to vote following a written order from it.



People wait in a queue to cast votes during the Kerala Assembly elections, at a polling station, in Thiruvananthapuram, Thursday

KEY POINTS

- » Akshaya cast her vote at around 6.15 pm, having arrived at the booth near Kurkancheri at 1.30 pm

» Referring to the incident in an 'X' post, the office of the Chief Electoral Officer of Kerala said that Akshaya was allowed to vote following a written order from it

"In Thrissur, a woman named Akshaya was initially stopped from voting because her left index finger was bandaged due to an injury. The Presiding Officer refused to let her vote since the election ink could not be applied to that finger. However, the Chief Electoral Officer intervened and

gave a written order, allowing her to cast her vote," it said in the 'X' post. Earlier, speaking to reporters, Akshaya said she was not being allowed to vote because her left index finger was bandaged due to a serious injury.

At around 5 pm, she told reporters outside the booth

that she had been waiting since 1.30 pm to exercise her right to vote, which the presiding officer also a woman was allegedly denying.

"The presiding officer insisted that I remove the bandage. But I have 15 stitches on my finger after it was injured four days ago when it got caught in the mixer-grinder jar, and it is impossible to remove the bandage. I showed her the medical certificates as well, but she was not satisfied," Akshaya claimed.

"I have been waiting since 1.30 pm without food. I will not leave without voting," she added.

CPI leader V S Sunil Kumar contended that the presiding officer was taking an "arrogant stand" by refusing to allow Akshaya to vote, despite other presiding officers asking her to permit it.

Even the Returning Officer (RO) instructed her to allow her to vote, but the presiding officer remained adamant that the direction be given to her in writing, Kumar claimed.

Puducherry: Brief clash between BJP, Cong workers

MPOST BUREAU

PUDUCHERRY: Groups of BJP and Congress workers were clashing in a booth in Mannadipet Assembly Constituency during the polling on Thursday, police sources said.

Due to the incident, tension prevailed briefly in the booth located in Tirukanoor village.

When a group of BJP workers were standing near a polling booth, those belonging to the Congress objected to their presence there and said that only voters can be present there.

Heated arguments ensued between those groups, and they started attacking each other.

Police intervened and dispersed the crowd using canes and restored normalcy. Polling was not disrupted, the police source said.

Puducherry Home Minister A Namassivayam (BJP) is seeking reelection from Mannadipet constituency, T P R Selvam, former Deputy Speaker of Puducherry Assembly is contesting on Congress ticket.

'ENTRY RESTRICTION ON GROUND OF DENOMINATIONS WILL DIVIDE SOCIETY'

Exclusion from temple will impact Hinduism: SC

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday observed that Hinduism will be adversely impacted and the society will stand divided if temples and “mutts” restrict entry on the grounds of sect and separate denominations inside a religion. A nine-judge Constitution bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant made these oral observations while responding to the submissions of senior advocate C S Vaidyanathan that Article 26(b) of the Constitution gives the right to a religious denomination to manage its own affairs and will have primacy over Article 25(2)(b), which empowers the State to throw open all Hindu religious institutions of public nature. Vaidyanathan appeared in the court on behalf of the devotees of Lord Ayyappa of the

HIGHLIGHTS

- » A nine-judge Constitution bench made these oral observations while responding to the submissions of senior advocate C S Vaidyanathan
- » Vaidyanathan, representing the Nair Service Society and other organisations related to the devotees



of Lord Ayyappa, vehemently put forth the point that they constitute a separate religious denomination and consequently, have the right to manage the affairs of the hilltop temple

historic Sabarimala temple in Kerala. The bench, also comprising Justices B V Nagarathna, M M Sundresh, Ahsanuddin Amanullah, Aravind Kumar, Augustine George Masih, Prasanna B Varale, R Mahadevan, and Joymalya Bagchi, is

hearing petitions related to discrimination against women at religious places, including the Sabarimala temple, and on the ambit and scope of the religious freedom practised by multiple faiths. Vaidyanathan, representing the Nair Service Society and

other organisations related to the devotees of Lord Ayyappa, vehemently put forth the point that they constitute a separate religious denomination and consequently, have the right to manage the affairs of the hilltop temple. He submitted that a denominational temple can give permissive rights and have worship or confine it only to the denomination. To this, Justice Nagarathna said, “There is one apprehension. If you say the right of entry, in the context of (the) Venkataramana Devaru (judgment of the apex court), where they said anybody other than Gowda Saraswat Brahmins is excluded, it will negatively affect Hinduism.” She added, “Everybody must have access to every temple and mutt. Keep aside the controversy in the Sabarimala

judgment (2018). But if you say it is a practice and it is a matter of religion that I will exclude others and only my section, my denomination, will attend the temple and nobody else, that is not good for Hinduism. Let the religion not be adversely affected. It will be counter-productive for the denomination.” Concurring with the view, Justice Kumar said such exclusions will divide the society. Vaidyanathan said in reality, there are private family temples in Kerala where only the members of these families go and these temples serve only their denomination. If a law is to be made, it has to pass the test of public order, morality or health, he asserted. Justice Nagarathna said she was not referring to such private temples and regardless of the question the Devaru judgment decided, “Let the religion not be

adversely affected.” She told Vaidyanathan to keep aside the Sabarimala controversy and emphasised that if the argument is that only Gowda Saraswat Brahmins must come to a temple, the followers of the Kanchi Mutt must only go to Kanchi, they should not go to Sringeri, the followers of Sringeri must not go to Kanchi, then it will affect the religion.” Vaidyanathan said it was a reality and it was for each denomination to think about that. Justice Nagarathna said the State can step in under Article 25(2)(b) to ensure access to temples to all sections of the society. Justice Kumar also told Vaidyanathan, “That is why we said, do not pitch the argument too high,” referring to his contention that Article 26(b) supercedes Article 25(2)(b).

'FLIP-FLOP ON COP'

Cong slams govt for 'withdrawing' bid to host COP33

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Thursday attacked the Centre over India withdrawing its bid to host the COP33 climate summit in 2028, and said it reflects the Modi government's true commitment to the 2015 Paris Agreement both in letter and spirit. The Opposition party said the decision also calls into question the government's true commitment to take on more ambitious carbon mitigation goals in the short and medium term.

Congress general secretary and former Environment minister Jairam Ramesh recalled that on December 1, 2023, the prime minister had announced grandly in Dubai that India would be hosting the annual UN Climate Change Conference of Parties (COP) in India in late 2028.

“Clearly the intention was to milk the global gathering for whatever it is worth in the months before the 2029 Lok Sabha elections like Mr. Modi did by having the G20 Summit in New Delhi a few months before the 2024 Lok Sabha polls,” Ramesh said on X.

“Unexpectedly last night, it was announced that India will not be hosting the high-profile 2028 Conference. No reasons have been given for this sudden decision. But it does reflect on the Modi Govt's true commitment to the 2015 Paris Agreement both in letter and spirit,” the Congress general in-charge communications said.

It also calls into question the Modi government's true commitment to take on more ambitious carbon mitigation goals in the short and medium term, Ramesh said.

INSIGHT

- » It said the decision also calls into question the govt's true commitment to take on more ambitious carbon mitigation goals in the short and medium term
- » Cong general secretary and former Environment minister Jairam Ramesh slammed the government's “flip-flop” on hosting the conference

By 2028, the seventh assessment report of the IPCC (Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change) may get published and this could put greater pressure on India as the Chair of the 2028 Conference to forge a new consensus that would undoubtedly involve a scaling up of ambitions not just for a distant future, he said.

“Incidentally, do we recall what the PM had told a group of children some years ago on his view of climate change? He had remarked that ‘people have changed, climate has not.’ Bizarre!” Ramesh said.

He slammed the government's “flip-flop” on hosting the conference.

Ramesh had on Wednesday night said that he was “surprised” at the development.

“I am very surprised. It was high on the PM's agenda especially since 2029 will be the year of Lok Sabha polls. So atmospherics could have (been) created,” he had said.

India has withdrawn its offer to host the United Nations annual climate Conference Of the Parties (COP33) in 2028, according to sources.

Cong to hold CWC meet today

Cyber fraud racket busted in Kanpur

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

NEW DELHI: The Congress will hold a meeting of its working committee on Friday, where the party's top leadership is expected to deliberate on the government's move to amend the women's reservation law, the proposed delimitation exercise, and the West Asia conflict, sources said.

The meeting comes days ahead of the three-day sitting of Parliament, during which the government is set to bring bills to implement the Women's Reservation Act before the 2029 parliamentary polls and increase the number of Lok Sabha seats to 816, with 273 reserved for women.

The Union Cabinet is learnt to have cleared on Wednesday draft bills which seek to implement the Women's Reservation Act before the 2029 parliamentary polls and increase the number of Lok Sabha seats.

Sources said the Congress Working Committee (CWC) meeting will be held at 3 pm at the party's Indira Bhawan headquarters here.

Top leaders will deliberate on the government's move to amend the women's reservation law, proposed delimitation exercise and the West Asia conflict issue, among other important matters, they said.

The Congress has accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi of using the proposal to amend the women quota law for its early implementation as a poll issue.

The opposition party last week alleged that the government has called a “special session” of Parliament for passing bills related to amending the women's quota law and delimitation to “grab political mileage” in West Bengal and Tamil Nadu polls, which, it claimed, is a “gross violation” of the model code of conduct. MPOST

KANPUR: A highly organised cyber fraud gang operating from Reuna village in Kanpur has been busted, revealing a structured network where members worked in coordination and allegedly targeted at least five victims every day after learning scam techniques in Tamil Nadu and Maharashtra.

Police said several youths from the village had gone to Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra and Gujarat for work, where they came in contact with cyber criminals and learned methods of online fraud. After carrying out multiple incidents there, they returned to Reuna and set up a training centre, inducting more locals into the racket. The gang included not only young men but also individuals above

50 years of age, with specific roles assigned to each member. Despite having education levels between Class 5 and 11, the accused displayed polished communication skills. Their tone often resembled that of government officials, helping them gain the confidence of victims. The gang used mule SIM cards and bank accounts to route transactions and avoid detection. Additional DCP SOG Sumit Sudhakar Ramteke said the group had been active for over a year and executed several frauds in quick succession. Around 10 members were assigned to make calls from different locations, while others kept watch on the outskirts of the village. Police, based on intel, carried out a planned raid and arrested them.

Haryana govt approves ₹1,028 cr expenditure for various projects

CHANDIGARH: The Haryana government has granted approval to expenditure of Rs 1,028 crore for various projects of more than 10 departments, including Haryana Police Housing Corporation and PWD.

Approvals were given at a meeting of the High-Powered Purchase Committee here under the chairmanship of Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini. The projects related to Haryana Police Housing Corporation, DHBVN, HSIIDC, PWD, Haryana Agro Industries Corporation, DMER, FMDA, GMDA, the Irrigation Department, and PHED. Through negotiations with bidders, savings of approximately Rs 96 crore were achieved, it said.

Saini directed officials to ensure regular monitoring of all projects so that they are

completed within stipulated timelines and meet quality standards. He said he would personally review the progress of projects and emphasized that all officers must ensure judicious use of funds. Any negligence in development works will not be tolerated, he said. Besides, procurement processes for 11-meter-long PCC (pre-stressed cement concrete) poles, single-phase and three-phase net meters, and 25 KVA transformers were finalized. Approval was also granted for commodity procurement worth Rs 29 crore under the supplementary nutrition programme as part of the ‘Har-Hith’ retail project of Haryana Agro Industries Corporation. A project worth Rs 5.78 crore was approved for implementing the ‘Student and Faculty

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Thursday said the collective chanting of the Navkar Mantra here for the welfare of the entire world is highly meaningful and relevant at a time when different parts of the world are witnessing conflicts over different ideologies.

Addressing the ‘Vishwa Navkar Mahamantra Diwas’ as the chief guest, Shah said mantras guide human life towards a higher path, awaken our consciousness, and strengthen noble intentions.

He noted that in an era when the world desperately needs peace, collective chanting of the Navkar Mantra can help purify the environment and calm the disturbances of the mind. “It will also strengthen mutual under-



standing, harmony, and sensitivity toward one another,” he said. Shah said the tradition of the Navkar Mantra has persisted for thousands of years, significantly contributed to by the 24 Tirthankaras and their followers.

He stated that our enlightened sages, through tireless penance over generations, have composed these mantras for the welfare of all humanity. “We should accept them with devotion and also incorporate them

into our practice,” he said.

He described the Navkar Mantra as a formless, impartial, and universal prayer that does not discriminate based on time, caste, region, or religion. Such an inclusive and universally accepted prayer is extremely rare in the world, he noted.

According to Shah, this prayer serves as a tribute to the virtues of great souls who have conquered their karma and paved the way for self-realisation and liberation.

Saini reviews ‘Samadhan Shivirs’

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday reviewed the progress of Samadhan Shivirs being organised across the state in a high-level meeting via video conferencing. During the meeting, he directly heard complaints from citizens of various districts and instructed concerned officials to ensure their prompt and effective resolution.

Samadhan Shivirs are organised every Monday and Thursday in the offices of Deputy Commissioners and Sub-Divisional Officers across all districts of the state. In these camps, citizens present their grievances. Complaints that can be resolved on the spot are addressed immediately, while the remaining cases are ensured to be resolved within 7 to 15 days.

MPOST BUREAU

IMPHAL: Defying curfew, thousands of demonstrators across five valley districts of Manipur held protest rallies and burnt tyres against the bomb attack that claimed the lives of two children in Bishnupur district.

At Tiddim Line in Imphal West district, hundreds of people under the aegis of the All Manipur United Clubs Organisation staged a rally from its office near Kwakeithel, denouncing the killings and demanding the immediate arrest of the perpetrators.

Several children, holding posters of the two minors killed in the attack, also attended the rally, which was stopped by security forces from advancing further near Kwakeithel.

On April 7, a 5-year-old boy and his 6-month-old sister were killed when militants hurled a bomb at their house

Later, representatives of AMUCO and others were escorted to meet Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh to address their concerns. The CM said his government was taking all necessary measures in coordination with the Centre to take action against the perpetrators of the attack.

On April 7, a 5-year-old boy and his 6-month-old sister were killed when suspected militants hurled a bomb at their house at Tronglaobi in Bishnupur district.

Soon after the incident, a mob of around 500 protesters stormed a CRPF camp near Gelmol, a few hundred metres from Tronglaobi, and engaged in vandalism and burning of security vehicles. In the ensuing firing by personnel, three protesters died while 30 were injured.

On Thursday, at Samurou in Imphal West district, hundreds of protesters also attempted to head towards the CM's official bungalow but were stopped by police. Protesters also burnt tyres and stopped vehicular movements at Moirang Lamkhai and Ningthoukhong in Bishnupur district.

Similar incidents of tyre burning were reported from Khurai in Imphal East district and parts of Thoubal and Kakching districts.

LPG crisis casts shadow over wedding season

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: A deepening shortage of commercial LPG cylinders is disrupting the wedding season across Uttar Pradesh, with families postponing ceremonies and caterers cutting down menus as the crisis spreads from cities to smaller towns.

The situation is turning grave despite a ceasefire in the Iran-US conflict, which had triggered supply disruptions. Trade bodies warn that even if the ceasefire holds, it may take at least a month for supplies to normalise, raising concerns ahead of the peak wedding period beginning April 15.

From Lucknow to Kanpur, Bareilly, Ghaziabad and Varanasi, caterers say they are struggling to manage events without a steady supply of commercial cylinders. Many have started reducing high-consumption food counters such as chaat, pav bhaji and dosa.

“We cannot rely on wood or coal at most venues because of smoke restrictions. Marriage lawns do not allow it. We are left with no option but to cut down on live counters that require continuous gas,” said a caterer in Lucknow.

Caterers across UP say they are struggling to manage events without a steady supply of commercial cylinders

In Kanpur, the crisis is already affecting business planning. “We are declining bookings or asking families to limit menu items. Without gas cylinders, it is impossible to maintain quality and service,” said a local caterer.

Bareilly traders echoed similar concerns. “The situation is unprecedented during the wedding season. Families are anxious about feeding guests. Some have even discussed postponing events,” said a member of the catering association in Bareilly.

In Ghaziabad, the uncertainty has forced last-minute adjustments. “We are redesigning menus to reduce gas usage. Earlier, weddings had multiple live counters. Now we are cutting them down significantly,” said a caterer.

Govt imposing ‘arbitrary’ conditions for buying crops, says Haryana LoP

CHANDIGARH: Former Haryana Chief Minister Bhupinder Singh Hooda on Thursday accused the government of imposing “arbitrary” conditions on purchase of crops.

The Leader of the Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda alleged that the BJP government in Haryana continues to impose fresh conditions on farmers “with the intent of ensuring that the government does not have to procure crops.”

“Yet another scam ... Instead of actually procuring wheat and mustard, the government is imposing one bizarre condition after another upon the farmers. Conditions such as portal registration, gate passes, biometric verification, tractor registration numbers, general verification, and the requirement of a guarantor are being arbitrarily imposed,” he said.

“Farmers are being treated like criminals; all in all, the government's objective appears to be to keep farmers entangled in this bureaucratic maze so that it can avoid having to procure their crops altogether,” he added.



Hooda, who was speaking to reporters in Naraingarh, claimed that during the Congress government procurement took place smoothly.

He was accompanied by state Congress president Rao Narender Singh and several party MLAs as he toured mandis (grain markets).

On Thursday, Hooda met farmers, labourers, and ‘arhtiyas’ (commission agents) in Naraingarh, Barara and Sadhaura mandis to assess the situation on the ground.

“The BJP government does not want to let go of even a single opportunity to fleece the farmers. This is because it is an anti-farmer government, in every sense,” he alleged.

The Congress leader demanded the government offer a bonus per quintal to the farmers. MPOST

Punjab: Parents to get daily SMS alerts for their children’s school attendance

State government rolls out state-wide attendance-tracking system

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Parents will now receive daily SMS alerts regarding their children's school attendance as the Punjab government on Thursday rolled out a state-wide attendance-tracking system under its Mission Samrath 4.0, a flagship foundational learning programme.

Declaring it as the next big leap in Punjab's ‘Sikhya Kranti’, Education minister Harjot Singh Bains said the state, already ranked number one in the PARAKH (Performance Assessment, Review, and Analysis of Knowledge for Holistic Development) survey, is now moving from recognition to results by tightening classroom accountability and scaling proven teaching practices.

He underscored that the state government raised the education budget to Rs 19,279 crore in 2026-27 from Rs 12,657 crore in 2021-22, ensuring funds reach classrooms rather than remain stuck in files, driving visible transformation from basic infrastructure to measurable learning

KEY POINTS

- » Education minister Harjot Singh Bains said the state is now moving from recognition to results by tightening classroom accountability and scaling proven teaching practices
- » He underscored that the state govt raised the Education budget to Rs 19,279 crore in 2026-27 from Rs 12,657 crore



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

in 2021-22

» Bains noted that the state government has introduced the attendance-tracking system as part of Mission Samrath 2026-27

outcomes across government schools.

Bains noted that the state government has introduced the attendance-tracking system as part of Mission Samrath 2026-27.

“Parents will receive daily SMS alerts on their child's attendance, with notifications for every absence, aiming to boost regular attendance, learning continuity and classroom engagement. Any child absent for seven days will trigger a district-level parent contact, while absence

beyond 15 days will be flagged to state headquarters. This will ensure both learning continuity and child safety,” he informed.

Emphasising the impact of the programme, the minister stated, “Mission Samrath has transformed classroom dynamics. This phase focuses on enhancing teaching quality and accountability through attendance tracking, improved monitoring and sharing the best practices. Our goal is to ensure that every child achieves strong



EDITORIAL

CLICK, DELIVER, REPEAT

India's online retail story is no longer a tale of promise; it is a story of scale. With gross merchandise value touching nearly USD 65–66 billion in 2025 and growing at around 20 per cent, e-retail has moved from the margins to the mainstream of consumption. Yet, the real signal lies not in the headline number but in the direction of travel. A market expected to nearly triple to USD 170–180 billion by 2030 is not merely expanding—it is reshaping how Indians discover, decide and buy. This transformation is unfolding alongside a broader revival in consumption, helped by tax relief, easing inflation and improved sentiment. When private consumption itself accelerates, digital retail becomes both a beneficiary and a catalyst. But beneath the optimism lies a deeper question: is this growth structurally sound, or is it sprinting ahead of its own foundations?

A defining feature of this phase is the rise of quick commerce. What began as an urban convenience has rapidly evolved into a central pillar of India's e-retail architecture. Contributing close to a sixth of total e-commerce value and doubling year after year, quick commerce has tapped into a uniquely Indian advantage—dense cities, relatively low costs, and a young, impatient consumer base. Its expansion into thousands of micro-fulfilment centres across hundreds of cities signals operational ambition. But speed alone cannot be the strategy. The economics of delivering a single item within minutes remain fragile, especially beyond the top metros. As platforms chase scale, the risk is clear: convenience may outpace viability. The test ahead is whether quick commerce can transition from a subsidised habit to a sustainable business model, particularly in Tier II and smaller markets where volumes are thinner and costs harder to absorb.

Equally transformative is the demographic shift driving this growth. India's digital marketplace is increasingly being shaped by Gen Z consumers— young, mobile-first, and heavily influenced by content rather than categories. Their shopping journeys begin not with search bars but with short videos, social feeds and influencer cues. This has profound implications. Commerce is no longer a linear funnel; it is a fluid, often impulsive experience where discovery and purchase collapse into a single moment. Add to this the rise of instant credit and frictionless payments, and the distance between desire and transaction is shrinking rapidly. For businesses, this means rethinking not just logistics but storytelling. For regulators, it raises questions around consumer protection, responsible lending and data use in an ecosystem where persuasion is increasingly algorithmic.

Yet, for all its momentum, India's e-retail penetration remains strikingly low—just about 1.6 per cent of GDP. This is not a weakness; it is a reminder of the long road ahead. The next wave of growth will not come from metros, where adoption is already deep, but from smaller cities and towns. These regions are contributing an increasing share of incremental orders, even as a large portion of internet users remain outside the e-commerce fold. Bridging this gap will require more than faster delivery. It will demand trust, localised supply chains, vernacular interfaces, and reliable last-mile infrastructure. Crucially, it will also require coexistence with offline retail, which continues to dominate a market projected to reach USD 1.6 trillion by 2030. India's retail future is not a zero-sum game between online and offline; it is a hybrid model where both must reinforce each other.

Ultimately, India's e-retail boom sits at the intersection of opportunity and responsibility. The country is poised to become a major driver of global consumption, but scale without stability can be deceptive. Profitability in quick commerce, data governance in digital platforms, fair competition for small sellers, and consumer safeguards in an increasingly immersive marketplace—all demand careful attention. Technology may make commerce feel like a conversation, but the underlying system must remain grounded in accountability. If India can balance innovation with discipline, its e-retail sector will not just grow—it will mature into a resilient engine of economic expansion. If it cannot, the risk is that speed and scale may outstrip sustainability, leaving behind a market that is large, but unevenly built.

SYSTEM CHECK



ALOK RANJAN

THE WRITER IS A FORMER IAS OFFICER WHO SERVED AS THE CHIEF SECRETARY, GOVT OF UTTAR PRADESH

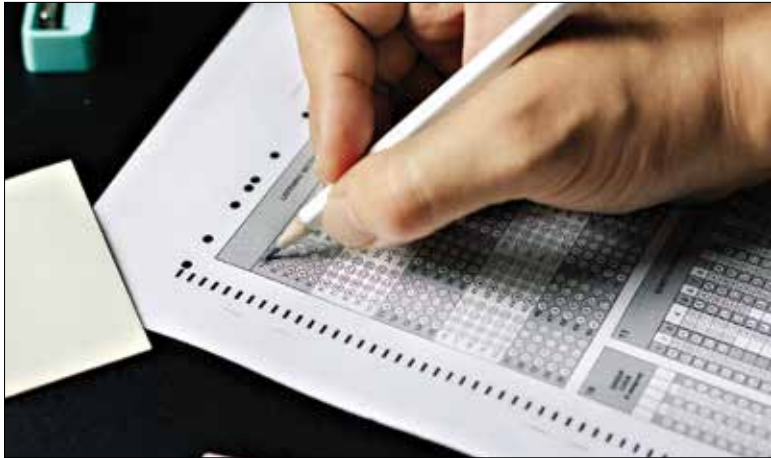
The civil services examination must balance aptitude with equity, ensuring no discipline holds an unfair advantage

CSAT and Structural Bias

Concerns over CSAT, skewed selection patterns, and declining humanities representation raise fundamental questions about fairness, diversity and the future of India's civil services

Any very relevant issue regarding the selection of candidates in the UPSC-held examination for the civil services came up for discussion in the Rajya Sabha the other day. The point of contention was the Civil Services Aptitude Test (CSAT). The civil services examination is held in two parts. The first stage is the preliminary examination, which a candidate must qualify to be eligible to take the main examination. It is basically an exercise in elimination. From about 7–8 lakh students who apply for the civil services, about 80 per cent take the preliminary examination. From these candidates, about 10,000 to 15,000 qualify for the main examination. The idea is that evaluating more than five lakh students for the main examination would become a cumbersome exercise and a logistical nightmare. The marks of the prelims are not added to the overall score, but there is a cut-off, and only candidates who clear this can write the main exam.

Before 1980, the qualifying barrier of prelims was not in existence. A totally different scheme of examination existed. Prelims were introduced from 1980 onwards, and a candidate had to appear for a general studies paper and an optional paper of his choice. This system continued till 2010. Thereafter, the optional paper was removed and replaced by a CSAT paper, with the idea being that the aptitude of a candidate for civil services should also be tested, apart from his subject matter knowledge. The objective behind such thinking had a rationale because any profession requires a certain aptitude, and civil services are no exception. Initially, both general studies and CSAT papers were of 200 marks each, and a combined score was calculated, and a cut-off was declared. There was a lot of agitation against this on the grounds that the system discriminated against non-engineers and humanities students, and also those coming from rural backgrounds. The UPSC responded by making the CSAT paper purely qualifying, meaning that a candidate must score more than 33 per cent marks to be eligible for the mains if their score in the general studies paper is above the cut-off. Now, once again, this issue has been raised that CSAT should be abolished completely, as it is the engineers and science students who are better equipped to handle the pattern of this paper, as evidently it has questions on



The CSAT debate exposes deeper structural distortions in how India selects its future civil servants REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

quantitative aptitude, data interpretation, and logical reasoning, which suits science and engineering students.

The pattern of the CSAT paper is such that it covers language comprehension, logical reasoning, analytical ability, basic numeracy, and data interpretation at the Class 10 level. There are eighty questions with negative marking. Candidates can take this paper in both English and Hindi, but the percentage of those doing so in English is much higher. It is alleged that the CSAT paper is, in some way, responsible for a lesser number of students with Hindi as the medium qualifying. One will have to look at the data to ascertain this, but it is a fact that, of the candidates ultimately selected in civil services, the percentage of those using the Hindi medium is very low. However, there are various reasons for this, which include things like the non-availability of preparation material in Hindi, and CSAT cannot be said to be the only contributory factor.

A scrutiny of the CSAT papers over time shows that ever since CSAT was made only qualifying, the difficulty level of the paper has gone up considerably. In particular, the questions on numeracy are definitely of a higher level than Class 10, and students of humanities, who have been out of touch with mathematics for several years, would find it difficult to handle. There can be no argument

over a civil servant requiring logical reasoning and critical thinking skills to do justice to his job. Also, the ability to interpret data and be comfortable with basic mathematics is an essential requirement, as policymaking today requires an in-depth analysis of data for evidence-based solutions. I feel there is no harm in having a qualifying CSAT paper, but the questions on numeracy should be such that even students of humanities can handle them, and engineers do not have an unfair advantage. The UPSC would need to collect a group of experts to go into this issue, and I am sure a solution can be found which is fair and objective and does not discriminate against anyone.

Moving away from the CSAT paper, I feel the UPSC does need to review the current scheme of the examination because it is a fact that the majority of the candidates being selected today are from engineering or science backgrounds, and the field has considerably narrowed for humanities students. According to the data shared by the government in 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, and 2021, a total of 715, 528, 595, 566, and 497 candidates selected in the civil services have been from engineering and science backgrounds, while the corresponding figures for humanities students were 106, 81, 77, 84, and 88. This is definitely an extremely skewed distribution, which must be looked into. Clearly, the

entire scheme of the examination appears to be working against humanities students. It may be pointed out that the civil services was one of the main career options for students of humanities, and they are being deprived of this by the current examination system.

I am not against students of engineering and science entering the civil services. In fact, most of them are brilliant and bring scientific rigour to administration, which is very much required in the modern age of technological disruption. Their training puts them in a better position to introduce AI and modern technology, along with data-based decision-making, in the civil services. However, the beauty of the civil services lies in its diversity. Students of humanities carry with them a better knowledge of Indian history, culture, and society, and bring to administration a lot of emotional intelligence and a human touch, which is essential for citizen-centric administration. Ideally, the candidates selected should have an optimum mix of engineers and candidates from other disciplines.

It is argued by supporters of the current system that engineers, by their academic training, present their answers in a more logical and analytical manner and are to the point, which enables them to score higher marks. Some others say that after school, some of the best students opt for engineering, which gives them a natural advantage when they choose to write the civil services later on. I am not going into a detailed discussion on these points, but I do feel that the current system is not giving proper representation to students coming from different academic and social backgrounds.

In the light of the above, I feel the time has come for the UPSC to constitute a high-level body of experts to review the current examination scheme. I may also add that it must be evaluated whether the current system is selecting the best talent for civil services. The issues of maximum age allowed and the number of attempts allowed must also be looked into critically. The UPSC must examine why very few candidates are succeeding in their first attempt and why many are spending the best years of their youth in civil services preparation, when their talent can be used in other areas required for the development of India.

Views expressed are personal

Beyond Bins and Landfills

The Solid Waste Management Rules 2026 expand accountability and push circularity, but weak segregation, funding gaps, and limited local capacity threaten meaningful implementation

India generates over 1,70,000 tonnes of municipal solid waste every day—a number expected to cross 3,00,000 tonnes by 2035. Much of this waste still ends up in open dumps or poorly managed landfills, contributing to air pollution, groundwater contamination, and rising public health risks. Despite the ambitious Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016, progress has been uneven—held back by weak segregation, limited processing capacity, and inconsistent enforcement.

The Solid Waste Management Rules 2026 signal a more mature phase in India's waste governance. They move beyond collection and disposal, aiming instead to build a circular system where waste is treated as a resource. But the real question is not what the Rules promise—it is whether India's institutions can deliver.

Fixing Segregation at the Source Every waste system is only as strong as its first step—segregation at source. The 2026 Rules place this at the centre, mandating the separation of biodegradable, recyclable, hazardous, and sanitary waste at the household and institutional levels.

What makes this iteration different is the shift from advisory to enforceable compliance. Households, bulk waste generators, and institutions can now face penalties for non-segregation, while Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) are tasked with ensuring 100 per cent door-to-door collection of segregated waste. Cities like Indore and Surat demonstrate why this matters. High levels of segregation have enabled efficient composting and recycling, drastically reducing landfill dependency. Yet, these successes are exceptions, not the norm.

The challenge remains behavioural. Segregation is not just a regulatory requirement—it is a daily habit. Without sustained citizen engagement and consistent enforcement, even the strongest mandates risk dilution.

Who Owns the Waste?

India's waste crisis is no longer just a municipal issue—it is a production and consumption problem. The 2026 Rules recog-



India's waste rules mark a shift to circularity, but weak systems could derail their promise

nise this by expanding Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) across a wider range of materials, including packaging waste, multi-layered plastics, and selected consumer goods. Producers, importers, and brand owners are now required to collect, recycle, and report waste through traceable digital systems. This is a significant shift: responsibility is being pushed upstream, closer to where waste is generated.

Globally, EPR has proven effective in countries like Germany and South Korea, where recovery rates exceed 60–70 per cent. India's framework, however, remains fragmented across waste streams, creating risks of duplication and regulatory loopholes.

A unified national EPR system—integrating plastics, e-waste, batteries, and other streams—could significantly improve efficiency and accountability.

Digitalisation and Data Transparency

For decades, India's waste systems have operated with limited visibility. Estimates often replace actual data, and “processed waste” is not always verifiable.

While initiatives like Swachh Survekshan have improved visible cleanliness—especially in cities like Indore—evidence

from the Central Pollution Control Board and academic studies points to a “data paradox,” including over-reporting, inconsistent recovery rates, and a focus on surface-level indicators over outcomes like segregation and landfill diversion.

The 2026 Rules attempt to change this by mandating real-time digital tracking of waste flows—from generation to final disposal. If implemented well, this could transform governance.

Data-driven systems can:

- Identify leakages in collection and transport;
- Benchmark performance across cities;
- Strengthen regulatory enforcement.

However, the digital push also exposes a critical gap. Many smaller ULBs lack technical infrastructure and trained personnel. Without parallel investments in capacity building, digitalisation may remain superficial—more reporting than reform.

From Dump Yards to Resource Hubs

India's waste crisis is most visible in its legacy dumpsites, with over 3,000 sites across the country. These are not just environmental hazards—they are sources of methane emissions, fires, and toxic leachate.

The 2026 Rules mandate scientific remediation and closure of these dumpsites, alongside a strong push for decentralised waste processing—including composting, biomethanation, and Material Recovery Facilities (MRFs). This marks an important transition: landfills are no longer central to waste management—they are the last resort.

Yet, remediation is expensive. Estimates suggest that reclaiming legacy dumpsites across India could require thousands of crores in investment. The Rules remain less explicit on financing mechanisms, raising concerns about implementation speed.

Integrating the Informal Sector

Behind India's recycling ecosystem is a vast network of informal waste workers, who recover nearly 20–30 per cent of recyclable waste in some cities. Their contribution is both economic and environmental—yet largely unrecognised.

The 2026 Rules acknowledge their role and call for integration into formal systems. This is a step forward, but the framework lacks clarity on:

- Social security and occupational safety;
- Institutional mechanisms for inclusion;

► Fair compensation within EPR systems.

Without these safeguards, formalisation risks becoming exclusionary. A just transition must ensure that efficiency does not come at the cost of livelihoods.

What Rules Cannot Change on Their Own

While the Rules are technically robust, their success depends on two critical, often overlooked dimensions:

► *Changing Behaviour, Not Just Policy*

Segregation, user fees, and compliance require citizen participation. This demands continuous awareness campaigns, incentives, and behavioural nudges—not just penalties.

► *Strengthening the Weakest Link: ULBs*

Urban Local Bodies remain the backbone of implementation, yet face chronic constraints:

- Limited financial autonomy;
- Shortage of skilled personnel;
- Weak enforcement capacity.

Without empowering ULBs, even the most ambitious policies risk underperformance.

Turning Policy into Practice

The Solid Waste Management Rules 2026 represent a decisive shift from linear disposal to circular management. They expand accountability, integrate producers, and embrace digital governance.

But three priorities will determine whether this shift becomes real:

► **Financing reform:** Dedicated funds for infrastructure, dumpsite remediation, and capacity building;

► **Regulatory convergence:** A unified approach to EPR across waste streams;

► **Local empowerment:** Strengthening ULBs with resources, autonomy, and skills.

India is at a critical moment. With rapid urbanisation and rising consumption, waste is no longer a peripheral issue—it sits at the core of public health, climate resilience, and urban sustainability.

The 2026 Rules provide a blueprint. The challenge now is to translate policy into practice—and compliance into circularity.

Views expressed are personal

Lebanon digs for survivors after deadliest day of renewed war

BEIRUT: Lebanon reeled Thursday after the deadliest day in more than five weeks of renewed war between Israel and Hezbollah, as rescue workers in Beirut and elsewhere searched for survivors and bodies and Israel warned of escalation.

Israeli strikes on Wednesday killed at least 203 people and wounded more than 1,000, Lebanon's health ministry said. Israel's military said it targeted sites of the Iranian-backed Hezbollah militant group, but several strikes hit densely packed commercial and residential areas without warning during rush hour, leading to widespread civilian casualties.

Lebanese President Joseph Aoun called the attacks "barbaric." Israel said the ceasefire in the Iran war doesn't apply in its fight against Hezbollah.

Lebanese Civil Defence spokesperson Elie Khairallah told The Associated Press that a wounded woman was found alive under the rubble overnight in the seaside Beirut neighbourhood of Ain Mreisseh, and a man was found alive in his collapsed apartment building in Beirut's southern suburbs.

Others waited anxiously. Mohammad Chehab, a Syrian man from Deir el-Zour, said six



A woman and an injured man (centre), being rescued by firefighters from a destroyed building that was hit in an Israeli airstrike in Beirut AP/PTI

Key Points

- » Israeli strikes on Wednesday killed at least 203 people and wounded over 1,000
- » Lebanese President Joseph Aoun called the attacks 'barbaric'
- » At hospitals, survivors and doctors described the carnage

of his 10 family members had been found dead in a destroyed building.

"They've been searching all day" for the rest, he said, watching rescue workers dig through

the rubble. At hospitals, survivors and doctors described the carnage.

"I thought I was dead. What happened? A big flash of light struck my face and eyes and I found someone flying over and landing next to me. He was dead," said Rabee Koshok from his bed at Makassed hospital in Beirut. He had been in the commercial district of Corniche al Mazraa when a strike hit a nearby building. Dr. Wael Jarrosh said the hospital had received around 70 injured patients within 10 minutes of the blasts. Two people died and five remain hospitalised, including three in intensive care, Jarrosh said. AGENCIES

China denies reports of support to Iran during war

BEIJING: China's Defence Ministry on Thursday denied reports that Chinese firms provided satellite imagery and semiconductor chip manufacturing equipment to the Iranian military in the midst of the US-Israeli war against Iran.

China firmly opposes the dissemination of speculative and insinuating disinformation targeting China by relevant parties, Defence Ministry spokesperson Zhang Xiaogang said.

He was responding to questions on reports stating that Semiconductor Manufacturing International Corporation (SMIC) had provided chip manufacturing equipment to the Iranian military, and a Chinese commercial satellite company had released images of US military bases in the Middle East.

Zhang said China firmly rejected remarks by US officials who claimed they were aware of actions taken by China and Russia to help Iran and would respond if necessary. AGENCIES

AIMS TO CONSOLIDATE A FRAGILE CEASEFIRE

Pak prepares for crucial US-Iran talks with anxiety

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan on Thursday beefed up security in the national capital as it prepares for high-stakes talks between the US and Iran this weekend with anxiety, amid a warning from top Iranian leadership that Israeli strikes on Lebanon would render negotiations meaningless.

The US and Iran agreed to a two-week conditional ceasefire on Wednesday, followed by a face-to-face meeting in Islamabad to settle the differences and convert the ongoing truce into a lasting peace. Hours before the proposed talks, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said that the Israeli attack on Lebanon blatantly violated the initial ceasefire and would render negotiations meaningless.

"Such actions signal deception and non-compliance, rendering negotiations meaningless. Our hands remain on the trigger. Iran will never forsake its Lebanese brothers and sisters," he said, a day after massive Israeli strikes in Lebanon killed more than 200 people and injured over 1,000.

Meanwhile, Army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir called on Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif and they reviewed the progress of Pakistan's mediation efforts to achieve sustainable peace in the region, said a statement issued by the PMO.

It said the two leaders expressed satisfaction with the de-escalation achieved so far and stressed the need to maintain peace and a ceasefire by all parties. They vowed to provide all support to the US and Iran to reach a peaceful settlement of their conflict.

They "appreciated the restraint demonstrated by all sides and reiterated Pakistan's commitment to facilitate and provide all-out support to both sides to arrive at a peacefully negotiated settlement".

PM Shehbaz renewed his invitation to the arriving delegations and assured them of the highest consideration and support by Pakistan.

The delegations from the rival sides are expected to arrive in Islamabad by Thursday night



Security personnel stand guard amid heightened security measures in the city ahead of US-Iran talks, for which authorities have announced a two-day holiday, in Islamabad on Thursday PTI



Road being blocked as part of heightened security measures PTI



Security personnel deploy in in Islamabad PTI

Highlights

- » PM Shehbaz renewed his invitation to the arriving delegations
- » The delegations from the rival sides are expected to arrive in Islamabad by Thursday night

SOURCES SAY A 30-MEMBER ADVANCE US TEAM HAD ALREADY ARRIVED IN ISLAMABAD

day night to participate in the talks. "Despite skepticism of Iranian public opinion due to repeated ceasefire violations by the Israeli regime to sabotage the diplomatic initiative, invited by Hon. PM Shehbaz Sharif, Iranian delegation arrives tonight in Islamabad for serious talks based on 10 points proposed by Iran," Reza Amir Moghadam, Iran's Ambassador to Pakistan, said in a post on X.

A day earlier, White House Press Secretary Karoline Leavitt said that President Trump was dispatching his negotiating team, led by Vice President JD Vance, to Pakistan for peace talks. However, no time has been announced for the delegation's arrival. Reportedly, Vance will be joined by Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner.

On Thursday, Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi assured US Chargé d'affaires Natalie Baker of foolproof security for all foreign dignitaries when she met him to discuss the preparation for the upcoming talks.

Naqvi assured Baker of the security arrangements taken ahead of the talks and stated that the US delegation members were "our special guests," according to a statement issued by the Ministry of Interior.

"A comprehensive plan has been prepared to provide foolproof security to all foreign guests in every respect," he was quoted as saying by Dawn.

Citing sources, Dawn reported that a 30-member advance US team had already arrived in Islamabad to review security arrangements. AGENCIES

Israel lifts restrictions at holy sites in Jerusalem

TEL AVIV: Worshipers were able to pray again at Jerusalem's holy sites Thursday after Israel lifted restrictions it imposed on large public gatherings throughout the war with Iran nearly six weeks ago.

Access had been prohibited altogether, or restricted to a few dozen faithful at a time, at Christian, Jewish and Muslim sites during the now-paused conflict, when missile attacks from Iran often sent Jerusalem residents into shelters. AGENCIES

Democrats grow bolder on talk about removing President Trump

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump's threats to wipe out Iran, "a whole civilisation," ended the restraint that Democrats have mostly practiced when it comes to questions of removing him from office in his second term.

By the dozens, Democrats came out to say that Trump should no longer serve in the White House, either through the impeachment process or the 25th Amendment, which allows the vice president and the Cabinet to declare that a president is no longer able to perform the job.

While Trump eventually pulled back on his threat and

Calls about Iran flooded into congressional offices, according to the lawmakers

agreed to a two-week ceasefire with Iran, the episode highlighted the growing demands for Democrats to oppose the Republican president in the strongest possible terms.

Calls about Iran flooded into congressional offices, lawmakers said.

The breadth of the Democratic pushback under-

scored the gravity of Trump's apocalyptic threat to a country of more than 91 million people. It also served to raise the domestic political stakes for a conflict that is far from over.

The Trump administration faces mounting calls to testify about the war and justify its demands for hundreds of billions of dollars in new military spending.

"A commander in chief who is truly in control would have never gotten into this colossal mess to begin with," said Senate Democratic leader Chuck Schumer at a news conference Wednesday in New York. AGENCIES

World Briefs

ENVOY PREETI SARAN RE-ELECTED TO KEY UN BODY FOR NEW TERM

NEW YORK: Veteran diplomat Preeti Saran has been re-elected to the prestigious UN Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (CESCR) for a fresh three-year tenure starting 2027, in recognition of her expertise in steering the body through complex global socio-economic challenges. Ambassador Saran is currently serving as the chair of the CESCR, the UN body responsible for monitoring how member nations implement international covenants on economic and social rights. The CESCR operates under the administrative control of the UN Human Rights Commission.

NEPAL'S EX-PM OLI, EX-HOME MINISTER LEKHAK RELEASED ON BAIL

KATHMANDU: Nepal's former prime minister K P Sharma Oli and ex-home minister Ramesh Lekhak were on Thursday released from custody on a personal recognisance bail, police said. Oli, the chairman of the Communist Party of Nepal (Unified Marxist-Lennist), and Lekhak, a senior Nepali Congress leader, were arrested last month on charges of alleged involvement in suppressing the Gen Z movement of September 8 and 9 last year, in which 76 people died. On Monday, a joint bench of the Supreme Court comprising Justices Binod Sharma and Sunil Kumar Pokharel ordered authorities to complete the investigation against Oli and Lekhak by Thursday or release them from custody. Oli and Lekhak have been released on condition.

CHINA CLAIMS ENTIRE SEA

Philippines opens key coast guard base in South China Sea

MANILA: The Philippines unveiled a major coast guard base Thursday on an island in the South China Sea to serve as a "steadfast sentinel of our sovereignty" in a disputed region closely guarded by China's forces. Chinese officials did not immediately react to the Philippines' opening of its coast guard district command on Thitu Island, which has been occupied by Filipino forces and civilians for decades but is also claimed by Beijing.

Chinese coast guard and other government-linked ships frequently patrol outlying waters off the island, which is also claimed by Vietnam and Taiwan. Chinese and Filipino forces have had tense but mostly minor confrontations in outlying waters in the past.

China claims virtually the entire sea, a key trade route, despite a 2016 arbitration ruling that invalidated its expansive claims under the 1982 UN Convention on the Law of the Sea. Beijing did not partici-

THIS IS A PERMANENT STEP FOR US TO SHOW THAT OUR COAST GUARD IS READY TO DEFEND OUR INTEREST IN THE WATERS

pate in the arbitration, rejected its outcome and continues to defy it. Philippine Transport Secretary Giovanni Lopez, Sen Erwin Tulfo and coast guard commander Adm Ronnie Gil Gavan flew to Thitu to unveil the command in a brief ceremony, which was held to coincide with the country's Day of Valour commemoration.

"This is a permanent step for us to show that our coast guard is ready to defend our interest in the waters, our fishermen, their livelihood and, most importantly, our sovereignty," Lopez said. AGENCIES

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 268- Purbasthali Dakshin Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Swapan Debnath

Sl.no.		
1.	Criminal antecedents	
i)	a.	Nature of the offences
		Offences alleged under: Sections 153/153A/294/504 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.
		G.R. Case No. 441/15, (Arising out of P.S No. 169/15, Dated – 19.03.2015, Kalna Police Station).
	c.	Name of the Court
		Learned A.C.J.M, Kalna.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)
		No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any
		Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any
		Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given
		Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere "winnability" at the polls (not more than 100 words)	The candidate is an experiencedgrassroot level political worker with strong public engagement who has great empathy for the people of his electorate. He serves as a voice for the underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)	Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 268- Purbasthali Dakshin Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Swapan Debnath

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O'Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

FOR YEARS, MOSCOW HAS SOUGHT TO TAKE INTERNET UNDER ITS CONTROL

Russia’s internet crackdown leads to a spring of growing discontent

MOSCOW: Several dozen people lined up outside a presidential administration building on a sunny spring weekend in central Moscow as police stood nearby and watched them closely.

The people were lodging complaints about the government's intensifying crackdown on the internet that has seen regular shutdowns of cellphone internet connections, blocked popular messaging apps and cut access to thousands of other websites and digital services.

It was the latest sign of the growing anger and frustration over the restrictions that have disrupted the daily lives



Representational Image

of Russians, hurt businesses and drawn criticism even from Kremlin supporters.

Knowing that any unau-

thorized demonstrations are harshly suppressed, activists have tried to organize authorized rallies, plastered posters

“THE CLAMPDOWN NOT ONLY SERVES TO CONTROL WHAT WEBSITES RUSSIANS CAN SEE, BUT ALSO HAS THROWN DIGITAL LIFE INTO DISARRAY”

on walls and notice boards, and filed lawsuits. Industry leaders pleaded with authorities to repeal the measures.

Even the leader of Armenia delivered a not-so-veiled

barb at Russia during a televised meeting with President Vladimir Putin on April 1. Prime Minister Nikol Pashinyan noted that in Armenia, “our social media, for example, is 100% free. There are no restrictions whatsoever.”

An unsmiling Putin stared at Pashinyan with slightly raised eyebrows.

The clampdown not only serves to control what websites Russians can see, but also has thrown digital life into disarray, making it difficult to order taxis and deliveries, pay for goods and services electronically, and stay in touch with friends and family.

AGENCIES

As fuel prices swing, travellers face higher costs, fewer flight options

WASHINGTON: A new reality is setting in for travellers worldwide: rising fees, fewer flight options and difficult decisions about whether a trip is worth the cost.

The culprit is volatile oil and jet fuel prices, which have spiked sharply since the war in the Middle East began and fighting near the narrow Strait of Hormuz created a chokepoint for global oil supplies.

“Volatility is the real story here,” said Shye Gilad, a former airline captain who now teaches at Georgetown University's business school. “Right now, the airlines are trying to make bets on what they think will happen in the future.”

Airlines are responding cautiously, trimming schedules and adjusting prices in ways that experts say will ripple unevenly



Representational Image

across the market but ultimately affect nearly every type of traveller.

Budget airlines and the price-conscious customers who rely on them are likely to feel the pinch first and most acutely, experts say, but even travellers in premium cabins won't escape the higher prices and less convenient schedules.

Oil prices have swung wildly in recent weeks, briefly topping USD 119 a barrel at one point, and then plunging Wednesday below USD 95 after President Donald Trump announced a two-week ceasefire in the Middle East that briefly reopened the Strait of Hormuz.

AGENCIES

SLIGHTLY BIGGER INTEGRITY CRATER IS ON LUNAR FAR SIDE

Artemis II Astronauts follow Apollo tradition of naming lunar features after loved ones

HOUSTON: Lunar love knows no bounds.

Now hurtling home from the moon, the Artemis II astronauts took a poignant page from Apollo 8 earlier this week, proposing deeply personal names for a pair of lunar craters.

Commander Reid Wiseman and his crew asked permission to name one small, fresh crater after their capsule called Integrity and another after his late wife, Carroll. Canadian astronaut Jeremy Hansen made the request right before Monday's lunar fly-around. Wiseman was too emotional to talk.

Carroll Wiseman, a neonatal nurse, died of cancer in 2020.

“Just for me personally, that was kind of the pinnacle moment of the mission for me,” Wiseman said from space Wednesday night.

During Apollo 8 in 1968,



Artemis II crew, counterclockwise from top left, Mission Specialist Christina Koch, Mission Specialist Jeremy Hansen, Commander Reid Wiseman, and Pilot Victor Glover during a lunar flyby

PTI

astronaut Jim Lovell bestowed his wife's name upon a prominent lunar peak: Mount Marilyn. It was humanity's first trip to the moon and she anxiously awaited his return back home in Houston.

The three Americans and one Canadian of Artemis II are the first lunar visitors since

During Apollo 8 in 1968, astronaut Jim Lovell bestowed his wife's name upon a prominent lunar peak: Mount Marily

Apollo 17 closed out that grand epoch in 1972, and their crater-naming request temporarily left ground controllers speechless.

“It was definitely a very emotional moment. I don't think most of us knew it was coming,” NASA lunar scientist Ryan Watkins told The Associated Press on Wednesday from Johnson Space Center in Houston. “There was not a single dry eye.”

Mission Control's lead scientist Kelsey Young worked with the Artemis II astronauts

before launch, quietly helping them choose the two bright, relatively young craters, which they quickly spotted once they were close enough to the moon through zoom lenses as well as their naked eyes.

Wiseman said his crewmates came up with the idea and approached him about it while they were in quarantine a few days before liftoff. His response: “Absolutely, I would love that, I think that's just the best. And I said, ‘But I can't give the speech, I can't give the talk,’” he recalled during a crew news conference, saying he was too overwhelmed.

Proposed Carroll Crater is at the moon's left limb on the boundary of the moon's near and far sides, and occasionally visible from Earth. It's rather shallow and approximately 3 miles (5 kilometers) across, according to Watkins.

AGENCIES

Nepal’s former speaker among 28 charged in gold smuggling case

KATHMANDU: Nepal's former parliament speaker Krishna Bahadur Mahara and joint secretary Arun Pokharel have been named among 28 accused along with a travel company in a case of gold smuggling.

The Commission for the Investigation of Abuse of Authority (CIAA) filed the corruption case at the Special Court and has named Mahara, his son Rahul Mahara, Pokharel, then customs chief at Tribhuvan International Airport, and others as defendants, accusing them of facilitating the smuggling of gold concealed in electronic cigarettes.

The anti-graft body has estimated the loss to the state at NPR 77.86 million due to the smuggling

and is seeking its recovery from the accused.

According to Ganesh Bahadur Adhikari, assistant spokesperson at the CIAA, the defendants include Chinese, Indian and Belgian nationals among others.

The case came to light on December 25, 2022, when a smuggling network attempted to bring gold hidden inside vape devices from Dubai.

Investigations found that smugglers concealed gold inside 730 vape units packed in 73 boxes and transported them via Tribhuvan International Airport to a customs warehouse.

The gold weighed around nine kilograms, but much of it later went missing.

AGENCIES

Several Nigerian soldiers killed during assault on military base in northeast

ABUJA: Several soldiers were killed during an attempt to raid a military base in northeastern Nigeria early Thursday, the country's military said.

The attack occurred in Beniseikh in Borno state, army spokesman Michael Onoja said in a statement, but it was repelled.

Onoja described the assailants as “terrorists,” which is the term the military uses to describe members of Islamic militant groups in the northeast of the country.

Onoja didn't specify how many soldiers were killed in the latest attack on military bases. He said that Brig. Gen. Oseni Braimah led the troops.

“This attack is a clear indication of the desperation of terrorist elements who, having suffered significant losses

in recent operations, continue to resort to futile and ill-fated offensives against well-defended military positions,” he said.

“Regrettably, the encounter resulted in the loss of a few brave and gallant soldiers who paid the supreme price in the line of duty.”

Nigeria, which is Africa's most populous country, is battling a complex security crisis, especially in the north where there is a decadelong insurgency and several armed groups who kidnap for ransom.

Among the most prominent Islamic militant groups are Boko Haram and its break-away faction, which is affiliated with the Islamic State group and known as Islamic State West Africa Province.

AGENCIES

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-II, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work:

1.	NIT-02	Name of work:- Cess repair work at various locations under ADE/NCZB in jurisdiction of Sr.DEN-II/DLI. Approx cost of work:- 2431156.11 Earnest Money to be deposited: 486200.00
2.	Date & Time of opening of tender	05.05.2026 15:00 Hrs
3.	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen.	www.ireps.gov.in

* The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. * For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. * No manual offers are acceptable. * Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.
No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT-02-26-27-W4I Dated: 08.04.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE
1180/26

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
GREATER LUDHIANA AREA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
GLADA Office, Rajguru Nagar, Ferozepur Road, Ludhiana
Tender Reference No. 560 Dated 09-04-2026
Divisional Engineer (C-II), GLADA, Ludhiana re-invites online bids for the following works:-

1. **Repair and renovation of parking and pavement area by providing & laying bituminous macadam and open graded premix carpet and interlocking pavers in Commercial Pocket opposite Labour Colony Site in U/E, PH-1, abutting 100 feet wide Dugri-Dhandra Road, Ludhiana.**
2. **Construction of boundary wall at Urban Estate Old Sugar Mill Site, Jagraon.**
3. **Hiring of Architect/Architectural Consultant for design, planning and supervision of Officer Residence (GLADA House) Dugri Phase-1, Ludhiana.**

Closing date & time: **22-04-2026 at 1.00 PM**
For details log on to: <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
NOTE: Any corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.
PR-Adv. No :- 1323/12/2026-27/10334

जिला अभियंता का कार्यालय जिला परिषद, खूँटी।
अति अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
ई० टेन्डर रिफरेन्स नम्बर – DOPR/DE/KHUNTI/01/2026-27

क्र.	प्रखण्ड	कार्य का नाम	प्रा० राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Arki	Construction of 12 Additional Classroom at ST Boys Residential High School, Hunth, Arki	2,01,79,800.00	404000.00	10000.00	11 माह

नोट :-
1. वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि एवं समय:- 13.04.2026 के अपराह्न 05:00 बजे।
2. ई-निविदा खोलने की अंतिम तिथि:- 20.04.2026 के अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक।
3. ई-निविदा की परिमाण विपत्र एवं अग्रघन की राशि ऑनलाईन जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय:- 20.04.2026 के अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक (e-Procurement Portal-jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
4. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय:- 22.04.2026 अपराह्न 04:00 बजे।
5. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, खूँटी।
6. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 9430752050
7. जिला परिषद, खूँटी/BCD के समुचित श्रेणी का निवेदन ही मांग्य होगा।
8. उपरोक्त निविदा का नि्यादन **Double Bid System** के अनुसार किया जायेगा।
9. खूँटी जिला अन्तर्गत बैसे सवेदक जिनका कार्य Work Program के अनुसार नहीं चल रहा है। वे इस निविदा में भाग लेने हेतु अयोग्य समझे जायेगे।
10. निविदा खोलने समय पथ निर्माण विभाग, झारखण्ड रॉंची के संकल्प संख्या 2146 (एएर) दिनांक 09.09.2024 में निहित प्रावधान के आलोक में संवेदक द्वारा 10 प्रतिशत से अधिक दर Quote करने Additional Performance Security की राशि निम्नवत जमा करनी होगी।
(i) 10 से 20 प्रतिशत Below की राशि का 20 प्रतिशत तथा
(ii) 20 प्रतिशत से अधिक Below की राशि का 30 प्रतिशत अतिरिक्त जमानत की राशि जमा करना होगा।
11. प्राक्कलित राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है, तदनुकूप ही अग्रघन की राशि (ऑनलाईन) जमा करना होगा एवं इस संबंध में में कोई दावा माध्य नहीं होगा।
12. अधिक जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है।

**जिला अभियंता,
जिला परिषद, खूँटी।**

PR 377029 (District) 26-27 (D)

JHARKHAND STATE SPORTS PROMOTION SOCIETY
(A CCL- State Govt. of Jharkhand Joint Initiative)
C/o Mega Sports Complex, Khelgaon, Hotwar, Ranchi- 835217
Registration under Society Act No.519
Registration under GST No. 20AACAJC1Z9
OUR MISSION- OLYMPIC GOLD
NIT No: CEO/LMC/JSSPS/K/EnM/2026-27/06
Date: 04.04.2026
निविदा सूचना
Notice Inviting Tender NIT 01 of 2026-27 (EnM) Works)
Tender ID : 2026 JSSPS 112431 1
1. Tenders are invited on-line under **Two Part System** on the website <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> as per the eligibility criteria defined in this tender document elsewhere.

Description of work	Location	Estimated Cost of Work (Including GST) (In Rs.)	Earnest Money (In Rs.)	Period of Completion (In Days)
Operation, Maintenance and Repair of Electrical Installations installed at Mega Sports Complex, JSSPS, Khelgaon, Ranchi for a period of 02 (Two) Years	Mega Sports Complex, JSSPS, Khelgaon, Ranchi	1,36,09,782.00	1,70,200.00	730 days

Note: The bid documents will be available on the website(s) <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> and <https://www.jharkhandcslsports.in/> and can be downloaded by the bidder up to the bid download end date. There is no Application Fee.

2. **For Site visit of location of work, the prospective bidder(s) may contact:**

Tender inviting authority Member (E&M), LMC, JSSPS	Contact Person(s)/Tender Dealing Officer(s) Member (E&M), LMC, JSSPS, 8987788600
---	---

3.**Time Schedule of Tender:**

Sl. No.	Particulars	Date	Time
a.	Tender e-Publication date	08.04.2026	10:00 Hrs
b.	Document download start date	09.04.2026	10:00 Hrs
c.	Document download end date	24.04.2026	17:00 Hrs
d.	Bid Submission start date	09.04.2026	10:00 Hrs
e.	Bid submission end date	24.04.2026	17:00 Hrs
f.	Start date for seeking Clarification on-line	08.04.2026	10:00 Hrs
g.	Last date for seeking Clarification on-line	13.04.2026	15:00 Hrs
h.	Date of Pre-bid meeting (if any)	NA	NA
i.	Technical Bid (Cover I) opening date	25.04.2026	17:00 Hrs
j.	Price Bid (Cover II) opening date	To be notified later	To be notified later

Sd/-
Member (E&M) LMC, JSSPS

PR 377017 Art Culture Sports and Youth Affairs(26-27)D

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER MECHANICAL IRRIGATION DIVISION SRINAGAR (190002)
GIST of e-NIT 01 of 2026-27
Invitation for Bids (Notice Inviting Tenders)
e mail Id: to-exenmidrsrinagar@jk.gov.in
Dated: 08/04/2026.
For and on behalf of the Lt. Governor, J&K State, fresh e-tender (in two cover system) in continuation to this office cancelled eNIT No. 03 Dt:20-05-2025, eNIT No. 25 Dt: 18-10-2025, eNIT No. 26 Dt: 18- 11-2025 and eNIT No. 34 Dt: 22-12-2025 are invited on Item rate basis from approved and eligible bidders as defined in the SBD for the following works:-

S. No.	Title	Details
1	Name of the Work	Revamping / Modernization of Marval Lift Irrigation Scheme, Pulwama
2	Source of Funds /Scheme Code	NABARD RIDF XXX (M.H. 4701)
3	Estimated Cost	Rs. 3918.80 Lacs
4	Position of Administrative Approval	Accorded vide Govt. order No. 55-JK (JSD) of 2024 Dated: 04.03.2024 issued under endst. No. JSD-PS03/2/2024-PLG-JSD Dated: 04.03.2024
5	Position of Technical Sanction	Sanctioned vide Chief Engineer Kmr. Irrigation & F C Department Srinagar's order No.64-08 of 2024-25 dt.06.03.2025
6	Position of Funds	Budgetary Provision 2025-26
7	Period of Completion	36 months
8	Cost of Tender Document	Rs. 10000/-in the form of Treasury Challan/ Treasury Receipt for bidders of UT J&K and for U.T. outside bidders may formulate DD/Banker's cheque from any Scheduled bank in favour of Executive Engineer M.L.D. Srinagar (16-digital Account No. 0365010100000188) (Copy shall be uploaded online) Same Tender Fee shall be considered in case of those bidders who have already paid/ furnished in the tender (e-NIT
9	Website/portal address	https://jktenders.gov.in
10	Earnest Money Deposit (in Lakhs)	Rs. 78.50 Lacs
11	Selection Criteria /Eligibility Criteria	As defined in SBD of this work
12	Period of Tender Validity	The tender shall remain valid for 120 days after the bid submission end date.
13	Critical Dates	
a	Publishing date and time of tender amendment documents	08-04-2026 at 05:30 PM
b	Starting date & time for downloading of tender documents	08-04-2026 at 05:30 PM
c	Pre-bid meeting, Site Visit and Clarification to Tender documents	-----
d	Starting date and time of bid submission (Cover No.1 to 2)	08-04-2026 at 05:30 PM
e	Closing date and time of bid Submission (Cover No.1 to 2)	16-04-2026 up to 02:00 PM
f	Date and time of bid opening (Cover No.1)	17-04-2026 at 12:00 PM in the office of the Chief Engineer Kmr, I & F.C. Deptt Rajbagh Srinagar
g	Date and time of bid opening (Cover No. 2)	Will be intimated online after completion of evaluation of Technical Cover (Cover-I)

1. Prospective Bidders within UT of J&K shall submit the tender Document Fee (Non- Refundable/ Non-Transferrable) in the shape of e-Challan/Treasury Challan/ Treasury Receipt pledged in favour of Executive Engineer M.L.D. Srinagar to be deposited under MH-0702-Rev. Misc. While as the bidders outside UT shall submit the same in the form of Demand Draft pledged to Executive Engineer, M.L.D. Srinagar. Same Tender Fee shall be considered in case of those bidders who have already paid/ furnished in the tender (e-NIT 34 of 2025-26) which has been cancelled.
2. Earnest money /Bid Security in shape of CDR/FDR/BC/ Insurance Surety Bond pledged to the Chief Engineer, I&FC Kashmir Payable at Srinagar. The Bank Guarantee should be valid for 45 days beyond bid validity. Same EMD shall be considered in case of those bidders who have already paid/ furnished in the tender (e-NIT 34 of 2025-26) which has been cancelled.
3. Furnishing of hard copies of bids immediately after submission of e-tenders is dispensed with. The same should be obtained only from the bidder who is declared as L1 after opening of financial bids as per Finance Department O.M. No. A/24(2017)-651 Dt: 07-06-2018.
4. The Contractor shall have to arrange all the key construction material for successful completion of the work. No Departmental store shall be issued.
5. Key construction material to be used and arranged by the contractor for execution of work is given below:
a) CEMENT: 43 Grade OPC conforming to IS: 8112-2013 (Latest Version) as required in the work, from Reputed manufacturers of cement approved as currently displayed on cement information system online portal of the Ministry of Industry, Government of India, and holding license to use ISI certification mark for their product. However final selection shall be based on design mix and approval of the Department.
b) STEEL OF ALL SORTS: Fe-500 Conforming to IS: 1786-2008 (Latest Version) from primary producers such as SAIL, TATA TISCO, JINDAL PANTHER or RINL only as approved by the Ministry of Steel, Govt. of India
c) STRUCTURAL STEEL OF: Grade E250 Conforming to IS: 2062-2011 (Latest Version) from primary producers such as SAIL, TATA, JINDAL or RINL only as approved by the Ministry of Steel, Govt. of India.
6. The bidder should have valid dealership or authorization issued by original pump manufacturer (OEM). The same is to be uploaded in Technical Bid (cover 1st) necessarily without which the bid shall be outrightly rejected.
7. Further details can be seen in bidding document available on [website:www.jktenders.gov.in](http://www.jktenders.gov.in)
8. Conditional bids and the bids not meeting the qualifying criteria shall be summarily rejected.
9. The authority reserves the right to cancel any or all bids without assigning any reason.
10. Subsequent Corrigendum/Addendum if any shall be published on above website.
11. All the bidders shall mandatorily upload the Bank Account details which is linked with GSTIN as per the J&K Finance Departments Circular No. 01 (Adm) FD of 2025, dated: 08-07-2025. No payments shall be released to any other Bank Account except the one linked with GST registered No. of the successful bidder.
DIP No:DIK-246/26
No:181-202
Dated:08/04/2026

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
M.L.D. Srinagar

India emerges stronger amid global shocks: Shaktikanta Das

India’s real GDP growth stood at 7.6 per cent in FY26, with an average growth of 7.8 per cent over past five years, the former RBI governor said

OUR CORRESPONDENT

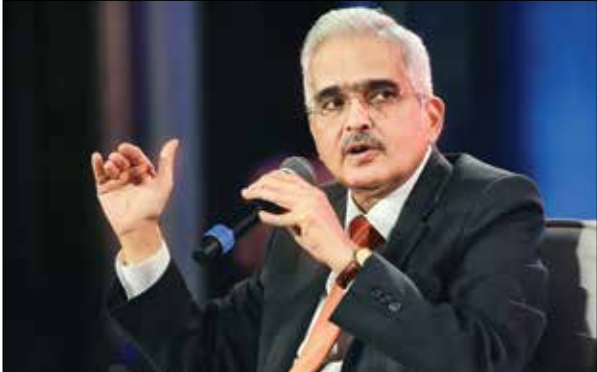
NEW DELHI: India has consistently shown remarkable resilience during global crises, not only surviving them but also transforming through the turbulence to emerge stronger, said Shaktikanta Das, Principal Secretary to the Prime Minister, on Thursday.

Addressing the AIMA National Leadership Conclave here, Das said, “Through each crisis, India has not merely survived. It has in fact emerged remarkably and measurably stronger”.

He noted that the global economy continues to face an “unsettled and charged environment” marked by geopolitical fragmentation, supply chain disruptions and uneven growth, with risks “decisively skewed to the downside”.

Against this backdrop, the former RBI governor highlighted India’s strong economic performance, stating that real GDP growth stood at 7.6 per cent in FY26, with an average growth of 7.8 per cent over the past five years.

“India’s resilience does not alone explain the full story. India did not just endure the period of turbulence. It trans-



Shaktikanta Das, Principal Secretary to the Prime Minister

He noted that the global economy continues to face an ‘unsettled and charged environment’ marked by geopolitical fragmentation, supply chain disruptions and uneven growth, with risks ‘decisively skewed to the downside’

formed through it,” he said.

He also noted that several factors underpin this resilience, including macroeconomic stability, policy consistency, infrastructure-led development and strong domestic demand.

The top official emphasised the importance of inflation control, describing it as critical for economic stabil-

ity. “Inflation has often been described as a tax on the poor. A low inflation would mean increasing the spending power in the hands of the consumer,” Das said.

Highlighting India’s policy response during crises, he said the country adopted a calibrated approach. “Fiscal and monetary expansion were fol-

Highlights

» ‘India’s resilience does not alone explain the full story. India did not just endure the period of turbulence. It transformed through it’

» Several factors underpin this resilience, including macroeconomic stability, policy consistency, infra-led development and strong domestic demand, he noted

» On the external front, he said India’s strategic autonomy and diversified partnerships have reduced overdependence on any single country

lowed by a timely rollback, thus froth was not allowed to accumulate or overrun the system”.

Das also pointed to structural transformations in the economy, including rapid digitalisation, expansion of infrastructure and growth in manufacturing sectors, such as electronics and semiconductors.

On the external front, he said India’s strategic autonomy and diversified partnerships have reduced overdependence on any single country.

“We take decisions in our best national interest,” he said.

He further described India as a safe anchor in a volatile global environment, offering stability, predictability and long-term growth prospects.

“India is now seen as a safe anchor at a time when much of the world is marked by conflict, volatility and policy uncertainty,” he said.

Looking ahead, Das said India’s growth drivers, ranging from demographic advantage and rising consumption to infrastructure push and digital public infrastructure, are structural and durable.

“These are not cyclical tailwinds. They are structural, compounding and durable,” he said. He also advised businesses to build resilience, strengthen balance sheets, diversify supply chains and invest for future readiness.

Das expressed confidence in India’s trajectory, stating that “even with all the turbulence around the world, India will find a way to triumph and emerge stronger”.

Sensex tanks 931 pts, Nifty sinks to 23,775 on ceasefire uncertainty

Rupee appreciates by 3 paise to 92.51 against US dollar

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Equity benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty buckled under heavy selling pressure to close with deep cuts on Thursday after investors pared exposure to financial, banking, and IT stocks as renewed tensions in West Asia faded the ceasefire-led optimism.

Weak trends in Asian and European markets, a jump in crude oil prices and uninterrupted foreign fund outflows also made investors jittery in the domestic market.

Snapping its five-session winning run, the 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 931.25 points or 1.20 per cent to settle at 76,631.65.

During the day, it dived 1,215 points or 1.56 per cent to 76,347.90.

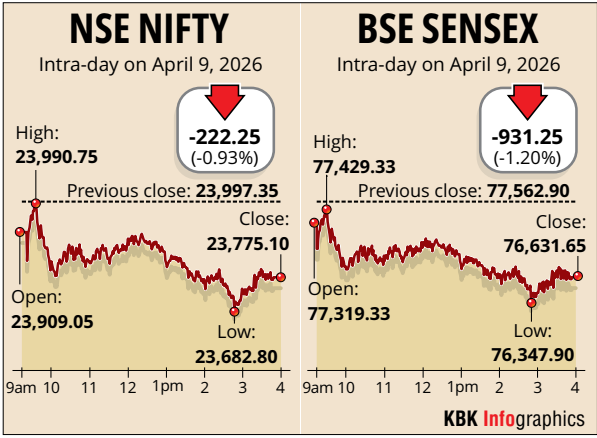
The 50-share NSE Nifty declined 222.25 points or 0.93 per cent to end at 23,775.10.

The ceasefire deal appeared to be at risk after Iran closed the Strait of Hormuz again in response to Israeli attacks on Lebanon.

From the 30-Sensex firms, InterGlobe Aviation, Larsen & Toubro, Eternal, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank and Kotak Mahindra Bank were among the major laggards.

On the other hand, Bharat Electronics, Power Grid, NTPC and Tata Consultancy Services were among the gainers.

The BSE SmallCap Select index climbed 0.26 per cent,



From the 30-Sensex firms, InterGlobe Aviation, L&T, Eternal, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank and Kotak Mahindra Bank were among the major laggards

and the MidCap Select index went up by 0.15 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, BSE Top 10 Banks tumbled 1.86 per cent, Private Banks index (1.75 per cent), Bankex (1.58 per cent), Financial Services (1.41 per cent), PSU Bank (1.21 per cent), Services (1.04 per cent) and MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt (0.88 per cent).

However, Capital Goods jumped 1.64 per cent, Metal (1.30 per cent), Power (1.27 per

cent), Hospitals (0.75 per cent), Healthcare (0.74 per cent), Utilities (0.69 per cent), Telecommunication (0.42 per cent).

The rupee settled with a marginal gain of 3 paise at 92.51 against the US dollar on Thursday, backed by a weak American currency, even as the situation in West Asia remains fragile, keeping investors wary of the opening of the Strait of Hormuz.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 3.27 per cent to \$97.85 per barrel.

FIIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 2,811.97 crore on Wednesday, according to exchange data. Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs), however, bought stocks worth Rs 4,168.17 crore.

On Wednesday, the Sensex jumped 2,946.32 points or 3.95 per cent to settle at 77,562.90. The Nifty soared 873.70 points or 3.78 per cent to end at 23,997.35.

Raman Krishnan takes charge as GM of MCF, Raebareli



RAEBARELI: Raman Krishnan has taken charge as General Manager of Modern Coach Factory (MCF), Raebareli on Thursday.

A 1990-batch officer of the Indian Railway Service of Mechanical Engineers (IRSME), he brings over three decades of experience in Indian Railways.

Prior to this, Krishnan served as Chief Administrative Officer at Integral Coach Factory.

He has held key roles including Chief Mechanical Engineer in South Western Railway, Chief Workshop Engineer at Rail Wheel Factory, and faculty at IRIMEE, Jamalpur.

He has also worked in Southern Railway and Rail Coach Factory, Kapurthala, across various technical and managerial positions.

Krishnan has undergone advanced management training in Singapore and Malaysia, and at the National Academy of Indian Railways, Vadodara. He is a recipient of multiple awards, including the General Manager’s Award and Principal Chief Mechanical Engineer’s Award. *MP*

Dalcore to invest ₹500 cr to build branded luxury homes in Gurugram

NEW DELHI: Realty firm Dalcore on Thursday announced a Rs 500 crore investment to develop a luxury housing project in Gurugram in partnership with global design brand YOO.

The project, ‘The Falcon’, will come up on a 2-acre plot along Golf Course Road and feature a single 165-metre-high tower — the tallest on the stretch.

It will offer 96 units, including 93 apartments and three penthouses, with a total built-up area of 5 lakh sq ft. Prices are expected to start at Rs 10 crore.

Founded by Philippe Starck and John Hitchcox, YOO has delivered over 85 projects across 36 countries. This marks its first branded residential project in North India.



Dalcore Managing Director Sidharth Chowdhry said the project aims to bring globally recognised design concepts to premium homebuyers, combining Starck’s design vision with architectural inputs from UHA. The company expects to generate around Rs 1,450 crore in revenue. This is Dalcore’s debut project, while property consultant Cushman & Wakefield is the strategic marketing partner. *MP*

FIEO sees 2-3% fall in exports during 2025-26

LUDHIANA: The country’s merchandise exports are expected to register a fall of 2-3 per cent in 2025-26 due to global economic uncertainties, aggravated by the West Asia crisis, according to FIEO.

Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO) President S C Ralhan said that the crisis may have led to a decline in shipments by 7-8 per cent in March.

The joint attack launched by the US and Israel on Iran on February 28 severely disrupted the country’s exports to West Asia, pushed up shipping freight, air transport prices and insurance costs.

Disruptions in the movement of oil and gas from Middle East countries have also led to an increase in the prices of raw materials such as steel, plastic and rubber, Ralhan said.

“Exports are expected to record a fall of 2-3 per cent

last fiscal and 7-8 per cent in March,” he told reporters here.

However, he said that India’s goods and services exports are likely to rise by 5-6 per cent. Exports stood at \$825 billion in 2024-25 (\$437 billion goods and \$388 billion services).

The final numbers will be released by the commerce ministry on April 15.

Ralhan expressed hope that ship movements would resume soon following the ceasefire announcement for two weeks between the US and Iran.

He suggested that the government should look into issues such as high interest rates, simplification of advance authorisation redemption, and harmonisation of nomenclature between the Directorate General of Foreign Trade and customs.

Advance Authorization Redemption is a term used in India’s foreign trade policy

(FTP). It is the process of closing or fulfilling an advance authorization licence after meeting its export obligation.

Advance authorization allows exporters to import raw materials duty-free on the condition that they will use those inputs to manufacture export products.

“We need a rate of interest at par with international standards, which is 2-4 per cent. In India, it is about 8.25 per cent after subsidy and without collaterals, it goes to about 12 per cent,” Ralhan said.

He added that it would take a few months for exports to stabilise from the West Asia crisis.

The announcement of a ceasefire between the US and Iran would provide immediate relief to exporters by easing shipping disruptions, the FIEO President said.

The conflict has posed challenges for exporters to ship

goods to the Gulf region, with which India had a bilateral trade of \$178 billion in 2024-25 (\$56.87 billion exports and \$121.67 billion imports).

The government has rolled out a host of measures to cushion exporters from the impact of the conflict in the Gulf region, a key market for India’s exports such as gems and jewellery, rice and pharma, which were valued at about \$57 billion in 2024-25.

The major sectors which are under stress include petroleum products, chemicals and plastics, engineering goods, rice, pharma and gems and jewellery.

The six countries in this region are the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Oman, Bahrain, Qatar and Kuwait. The region is the largest agri-export destination for basmati, marine products and fresh produce, he said, adding that air and sea freight costs surged for fresh fruits and vegetables in transit. *PII*

ITAT rejects Surat trader’s ₹80L demonetisation claim

NEW DELHI: The Income Tax Appellate Tribunal (ITAT) has dismissed a Surat-based businessman’s appeal over Rs 80 lakh deposited during the 2016 Indian demonetisation, ruling against his explanation for the cash.

The case dates back to November 2016, when the government scrapped Rs 500 and Rs 1,000 notes, re-quiring citizens to deposit old currency.

The businessman claimed the Rs 80 lakh deposited was with-drawn earlier from his own bank account for a property deal that later fell through.

However, the Income Tax Department questioned the source of funds, stating the taxpayer failed to establish the identity, creditworthiness and

genuineness of the transaction. It argued the explanation lacked supporting evidence and was not legally tenable.

The taxpayer contended that his accounts were audited and not rejected under Section 145, and therefore Section 68—dealing with unexplained cash credits—should not apply. After hearing arguments, the ITAT Surat bench (I.T.A. No. 417/ SRT/2025) ruled on March 26, 2026, against the taxpayer.

Mihir Tanna of S K Patodia LLP said such cases hinge on documentary proof & credibility of claims, noting that courts assess both legal provisions and the probability of transactions when adjudicating disputes involving large cash holdings. *AGENCIES*

FICCI FLO launches its 22nd Chapter in Raipur

RAIPUR: The FICCI Ladies Organisation (FLO) has launched its 22nd Chapter in Raipur, Chhattisgarh, expanding its footprint to promote women’s entrepreneurship and leadership across India.

With headquarters in New Delhi and a network of over 15,000 members across 21 chapters, FLO has played a key role in advancing women’s economic empowerment for over four decades.

The Raipur chapter aims to create opportunities for women entrepreneurs and professionals, supporting inclusive growth in the state. The launch event was attended by Raipur Mayor Meenal Choubey and Sangita Reddy, along with FLO leadership, governing members, and women entrepreneurs.

FLO National President Puja Garg said the expansion reflects the organisation’s commitment to equipping women with mentorship, networks, and resources to succeed. She highlighted Raipur’s entrepreneurial potential and its role in driving regional growth.

Poonam Agrawal, Chairperson Designate and Founder Chair of the Raipur chapter, said the initiative will build a strong support ecosystem, enabling women to connect, collaborate, and scale their ventures through training, mentorship, and access to finance and technology. *MP*

FICCI flags West Asia conflict risks, outlines action roadmap

Report assesses the cascading impact on India’s economy, across energy, logistics & manufacturing supply chains

NEW DELHI: The Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce & Industry (FICCI) on Thursday released a report titled ‘West Asia Conflict: Implications for India and Imperatives for Industry and Government’, flagging rising economic risks from ongoing geopolitical tensions and outlining a coordinated response strategy.

Based on consultations with industry stakeholders, the report assesses the cascading impact on India’s economy, particularly across energy, logistics and manufac-



turing supply chains. It notes early signs of stress and calls for proactive steps to address immediate risks while building long-term resilience.

For industry, FICCI rec-

CLOSER LOOK

» Report notes early signs of stress & calls for proactive steps to address immediate risks while building resilience

» For industry, FICCI recommends two-pronged approach focused on financial stability and operational continuity

» The report calls for continued govt support, including stable energy supplies, faster customs clearances, and financial relief for MSMEs

ommends a two-pronged approach focused on financial stability and operational continuity. Companies are advised to adopt scenario-based planning, secure additional fund-

ing, hedge currency risks, and monitor the financial health of suppliers and customers. Strengthening insurance coverage and cybersecurity is also highlighted.

On operations, firms are urged to align production with input availability, optimise logistics, and enhance coordination with global shipping lines.

Diversifying energy sources—through renewables, bio-fuels and electrification—along with improving energy efficiency, is seen as critical.

In the medium to long term, the report stresses supply chain diversification, reduced dependence on specific geographies, and greater domestic sourcing. It also highlights the need to accelerate energy

transition, invest in green technologies, and strengthen logistics through alternative trade routes and digital tools.

On the policy front, the report calls for continued government support, including stable energy supplies, faster customs clearances, and financial relief for MSMEs.

Long-term priorities include expanding strategic reserves, boosting renewable energy, strengthening manufacturing ecosystems, and improving trade infrastructure to enhance India’s economic resilience. *MP*

Sanjay Khanna appointed Chairman & MD of BPCL

NEW DELHI: Veteran energy executive Sanjay Khanna has been appointed chairman and managing director of Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL), the country’s second-largest state-run fuel retailer.

He previously served as Director (Refineries) and was holding additional charge as CMD following G Krishnakumar’s retirement in April 2025.

BPCL said Khanna assumed office on April 9, 2026, after approval from the Ministry of Petroleum and

Natural Gas. His tenure will run until May 31, 2029, or until further orders.

A chemical engineering graduate from the National Institute of Technology, Tiruchirappalli, with a post-graduate degree in finance from the University of Mumbai, Khanna has led key BPCL units, including Kochi and Mumbai refineries.

He was selected by a search-cum-selection committee after earlier efforts by the Public Enterprise Selection Board failed to finalise a candidate. *AGENCIES*

India caps refinery margins after windfall tax to cushion fuel losses

Govt last month imposed additional excise duty on exports of diesel & ATF to curb windfall gains by refiners & boost domestic fuel availability

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: After imposing a windfall tax on fuel exports, India has moved to cap refinery margins in a bid to offset losses on domestic fuel sales, sources said.

The war in West Asia has had two prolonged impacts - spike in international oil prices that has led to record losses on petrol and diesel sales as retail rates have not changed in tandem. Secondly, it has given bumper margins to refineries, who irrespective of retail price freeze, price their products at imported cost.

The government last month imposed a Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED) on exports of diesel and ATF, as part of efforts to curb windfall gains by refiners and boost domestic fuel availability amid tight global markets. Alongside, refining margins have been capped at \$15 per barrel, with any earnings above that threshold treated as a discount on fuel sold to state-run marketing companies, effectively transferring excess gains to offset retail losses, sources said.

The oil marketing companies (OMCs) on March 26 fixed rates for petroleum products that are at a discount of up to



For the second half of March, a discount of Rs 22,342 per kilolitre (Rs 22.34/ litre) was fixed on diesel to bring down the RTP of Rs 85,349 per kl to Rs 63,007 per kl

Rs 60 per litre to their imported cost. OMCs have decided to fix a discount on the refinery transfer price (RTP) - the internal price at which refineries sell fuel to marketing arms - to effectively pay refineries less than the import-parity cost of the fuels like petrol and diesel.

For the second half of March, a discount of Rs 22,342 per kilolitre (Rs 22.34 per litre) was fixed on diesel to bring down the RTP of Rs 85,349 per kl to Rs 63,007 per kl.

For the first fortnight of April, the discount on diesel has

been fixed at Rs 60,239 per kl to lower RTP from Rs 146,243 per kl to Rs 86,004 per kl. On ATF, the RTP has been slashed to Rs 76,923 per kl from Rs 127,486 per kl after considering a discount of Rs 50,564 per kl.

The RTP for kerosene after a discount of Rs 46,311 per kl has been fixed at Rs 77,534 per kl from Rs 123,845 per kl, they said.

Traditionally, petrol and diesel in India have been priced on an import parity basis, meaning the fuels are valued as if they were imported, even though

Highlights

» For the first fortnight of April, discount on diesel has been fixed at Rs 60,239/kl to lower RTP from Rs 146,243/kl to Rs 86,004/kl

» On ATF, the RTP has been slashed to Rs 76,923 per kl from Rs 127,486 per kl after considering a discount of Rs 50,564 per kl

» The RTP for kerosene has been fixed at Rs 77,534 per kl from Rs 123,845 per kl

it is primarily crude oil that is brought into the country and refined locally. Refinery transfers of these products to oil marketing companies were based on import parity price (IPP) until June 2006, after which the government adopted trade parity pricing (TPP) - a benchmark that assigns 80 per cent weight to import parity price and 20 per cent to export parity price.

This pricing protected refinery margins, particularly of standalone refiners who didn't have the cushion of marketing margins on petrol and diesel,

whose pricing was deregulated by the government in 2010 and 2014, respectively. Despite being freed, petrol and diesel prices have not exactly moved in line with cost and have been on a freeze since April 2022, with OMCs absorbing losses when crude oil prices rise and making bumper profits when rates fell.

The discount on RTP comes as under-recoveries or losses on petrol and diesel have widened, sources said adding unlike cooking gas LPG, the government does not compensate OMCs for losses on auto fuels.

Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas in a post on X on April 1 had stated that, "With global petroleum prices up by up to 100 per cent in the last one month, PSU OMCs are incurring under-recoveries of Rs 24.40 per litre on petrol and Rs 104.99 per litre on diesel at retail selling price (RSP) level as on 01.04.2026."

OMCs feel the freezing RTP would effectively distribute the financial burden across the refining ecosystem, but analysts say it could disproportionately affect independent refiners with limited downstream marketing exposure. Also, it will distort the commitment of market price to standalone and private refiners, sources added.

TCS net profit rises to ₹13,718 cr, revenue jumps to ₹70,698 cr in Q4

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Country's largest IT services company TCS on Thursday reported a 12.22 per cent jump in its March quarter net profit at Rs 13,718 crore.

The Tata Group company reported a net profit of Rs 12,224 crore in the January-March period last year and Rs 10,657 crore in the preceding December quarter.

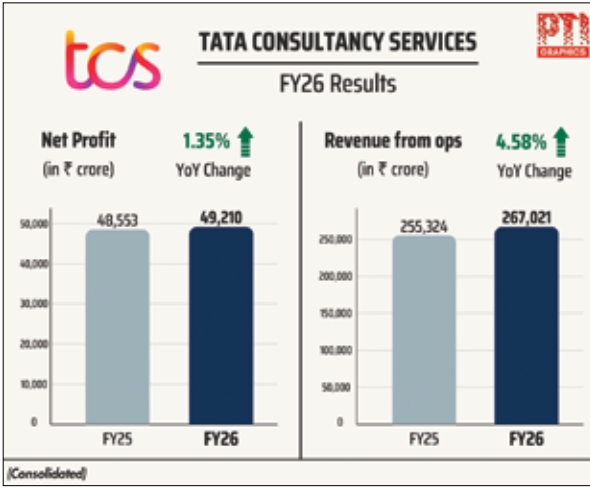
For fiscal year 2025-26, TCS' PAT inched up 1.35 per cent to Rs 49,210 crore, as against Rs 48,553 crore in FY25.

From a headcount perspective, the company added 2,356 jobs in Q4 to take the overall number of employees to 5,84,519 as on March 31, 2026, marking the first quarter of net addition after two consecutive quarters of a fall.

The company's employee base declined by 23,460 in FY26, a year in which it began an exercise to cut 12,000 jobs because of changes in the technology landscape.

TCS is the first company in the \$315 billion Indian IT sector to report its earnings for the fiscal year 2025-26, which saw a deepening of artificial intelligence (AI) technologies and subsequent concerns on the employee intensity in the sector which produces one of the best quality jobs in the economy.

In the reporting quarter, its revenue from operations jumped 9.64 per cent to Rs 70,698 crore from the Rs 64,479 crore in the year-ago period,



For FY26, TCS' PAT inched up 1.35 per cent to Rs 49,210 crore, as against Rs 48,553 crore in FY25

while the same for the full fiscal jumped 4.58 per cent to Rs 2.67 lakh crore.

The operating profit margin expanded to 25.3 per cent in the March quarter, up from 24.2 per cent in the year-ago period.

Its chief executive and managing director K Krithivasan said this is the third consecutive quarter of sequential growth and added that the momentum was broad based across major markets and industries.

"While the macro-economic headwinds continue, we see sustained customer conviction in technology investments,

which positions us well for the opportunities ahead," he said.

It signed new deals of \$12 billion in the three months, led by North America at \$5.4 billion and the banking, financial services and insurance business at \$2.8 billion.

The voluntary attrition stood at 13.7 per cent at the end of the quarter, and the company's chief human resources officer Sudeep Kunnunall said it will be reverting to implementing salary hikes across the organisation from April 1 onwards.

Its board has proposed a final dividend of Rs 31 per share which will have to be approved by shareholders at the annual general meeting.

The company scrip closed 1.09 per cent up at Rs 2,587.75 a piece on the BSE on Thursday, as against a 1.20 per cent correction on the benchmark.

Silver, gold rally falters as tensions in West Asia resurface

NEW DELHI: Silver prices declined by Rs 7,800 to Rs 2.43 lakh per kilogram in the national capital on Thursday while gold fell to Rs 1.54 lakh per 10 grams as investors booked profits amid concerns over the durability of the fragile ceasefire in West Asia.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the white metal depreciated by Rs 7,800, or 3.10 per cent, to Rs 2,43,200 per kg (inclusive of all taxes) from Wednesday's closing level of Rs 2,51,000 per kg.

Gold of 99.9 per cent purity also decreased by Rs 1,500, or nearly 1 per cent, to Rs 1,54,900 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes).

The yellow metal had finished at Rs 1,56,400 per 10 grams in the previous market session.

Analysts said precious metals witnessed selling pressure as uncertainty around the ceasefire between the US and Iran weighed on investors' sentiment.

In the global markets, spot gold went up by \$21.28, or 0.45 per cent, to \$4,740.63 per ounce while silver was trading marginally higher at \$74.12 per ounce.

"Gold has extended its gains to the fourth straight day on dollar weakness," Praveen Singh, Head of commodities at Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said.

India grants waivers for some ships to deliver Iran cargoes, say sources

NEW DELHI: With a view to speeding delivery of energy supplies from the Gulf, India recently granted waivers to allow two Iranian cargoes aboard an older tanker and another under international sanctions to enter its ports, two officials familiar with the matter said.

The world's No.2 importer of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG), India is facing its worst gas crisis in decades, with the government rationing supplies to industry to ensure households are supplied with the cooking gas, Reuters reported.

India recently permitted the LPG tanker Aurora to dock in the southern port of Mangalore despite it being about 30 years old, one of the sources said.

A crude oil tanker, the Jaya, despite being under US sanc-



tions, was also permitted to unload, the other source said.

The officials said the approvals were being made on a case-by-case basis and only vessels meeting safety parameters were being considered for waivers.

India typically requires tankers that are more than 20 years old to have seaworthiness certification from a member of

the International Association of Classification Societies, or an entity authorised by India's maritime administration.

It also typically bans vessels subject to US sanctions from its ports.

Iran has sidestepped Western sanctions to deliver its oil in recent years by deploying a "shadow fleet" of older tankers lacking such paperwork. AGENCIES

Commerce Ministry discusses shipping, port and packaging challenges with exporters

NEW DELHI: The Commerce Ministry on Thursday held meetings with exporters to discuss challenges related to packaging, shipping and port operations amid the West Asia crisis, an official said. Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal chaired two meetings, which were attended by representatives of export promotion councils and commodity boards.

The commerce secretary, Shipping Secretary Vijay Kumar, shipping lines, ports, Export Promotion Councils (EPCs), and exporters discussed issues related to ports and shipping in the context of the ongoing challenges, and to explore feasible solutions, the industry

officials said.

EPCs were requested to share specific issues or challenges being faced at ports so that these may be taken up effectively during the discussion.

The joint attack launched by the US and Israel on Iran had led to severe disruptions in the movement of ships in international waters, particularly to the West Asian nations.

The other meeting was held to deliberate on key packaging challenges faced by the industry arising from the evolving situation in West Asia and to identify operational responses. According to industry players, rising prices of petrochemicals have led to a surge in raw material

costs, resulting into a 50 per cent hike in the prices of packaging materials in the past few weeks.

Issues which figured in this meeting included measures to enhance food exports in the current global supply scenario, strategies to address shortages of packing materials across sectors and key trade issues arising from the Middle East crisis, along with suggested remedial measures.

Exporters suggested that the waiver granted by ports and other stakeholders should be passed transparently to the trade, and it should be an upfront benefit by all agencies rather than first charging and then refunding. They also urged

NEW DELHI: The World Bank on Thursday said India is well placed to weather the current global energy shock with ample buffers, including high foreign exchange reserves, fiscal space and low inflation, which will support growth despite global headwinds.

Addressing a conference a day after raising India's GDP growth projections for the current fiscal to 6.6 per cent, the World Bank said India had dealt well the trade turbulence last fiscal and the Indian economy entered the current Middle East crisis, which has led to volatility in oil markets, "from a position of strength".

World Bank Regional Practice Director, Prosperity, for South Asia, Sebastian Eckardt said, "India has strong policy buffers, high Forex reserves, fiscal space, to provide support as

needed, as well as low inflation, and strong goals moment going into this current shock. And that strong growth momentum is supported by gross positive policies, including the EU FTA the new labour, all of these things, of course, reinforced and support strong growth momentum, and that's fine. Despite the global headwinds, we do see India and the region, continuing to be a very strong, performed gross performing region compared to other emerging markets across the world".

The World Bank in its South Asia Economic Update report released on Wednesday, had said India's growth is estimated to have accelerated from 7.1 per cent in FY25 to 7.6 per cent in FY26 (April 2025-March 2026), owing to strong domestic demand and export resilience. It projected growth to slow to 6.6

per cent in FY27, but the projection is higher than 6.5 per cent made in the Global Economic Prospects report released in January.

World Bank Lead Economist for India Aurelien Kruse said India has remained the fastest-growing large economy in the world in FY26, despite facing some of the highest tariffs on its exports globally. He said the income tax cuts and GST rate reductions last year supported domestic consumption, while exports and investment, areas which were expected to be adversely affected by tariffs, performed much better than anticipated.

"India showed very strong performance and resilience," Kruse said. Describing the current situation as a "major trade shock", the World Bank said the risks to growth are tilted to

the downside. The World Bank has assumed oil price in FY27 at \$90-100/ barrel for arriving at its growth estimates.

The US-based multilateral agency also appreciated the Indian government's strategy of handling that energy crisis that emanated due to the Middle East conflict.

"The authorities have struck a right balance between taking measures to manage supply without doing massive rationing or massive restrictions, and also trying to soothe the initial volatility by maintaining retail prices of oil relatively constant to avoid kind of very sharp, non-linear adjustments that would have been probably more detrimental than beneficial in the short term. So having said that, the risks are obviously massive. They're tilted to the downside," Kruse said.

Govt ramps up feedstock supplies to pharma sector amid West Asia crisis

NEW DELHI: The government has ramped up supplies of critical petrochemical feedstock to the pharmaceutical industry to ensure uninterrupted production of essential medicines, amid ongoing disruptions in global supply chains due to the West Asia crisis.

Earlier, the sector relied heavily on imports routed through Kandla, Gujarat. However, supply disruptions have prompted domestic refiners to step in, adjusting production lines to provide specialised in-puts.

Key feedstocks such as propylene, ammonia and methanol are being allocated on a pro-rata basis, said Satyaprakash TL, Joint Secretary, Department



of Pharmaceuticals. Domestic refiners, including Bharat Petroleum Corp Ltd, are supplying propylene for intermediates like isopropyl alcohol and isobutyl ben-zene, used in drugs such as Ibuprofen.

Ammonia supplies from the fertiliser sector remain stable, while methanol shortages are being addressed through output from Assam Petrochemicals and Gujarat Narmada Valley Fertil-

isers & Chemicals.

To ease costs, the government has removed customs duty on 40 petrochemical products effective April 1.

Despite global shortages of solvents and APIs, drug prices in India have remained largely stable. The government is closely monitoring supplies of key intermediates used in medicines like Metformin and Aspirin, while temporarily relaxing quality norms for certain inputs to boost availability.

Packaging material constraints are easing, and fuel supplies remain adequate. The government said it will continue facilitating critical inputs to ensure availability of essential medicines.

India's Energy Inflection: PNGRB & IGL convene strategic dialogue to discuss energy security

IGL organised this session to align industry leadership with the government's vision of a system-wide transformation of the national energy architecture

NEW DELHI: As India navigates a pivotal shift in its global energy standing, the Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB) and Indra-prastha Gas Limited (IGL), on Thursday convened a high-intensity dialogue titled "Energy Security: Driving India's Next Wave of Gas Demand." This two-day session brought together an unprecedented assembly of senior policymakers, heads of global as well as Indian energy majors, and institutional advisors with the singular objective of charting a definitive, executable path-way to increase natural gas's share in India's primary

energy mix to 15 per cent by 2030. As a cornerstone of India's city gas distribution network, IGL organised this session to align industry leadership with the government's vision of a system-wide transformation of the national energy architecture.

Dr. Neeraj Mittal, IAS, Secretary, Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, during his speech, called upon CGDs to accelerate and simplify the process of PNG connections. He also highlighted that India sources crude oil from 41 countries, natural gas from 30 countries, and LPG from 13 countries, and these fac-

tors must be considered while framing future energy security policies. He assured that the government is committed to ensuring that gas is available to all entities, and the government is also focusing on diversification so that such crises do not impact supplies.

Dr. Anil Kumar Jain, PNGRB Chairperson called for synchronized infrastructure and market reforms to achieve a 15 per cent gas share by 2030, urging industry leaders to accelerate execution and fulfill milestones to ensure energy security, affordability, and a cleaner, more resilient

CLOSER LOOK

- » Dr. Neeraj Mittal, IAS, Secretary, Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas, during his speech, called upon CGDs to accelerate and simplify the process of PNG connections
- » Dr. Anil Kumar Jain, PNGRB Chairperson called for synchronized infrastructure and market reforms to achieve a 15 per cent gas share by 2030
- » India's natural gas demand is projected to grow by nearly 60 per cent by 2030

national energy architecture. Kamal Kishore Chhatwal, Managing Director, IGL, in his earlier welcome note mentioned that IGL remains committed to advancing the

government's vision to increase the share of Natural Gas in the primary energy mix by continuously expanding IGL's network, enhancing operational efficiency and delivering safe

and sustainable energy solutions to our customers.

India's natural gas demand is projected to grow by nearly 60 per cent by 2030, and the dialogue emphasized that IGL's operational roadmap remains strictly in line with the session's core agenda of advancing energy security and sustainability. By driving structural shifts in industrial fuel switching and transport decarbonization, IGL is actively facilitating the transition from a 6 per cent gas share to a resilient 15 per cent gas-based economy.

The leadership emphasized that this growth is con-tingent

upon four critical enablers: synchronized infrastructure build-out, market-oriented pricing, regulatory stability, and secured LNG supply chains. IGL's commitment to expanding domestic PNG connections and scaling CNG infra-structure serves as a practical blueprint for the "decision-enabling insights" sought during this high-impact discussion.

The agenda was structured to move beyond traditional diagnosis toward actionable outcomes, focusing on how col-laborative efforts can stabilize the gas value chain from upstream production to end-use

adoption. Participants engaged in rigorous debate regarding the implementation of the recent Natural Gas and Petroleum Products Distribution Order, 2026, and the role of anchor loads in ensuring the viability of new pipeline networks. By hosting this dialogue, IGL has positioned itself at the forefront of the regulatory and market evolution necessary to meet India's 2030 tar-gets.

The session concluded with a unified call for coordinated action to ensure that natural gas remains a reliable and affordable bridge fuel for India's industrial and domestic sectors.

MUKUL CHOUDHARY SINGLE-HANDEDLY LEADS LSG TO THREE WICKET WIN

KKR's pace woes exposed as LSG pull off last-ball win in IPL

KOLKATA: Kolkata Knight Riders' inexperience in pace bowling came back to haunt them yet again as Lucknow Super Giants rode on a stunning late assault from rookie Mukul Choudhary and a fifty from Ayush Badoni to clinch a three-wicket win in a last-ball IPL thriller here on Thursday.

Defending 181, KKR looked in control when Cameron Green, making his much-anticipated bowling debut this season, struck with his second ball to remove LSG skipper Rishabh Pant.

But the Australian all-rounder, short on bowling rhythm following workload management after back surgery, could not deliver at the death.

Tasked to bowl the crucial penultimate over with 30 runs needed off the last two overs, Green conceded 16 runs as 21-year-old debutant Choudhary turned the game on its head with fearless hitting, smashing two sixes and a four, including a flat hit over long leg.

With 14 required off the final over, Vaibhav Arora, who has played the lead bowler this season for KKR in the absence of Harshit Rana and Matheesha Pathirana, faltered



Lucknow Super Giants' Mukul Choudhary celebrates after hitting the winning runs during an Indian Premier League (IPL) match against Kolkata Knight Riders in Kolkata on Thursday

under pressure.

Choudhary sealed the contest in dramatic fashion, launching two sixes, including one off the penultimate delivery after a missed yorker that was dispatched over deep cover.

Needing just one off the final ball, the batters scampered through as Choudhary capped a sensational knock, finishing unbeaten on 54 off 27 balls (7x6, 2x4), one of the finest cameos down the order this season.

16
Green conceded 16 runs as 21-year-old debutant Choudhary turned the game on its head with fearless hitting, smashing two sixes and a four

He shared an unbroken 54-run stand with Avesh Khan, which came off just 24 balls, underlining KKR's struggles at the death.

Earlier, Badoni had anchored the chase with a well-compiled 54 (34 balls; 7x4, 2x6) to keep LSG in the hunt before Choudhary's late blitz as they scripted a remarkable turnaround from being 128/7 in 16 overs.

The defeat meant KKR remained winless after four matches, with their lone point coming from a rain-abandoned game against Punjab Kings.

LSG, on the other hand, registered back-to-back wins to move to the top half of the table with four points.

Under scrutiny as the IPL's costliest overseas buy (Rs 25.20 crore), Green produced his best outing with the bat, scoring an unbeaten 32 off 24 balls (3x4, 1x6).

He stitched a crucial unbroken stand with Rovman Powell (39 not out; 24 balls, 4x4, 2x6) to lift KKR to a competitive 181/4 after a mid-innings slowdown.

Green, who had been held back from bowling following back surgery and workload management directives from Cricket Australia, finally rolled his arm over in the ninth over and struck immediately.

With his second delivery, a sharp short ball, he dismissed LSG skipper Rishabh Pant (10), who top-edged a mistimed hook to short fine leg.

It came after Arora had rocked LSG with two wickets in three balls, removing Aiden Markram (22; 15 balls) and Mitchell Marsh (15; 11 balls) to derail their brisk start.

From 41/0 in four overs, LSG suddenly lost momentum and were left with a stiff chase.

Asian Wrestling C'ships: Hansika, Neha clinch bronze, Meenakshi reaches final

BISHKEK: Hansika Lamba and Neha won a bronze medal each in the women's 55kg and 59kg class respectively while two-time national champion Meenakshi Goyat came back from the brink to beat South Korea's Seoyoung Park and reach the final of the 53kg category at the Senior Asian Wrestling Championships here on Thursday.

In the women's 55kg bronze medal bout, Hansika was cautious in the first round against Kyrgyzstan's Aruuke Kadyrbek Kyzy.

The 19-year-old Indian then opened her account with a take down in the first minute of the second round with

a leg attack. She then pressed for the advantage and won the bout 6-1.

Neha then added the seventh medal to India's tally when she registered a dominating 10-4 win over Mongolia's Bolortuya Khurelkhuu in the women's 59kg bronze medal play-off.

Praggnanandhaa loses to Sindarov

Chess: Vaishali jumps to sole lead among women

PAPHOS: The unstoppable Javokhir Sindarov of Uzbekistan made another stride towards the title as he beat India's R Praggnanandhaa to stretch his lead to a massive two points after the end of the tenth round of Candidates chess tournament here on Thursday.

Sindarov took his tally to eight points following his sixth victory in the tournament and second over the Indian.

Anish Giri of the Netherlands is the lone player closest to Sindarov on six points.

Praggnanandhaa is out of contention completely as he remained on four points following his third loss in the tournament. In other games of the day, Fabiano Caruana of United States was held to a draw by Wei Yi of China, American Nakamura drew with Giri while Andrey Espenko of Russia played out a draw with Matthias Bluebaum.

R Vaishali, the elder sister of Praggnanandhaa, meanwhile,



R Praggnanandhaa

continued with her good form and drew with Anna Muzychuk of Ukraine to emerge as the sole leader in the women's Candidates on six points.

The Indian is now followed by Muzychuk and Jiner Zhu of China who both have 5.5 points apiece.

Bibisara Assaubayeva of Kazakhstan defeated Jiner Zhu and moved to five points alongside Russians Kateryna Lagno and Aleksandra Goryachkina. The last four rounds

will decide the fate of the winner and it looks like an exciting finish is on cards in the women's section.

Sindarov yet again showcased his deep opening preparation and caught Praggnanandhaa in a deeply worked on position. The Uzbek sacrificed a piece early and huge complications were on the board when Praggnanandhaa erred and lost his queen for two rooks and a handful of white pawns.

Sooryavanshi can become a proper superstar: Smith



Rajasthan Royals' Vaibhav Sooryavanshi plays a shot during an Indian Premier League (IPL) match in Guwahati

NEW DELHI: Prodigiously talented Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's legion of fans keeps on growing with South African batting great Graeme Smith describing the 15-year-old Indian as a "proper superstar" after his exploits in the IPL 2026.

The 15-year-old Sooryavanshi smashed world's best T20 bowler Jasprit Bumrah for a six off the very first delivery he faced during Rajasthan Royals' win 27-run win over Mumbai Indians in a rain-curtailed match on Tuesday.

The young swashbuckler hit Bumrah again for a six in the same over during his 14-ball

39. "The IPL has started exactly how I expected it to, with flatter pitches and high-scoring games. As always, it's interesting to see how the old school superstars like Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli perform, but I think this youngster for Rajasthan Royals, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, is the one to watch in the opening few weeks," Smith said on his blog.

"He has already shown his ability to power it right from ball one. As a young man, he could become a proper superstar over the course of the tournament and I'm really excited to see how he goes," said the former South Africa captain.

BJKC: VAISHNAVI RESPONDED UNDER PRESSURE

Vaishnavi, Sahaja lose as Indonesia take unassailable 2-0 lead over India

NEW DELHI: Vaishnavi Adkar's gallant fight ended with a heartbreaking loss, while Sahaja Yamalappalli was outplayed by world No. 41 Janice Tjen as India conceded an unassailable 0-2 lead to Indonesia in their third match of the Asia/Oceania Group I tie of the Billie Jean King Cup here on Thursday.

The 21-year-old Vaishnavi, ranked 391 in the world, played her heart out but couldn't get past Priska Madelyn Nugroho, ranked 419, going down 7-6 (3) 6-7 (3) 3-6 in the first singles in three hours and six minutes at the DLT stadium.

It was always going to be a difficult task for Sahaja to beat Janice as she went down 2-6 1-6 to the star Indonesian in the second singles.

Doubles pair of Ankita Raina and Rutuja Bhosale will now face Janice and Aldila Sutjiadi in the third match of the tie.

India had registered a 3-0 win over New Zealand after suffering a 1-2 loss against Thailand in their first tie on Wednesday.

Vaishnavi vs Priska
Vaishnavi produced a gritty, high-quality performance to take the opening set

Key Points

- » It was always going to be a difficult task for Sahaja to beat Janice as she went down 2-6 1-6 to the star Indonesian in the second singles
- » Doubles pair of Ankita Raina and Rutuja Bhosale will now face Janice and Aldila Sutjiadi in tie
- » The second set saw Vaishnavi start poorly, falling 0-2 after an early break

in a contest marked by frequent momentum swings, long baseline exchanges and multiple service breaks.

She showed intent at the net and mixed her game well, using aggressive forehands to stay competitive.

However, she struggled to consolidate early advantages. Despite leading 40-15 in the opening game, she dropped serve as Priska countered with sharp winners.

Trailing 0-2, Vaishnavi broke back in the fourth game to level at 2-2.

A series of breaks followed, with neither player able to dominate for long. Inconsistent shot selection and unforced errors from the Indian allowed Priska to move ahead 5-3.

Vaishnavi, however, responded under pressure, saving a set point and forcing a tie-break, which she

won 7-3 with improved control and shot-making.

The second set saw Vaishnavi start poorly, falling 0-2 after an early break. She recovered to level at 2-2 and later moved ahead with aggressive play, including a series of strong forehand winners.

Priska briefly took a medical timeout while trailing 2-3 but returned to level at 4-4 after breaking back. Vaishnavi again edged ahead and served for the match at 5-4 but failed to close it out.

The set eventually went into a tie-break, where Priska raised her level to draw parity.

In the decider, the Indian raced to a 2-0 lead before Priska clawed back, breaking twice to go 4-2 up. Despite signs of physical discomfort, the Indonesian maintained composure, using precise placement and effective net play.



STATE BANK OF INDIA

HOME LOAN CENTRE - FARIDABAD, NEELAM CHOWK, FIRST FLOOR, NIT, FARIDABAD, HARYANA-121001

CORRIGENDUM

Please refer to the advertisement of "NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION SALE OF MOVABLE PROPERTY" OF SI. No.89.1- MR. VINO JAMES CHACKO S/O V. C. CHACKO, Car Loan A/c. No.42889716452, Asset Details: Registration No.: HR87Q7437, MODEL - BALENO ZETA (MARUTI SUZUKI INDIA LTD.) FUEL - PETROL REGISTRATION DATE: 08/05/2024 AND SI. No.2 - MR. RAVINDER KUMAR S/O BIJENDER SINGH, Car Loan A/c. No.39635772434, Asset Details: Registration No.: HR30W2042, MODEL - VENUE 1.5 CRDI MT SX (HYUNDAI MOTORS) FUEL - Diesel REGISTRATION DATE: 21/09/2020 published in this newspaper on 01.04.2026. The Date of E-Auction Sale is wrongly published. The correct Date of E-Auction Sale please be read as **24.04.2026** instead of 15.04.2026. In SI. No.1- MR. VINO JAMES CHACKO S/O V. C. CHACKO - Name of the Contact Person for Vehicle Inspection please be read as "MR. HEMANT KUMAR, MOBILE : 9034545090".

Date / Time of E-Auction On 24.04.2026 For 5 Hours From 11:00 AM to 04:00 PM with unlimited Extn. of 20 minutes each.

Date and Time of Vehicle Inspection is 23.04.2026 at 11:00 AM to 04:00 PM. Last Date of EMD Deposit on or before 23.04.2026 upto 4:00 PM. All other details will remain the same.

Sd/- Authorized Officer,

State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre - Faridabad

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING
THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED**

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)

84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sंहिता-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Deepak @ Kachri S/o Vinod Kumar R/o H.No. A-1/243, Nand Nagri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 11874/2020 U/s 379/411 IPC at PS: Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Deepak @ Kachri** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Deepak @ Kachri** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant), Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Deepak @ Kachri** of **FIR No. 11874/2020 U/s 379/411 IPC at PS: Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.05.2026.**

By order
Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No.19, First Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP4105/NE/2026

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused (1) Praveen Kumar (2) Anil Kumar, (3) Jitender @ Jai (4) Sunil Kumar S/o Rajender (5) Aman S/o Jitender & (6) Gaurav S/o Sunil R/o B-13/1, Gali No. 13, Gamri Extension, Bhajanpura, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide FIR No. 77/2026 U/S 74/76/79/110/115(2)/126(2)/333/351(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Bhajanpura, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said **above all accused** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **above all accused** have absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused (1) Praveen Kumar (2) Anil Kumar, (3) Jitender @ Jai & (4) Sunil Kumar (5) Aman (6) Gaurav of FIR No. 77/2026 U/S 74/76/79/110/115(2)/126(2)/333/351(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Bhajanpura, Delhi is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **03.06.2026**

By Order,
Sh. Pankaj Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Room No. 73, North-East District, 5th Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/4552/NE/2026(Court Matter)

ICIICI Bank Branch Office: ICIICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohatk Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

PUBLIC NOTICE:
Builder Cancellation

This is to bring to your notice thatMr. MuktiKanta Nayak / Subhashree Nayak (Borrower/s) has availed Home loan facility vide facility agreement number LBDEL00002267335 located at Flat No E01 Ground Floor, Gardenia Gateway, Plot No 9, Sec 75, Noida- 201307. The borrower/s has failed to pay the contractual amount to the builder as per the terms and conditions of the agreement.

The Bank had informed the same to the borrower through letter dated April 08, 2026, informing that Gardenia India Limited has cancelled the allotment of the above mentioned property. You are therefore requested to resolve this matter with the builder within 7 days from the date of this publication.Please take further notice that post cancellation of the allotment of the said property ICIICI Bank shall not be bound and/or responsible for any other allotment done by the builder.

Dated: Delhi/ 01, 2026
Place : Delhi/ NCR

For ICIICI Bank Limited
Sd-

Government of Jharkhand

Rural Works Department

JHARKHAND STATE RURAL ROADS DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (JSRDA)

3rd Floor, F.F.P. Building, Dhurwa, Ranchi 834004

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS

(National Competitive Bidding Through e-Procurement)

Re- eTender No.- 03/ 2026-27-433(Encl) **Ranchi, Dated: 08.04.2026**

PR No- 364457 dated 18.10.2025

The undersigned on behalf of Government of Jharkhand invites item rate bids through e-Procurement from the eligible bidders registered* in appropriate class with any State/Central Government/State /Central Government Organization for construction and maintenance for five years of the works (List of schemes shall be displayed in the website pmgsytendersjhr.gov.in) of Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojna PM-JANMAN (Batch-1, 2025-26).

Sr. No	District Name	Block Name	Tendering Package	Road Name / Bridge Name (in lakhs)	Road Length (Kms)	Sanction Construction Cost (in lakhs)	Sanction Maintenance Cost	Total Sanction Cost with Maint. (in lakhs)	Total Package Cost (in lakhs)	Earnest Money (In Lakh)	Time of Completion (in month)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
1	Palamu	Chainpur	JH-17- PMJANMAN- PAL-04 (2025-26) (2 nd Call)	L023-Nawadhi sungai to korwa tola via Nawadhi Barwa tola to karwa	3.137	282.23	27.30	309.53	933.54	18.67	15
	Palamu	Chainpur		L033- Islamnagar More To Dhamanawa Main Road	7.500	570.50	53.51	624.01			
Total					10.637	852.73	80.81	933.54	933.54		

The bid should be submitted online in the website pmgsytendersjhr.gov.in. The bidders should have valid Digital Signature Certificate for online submission of bid.

Details of bid submission is as under:

Procurement Officer	Place of Opening	Availability of tender (on-line) for bidding		Last date & time of seeking clarification	Last date and time of bid submission	Date & time of opening (on-line) of tender	
		From	To			Technical bid	Financial bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Engineer in Chief, JSRDA, Ranchi	Engineer in Chief, JSRDA, Ranchi	10.04.2026 at 10.00 AM	23.04.2026 upto 5.00 PM	15.04.2026 upto 2.00 PM	23.04.2026 upto 5.00 PM	23.04.2026 at 05.30 PM	To be informed later

* Non-registered bidders may also submit bid, however the successful bidders must get registered in appropriate class with appropriate authority before signing the contract.

** Cost may change.

Note :-

- Amount of Bid Security should be taken as mentioned in the Bid Data Sheet of the Bidding Document.
- Cost of Bid Document (Rs. 10000) and Bid Security (as mentioned in the Bid Data Sheet) shall be deposited **online** in form as mentioned in Bid Data Sheet failing which the bid will be treated non responsive and action shall be taken as per Sec. 2 of ITB clause 12.2 (d).
- In case, it is found, even after the award of work that the bidder has submitted/ uploaded any false/erroneous/fraudulent statement/document, he/she is liable for blacklisting and forfeiture of Bid Security.
- Bidders must submit GST registration certificate without which bid is liable to be rejected.
- Bidders whose names appear in the Debar/blacklist of RWD or any department of GoJ/Gol (including JSRDA) shall not be allowed to participate in the above bids.
- Bids submitted by bidders, who have long pending ATR(s) made inordinate delay in execution of earlier allotted construction/ maintenance works of PMGSY, may be rejected summarily.
- In case of any discrepancy/dispute about units in BOQ, units as mentioned in Current TOR on which BOQ has been prepared shall prevail.
- Participating bidders are free to submit grievances, if any, against the decision of technical evaluation within five days from the date of uploading of decision of technical evaluation only through email at jh-ee@pmgsy.nic.in Grievance submitted after stipulated period shall not be considered.
- Bidders must have valid registration with Employee Provident Fund organization under EPF and Miscellaneous Provisions Act 1952 failing which the bid shall be rejected.
- Bidders must not quote rate for routine maintenance. The amount for routine maintenance as indicated in the Bill of Quantities must be acceptable to bidders.
- For unbalanced bids, extra security will be required to be deposited by the bidder at the time of Agreement.
- The undersigned reserves the right to cancel the tender at any stage without giving prior notice/reason.

All other details can be seen in the bidding document which is available in website pmgsytendersjhr.gov.in as per schedule mentioned above.

Sd/-
Engineer-in- Chief

PR 377025 Rural Work Department(26-27).D

Rural Works Department- Cum- JSRDA, Ranchi

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, MINOR IRRIGATION DIVISION, Ranchi		
e-Procurement Tender Notice Two Envelope System		
Tender Reference No:- WRD/MID/01/BD/(SLI)2026-27		
Letter no-.....		Date-.....
1	Name of Work:	Construction of Mukhyamantri Solar Lift Irrigation Scheme at Nagdabeda Block- Angara, Dist- Ranchi.
2	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Rs. 11,56,000.00
3	Cost of tender document (Rs)	Rs. 10,000 only (non-refundable).
4	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Rs. 1,12,000.00 only.
5	Time of Completion	335 Days
6	Mode of Submission of tender	Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
7	Date of Publication of Tender on website	Date: 24.04.2026 Time: 2:00 PM
8	Last Date/Time for downloading of bidding documents and Submission of Tender on Website	Date: 30.04.2026 Time: 2:00PM
9	Submission of Tender Fee and EMD	Start Date:-24.04.2026 Time: 2:00 PM Last Date:- 30.04.2026 Time:- 2:00 PM
10	Technical Bid Opening Date	Date: 02.05.2026 Time: 5:00 PM
11	Officer Inviting Bids	Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation Division, Ranchi
12	Contact No. of Procurement Officer e-mail of Procurement Officer	9431190681
13	Help line No. of Procurement Cell	0651-3512681/Email ID- cemidran-cemr-jhr@nic.in

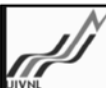
Note:- ➤ Work will be awarded to those bidders (specially MNRE approved channel partners/MNRE approved manufacturers/ MNRE approved PV system integrators/ A registered manufacturers/ of Company/ Firm/ Corporation in India (including MSME of Jharkhand) of at least one of the major sub system namely pumps or PV System electronics (conforming to National/ International Standards) any other agencies having experience of installation and commissioning of such solar powered irrigation schemes). Empanelled Indigenous Manufacturers of 10HP pumps (AC/DC Surface water Pumps) in the department with all accessories for off-grid stand alone SPV water pumping systems can also take part in the bid for executing the whole work of the bid. However those bidders who have not yet registered in Water Resources Department can also submit their bid provided they will have to get themselves registered in Water Resources Department within two months from the date of allotment of work.

➤ Only e-Tender will be accepted.

Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

**Executive Engineer,
Minor Irrigation Division,
Ranchi**

PR 377036 (Minor Irrigation) 26-27 (D)



UJVNL LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006

Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508

CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Date Extension Notice

Date: 09/04/2026

Due to unavoidable reasons, the last date of submission and date of opening of NIT no. 14/UJVNL/EE/(M&G)/KPS/2025-26 for "Procurement of different types of Canon make printer cartridge for various offices of Kulhal Power Station" is hereby extended as under-

Last date for submission of tender: 16.04.2026, 15:00 Hrs.

Date of opening of tender : 17.04.2026, 15:00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com"**

Executive Engineer (M&G), Kulhal

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

4th Floor, Jeevan Tara Building, Parliament Street, New Delhi-110001

Notice under Section 19(4) of the Recovery of Debts Due to Banks and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 read with Rule 12 & 13 of the Debts Recovery Tribunal (Procedure Rules) 1993.

In the matter of	OA NO 22/2025	Date:	06.04.2026
Bank of Maharashtra	Versus	Applicant	
Shefali Rathour & Anr.		Respondent	
To,			
Defendant			
D1. Ms Shefali Rathour W/o Shri Naveen Rathour, R/o 173-B, Pkrt-C-2, Mayur Vihar, Phase-III, Delhi-96, Also at: Flat No. 106, Sector- 17F, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, UP			
D2. M/s Mallia Realtors Pvt Ltd, 676 Ground Floor, Chilla Gate, Chawari Bazar, Delhi-06, Also at: 710-711, Devika Tower, Chander Nagar, Ghaziabad, UP- 201011			
Whereas the above named applicant(s) has/have instituted a case for recovery of Rs. 40,69,096/- (Rupee Forty Lakh Sixty Nine Thousand Ninety Six Only) against you and whereas it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in ordinary way, therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance in the Tribunal on 14.08.2026 at 11:00 A.M.			
Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before the mentioned, the case will be heard and determined in your absence.			
All the matters will be taken up through Video Conferencing or physical and for that purpose:-(i) All the Advocates/Litigants shall download the "Cisco Webex" application/software. (ii) "Meeting ID" and "Password" for the date of hearing qua case to be taken by Hon'ble Presiding Officer (Registrar) shall be displayed in the daily case list itself at DT Official Portal i.e. drt.gov.in . (iii) In any exigency the Advocates/Litigants can contact the concerned official at Ph. No. 23748478			
Given under my hand and seal of the Tribunal this the 06th day of April, 2026.			
By Order of the Tribunal Secretary Officer, DRT-II, Delhi			

NORTHERN RAILWAY Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana, Sonipat Tender Notice	
Invitation of tender through e-tendering (e-Procurement Systems)	
On behalf of President of India Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer, office at - Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana Sonipat invites e-tender for below mentioned work:-	
NIT No.	08-RCNK-OPN-FURVB-2026
Name of Work and its location	Furnishing Work (Mechanical & Electrical) of Vande Bharat Rake (08 Coaches) during SS-II at RCNK/SNP (As per Scope of Work)
Approx Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs. 99,53,259.95/- including GST@18% (Rs. Ninety-Nine Lakh Fifty-Three Thousand Two Hundred Fifty-Nine and Ninety-Five Paise Only)
Earnest Money	Rs. 1,99,100.00/-
Completion period of work	06 months from date of issue of Letter of acceptance
Cost of Tender document (In Rs.)	NIL
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Up to 15:00 hrs on 23/04/2026 Opening of Tender at 15:15 hrs on same day.
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
Tender No. 08-RCNK-OPN-FURVB-2026 Date: 08/04/2026	
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE	
	1174/2026



पावर ग्रिड POWERGRID

Notice

1. Approval under Regulation-86 of CERC (Conduct of Business) Regulations 1999 and CERC (Terms and Conditions of Tariff) Regulations 2019 for i) Truing up of Transmission tariff for 2019-24 tariff block and ii) Determination of Transmission tariff for 2024-29 tariff block for Petition-L: Assets under “Augmentation of Transformation Capacity at 400/220 kV Kurukshetra (PG) and Patiala (PG) Substation”.
2. The beneficiaries of the above-mentioned Transmission systems are: (a) Aijmer Vidhyut Vitran Nigam Ltd. (b) Jaipur Vidhyut Vitran Nigam Ltd. (c) Jodhpur Vidhyut Vitran Nigam Ltd. (d) Punjab State Electricity Corporation Limited (e) Haryana Power Purchase Centre Ltd. (f) Jammu & Kashmir Power Corporation Ltd. (g) Uttar Pradesh Power Corporation Ltd. (h) BSES Yamuna Power Ltd. (i) BSES Rajdhani Power Ltd. (j) Tata Power Delhi Distribution Ltd. (k) Chandigarh Electricity Department (l) Uttaranchal Power Corporation Ltd. (m) North Central Railway (n) New Delhi Municipal Council. (o) Uttar Pradesh Power Transmission Corp. Ltd.

3. Tariff Details:

a) 2019-24 Block

		Rs. in Lakhs						
Asset Detail	DOCO	Completion Cost as on 31.03.2024		2019-20	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24
Asset-1	23.11.2023	4880.77	AFC approved	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	354.27
			Revised AFC based on truing up	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	360.45
Asset-2	12.07.2023	3858.27	AFC approved	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	628.22
			Revised AFC based on truing up	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	626.42

b) 2024-29 Block

			Rs. in Lakhs				
Asset Detail	Completion Cost as on 31.03.2029	-	2024-25	2025-26	2026-27	2027-28	2028-29
Asset-1	9487.16	AFC	1834.40	1874.87	1863.91	1853.27	1835.53

4. A copy of this notice and of the application made for determination of tariff is posted on the website of the applicant at www.powergrid.in
5. Suggestions and objections, if any, on the proposals for determination of tariff contained in the application be filed by any person, including the beneficiary before the Secretary, Central Electricity Regulatory Commission, 6th, 7th & 8th Floor, Tower B, World Trade Centre, Naroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029 (or other addresses where the office of the Commission is situated), with a copy to the applicant at the address of its corporate office within 30 days of publication of this notice.

Place: GURUGRAM

Date: 10.04.2026

Sd/-

GM (Commercial)

POWER GRID CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Regd. Office : B-9, Qutab Institutional Area, Katwara Sarai, New Delhi-110016

Corp. Office : "Saudamini", Plot No.2, Sector-29, Gurugram-122011 (Haryana)

www.powergrid.in CIN : L40101DL1989G0038121

 Suryodaya Finance Bank Limited Regd. & Corp. office : 1101, Sharda Terraces, Plot 65, Sector – 11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai – 400614. CIN: L65923MH2008PLC24742.	
Under Section 13 (2) of The Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 Whereas the Bank is the Authorised officer of the M/s. Suryodaya Small Finance Bank Ltd. ("SFBSBL") under Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) read with Rule 3 of Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002 issued thereunder under Section 13(2) of the said Act, and in exercise of the following Borrower(s), Co-Borrower(s), Guarantor(s) to discharge in full their liability to the company by making payment of entire outstanding including up to date interest, cost and charges within 60 days from the date of respective Notices issued and the publication of this notice is given below and in view of alternate service upon you. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following Secured Asset(s) have been mortgaged to SFBSBL by the said Borrower(s), Co-Borrower(s), Guarantor(s) respectively.	
Name of Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Guarantor 237000004561, 1. MR. JITENDER KUMAR S/O NARESH SINGH, 2. MRS.RENU W/O JITENDER KUMAR	Date of Demand Notice 09.03.2026 Date of NPA 05.03.2026 Total Outstanding Amount in Rs. Rs.19,82,309.82/- as on 06.03.2026
Description of Secured Asset(s) /Immovable Property (ies) : All That Piece and Parcel Of The Mortgaged Property Built Up 1st Floor Without Roof/Rights, Out Of Property Bearing No. 57/58 Area Measuring 54 Sq. Yds., i.e. 45.2 Sq. Mtrs., Out Of Khasha No. 28, Situated In Area Of O/S Of O/S/Of O/S/Of And The Colony is known As "Suryodaya Colony", Uttam Nagar, District No. 10059, Bhopal. Plot No. 58, West. Plot No. 57, South. Others' Property, North- Road 20 Ft., Wide & 2 Of 6.	
23700000095 & 237000001145, 1. MR. RAMESH TYAGI S/O BALWANT TYAGI, 2.MRS. BITA W/O MAHESH TYAGI.	Date of Demand Notice 09.03.2026 Date of NPA 05.03.2026 Total Outstanding Amount in Rs. Rs.30,61,180.92/- as on 06.03.2026
Description of Secured Asset(s) /Immovable Property (ies) : Flat Bearing No. 264, On First Floor, Category-Janta (Without Roof/Rights) Registered In Plot No. 65, Sector-11, Situated In The Layout Plan Of Rohini Residential Scheme, Rohini, Delhi-110085.	
Date : 10.04.2026, Place : Delhi Authorised Officer, Suryodaya Small Finance Bank Limited	

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rajesh Kumar**, Director **Sai Solar Technologies Pvt. Ltd.**, At: I-159A, Sector-22, Noida (U.P.), **Also at:** 429 RPS Mansarovar Park, Shahdara, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT No. 1441/2019, PS Krishna Nagar, Shahdara Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Rajesh Kumar**, Director **Sai Solar Technologies Pvt. Ltd.**, the said accused of **CT No. 1441/2019, PS Krishna Nagar, Shahdara Distt., Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
East Distt., Court No. 16,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/3939/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)



UJVNL LIMITED
H.O.: "UJVJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 290 Date: 09/04/2026

Date Extension-01

In tender NIT No. T-12/ EE (E&M)/ Asan Barrage/ (2025-26) for the work of "Hiring of 01 nos. non-AC diesel vehicle alongwith Driver for EE (E&M), Asan Barrage, Dhalpur for a period of one year" invited by Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M), Asan Barrage, 'Jai Shakti Bhawan', Dhakrani invites sealed tenders from interested parties is hereby extended is as given below:

Last date for submission of tender: 13/04/2026 at 13:00 hrs.

Date of tender opening : 13/04/2026 at 16:00 hrs

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com" rest of all the conditions shall remain same.

Executive Engineer (E&M)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

**See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik
Suraksha Sanhita, 2023**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Bablu S/o Hawaldar R/o: Kh. No.-192, Mukundpur Extn., Part-2, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 857/2025, U/S 109(1)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 & 25/27 Arms Act, PS Burari, North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Bablu** the said accused of **FIR No. 857/2025, U/S 109(1)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 & 25/27 Arms Act, PS Burari, North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Payal Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-09,
Room No.-286, Central Distt.,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/4628/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Malakava @ Malpuha @ Sonu, S/o: Nanku, R/o: Jhuggi No.7A, Golden Park, Rampura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case vide **FIR No.000547/2022 U/S 457/380/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S Sarai Rohilla, North District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon insinuating that the said **Malakava @ Malpuha @ Sonu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Malakava @ Malpuha @ Sonu** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Malakava @ Malpuha @ Sonu**, accused of **FIR No. 000547/2022 U/S 457/380/411/34 IPC, P.S. Sarai Rohilla, North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.05.2026**.

By Order, Sh. Rangat Ghirra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04 (Cenral),
Room No.-37, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/4594/N/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY NOTICE INVITING TENDER		
Name of work and its location	03-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27	
	Electrical work in connection with (i) Provision of 2 Family suits and 6 individual suits at ORH GZB in lieu of Old ORH. (ii) Construction of underground tank & pump house, electric sub-station, improvement to water supply system under ADEN/GZB (iii) Augmentation of homing capacity of ELS/GZB from 200 to 225, (iv) Reorganization of facilities available in Shed and shop at ELS/GZB. (v) Provision of efficient treatment plant at ELS/GZB.	
	Approx. cost of the works in	Rs. 11909661.90/-
	Address of the office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi.
	Earnest Money	Rs. 2382000.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender	30.04.2026, 16.00 Hrs.	
Opening of tender	30.04.2026, 16.00 Hrs.	
Website & notice board	www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi	
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE		
11/7/2026		

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sompal Aarang, S/o: Ranjeet Aarang, R/o: 1419 Nicholson Road, Mori Gate, Delhi, Also at: Kashmoli Uttar Bandh Parakasharm, PS Joypur, Howarh, West Bengal** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 80021352/25, Dated: 24.02.2025, U/s: 305 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, Police Station Karol Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sompal Aarang** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sompal Aarang** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sompal Aarang of Police Station Karol Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Nishat Bangarh
Ld. JMFC-01, Central, Room No. 180
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/4588/CD/2026



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No. –PRYJ–Sig–002-2026-27

E-Tender Notice

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordination/ North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to 12:00 hrs. or the opening date of E-Tender mentioned therein. **The details of the Tender are as under :-**

Tender No.: 002	Approx. Cost of work : 24741851.30	Earnest Money : 494800/-
Cost of Tender Form : 0.00	Completion Period : 12 Months	
Date of opening of tender : 05.05.2026		

Name of work : Strengthening and Augmentation of Earthing and Bonding Arrangement as per revised RDSO/TAN3006 in section of Sr. DSTE/Co/PRYJ.

Availability of tender form : Tender forms are available on www.irops.gov.in

Earnest Money to be deposited : The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking on Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenderers without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected.

Time & place of opening of tender : Tender will be opened through E-Tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj, at or after 12:30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenderers will be opened on the next working day.

Validity of Offer : 60 days from the date of opening.

Right of Railway to deal with tender : Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 770/26 (D)

 North central railways
  @ CPRONCR
  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



'It has been like 21 years into my career and I still feel like I'm starting off all over again,' she says

'NOT MANY FEMALE ACTORS GET THIS SORT OF OPPORTUNITY'

Actress Tamannaah Bhatia opened up about her 21 years in cinema

Tamannaah Bhatia reflected on the rare position she finds herself in after 21 years in the film industry, one that, she said, very few female actors get to experience. Recently, the actress spoke about her excitement over a string of upcoming projects, the warmth she has received from audiences across India and why she still feels like she is just getting started.

In an interview with 'ANI' at a Delhi event, Tamannaah Bhatia expressed, "I'm really excited for all my features to come out one by one. It's very interesting; not many actors and maybe more so female actors, get this sort of an opportunity. It has been like 21 years into my career and I still feel like I'm starting off all over again."



Having built a strong foundation in South Indian cinema, Tamannaah Bhatia said the response she is now receiving from other parts of the country has been both exciting and humbling.

She said, "There's a sense of freshness, even for me as an actor. And I think even the audience is continuously sort of being so warm towards me."

AGENCIES

Atlee's 'Raaka' looks so exciting: Shah Rukh Khan

The Bollywood superstar extended his wishes to the entire cast

Bollywood superstar Shah Rukh Khan said he is excited for Atlee's upcoming film 'Raaka' and extended his wishes to the entire cast.

Billed as a grand fantasy-action entertainer, the film features Allu Arjun and Deepika Padukone in the lead roles, marking the first collaboration for the actors. The makers revealed the title of the film on Wednesday, on Arjun's 44th birthday and also released the posters of the film.

Shah Rukh re-shared Arjun's poster on his 'X' handle as he wished the actor and said he appeared 'intriguing and amazing' in it. "Happy Birthday @alluarjun... The poster is intriguing and amazing just like you are," he wrote.

"Can't wait to see what you guys have put together. This experience will be in Atlee's words - Mass masssss!! #Raaka looks so exciting, all the best!! @Atlee_dir," he added.

The 'Don' actor has previously worked with the director on the 2023 film 'Jawan', which went on to cross over Rs 1000 crore at the box office.

'Raaka' is backed by production ban-



ner 'Sun Pictures' and also features Mrunal Thakur. It also reunites the filmmaker with Padukone, who was a part of Atlee's 'Jawan' alongside Shah Rukh.

PTI

Tom Cruise is 'looking forward' to Jerry Maguire's re-release

Hollywood star Tom Cruise said he is looking forward to the re-release of his film 'Jerry Maguire' on its 30th anniversary. The film originally released on December 13, 1996 and is set to be re-released in theatres on April 12, 14 and 15.

Cruise shared a post on his 'Instagram' story on Wednesday, which featured the film's poster along with the release dates written over it. "Looking forward to sharing it with you all again in theatres next week" he wrote in the caption.

It was directed by Cameron Crowe and featured him in the role of a sports agent

'Jerry Maguire' was directed by Cameron Crowe and featured the actor in the role of a sports agent, Jerry Maguire. It revolved around Cruise's character, who, after getting fired from his job for exposing the alleged illegal practices

that exist in his profession, starts his own agency. But he manages to find only one client.

The film received five Academy Award nominations at the 69th Academy Awards in 'Best Picture', 'Best Actor', 'Best Supporting Actor', 'Best Original Screenplay' and 'Best Film Editing' categories. It went on to win an Oscar in the 'Best Supporting Actor' category, which was given to Cuba Gooding Jr. It also starred Renee Zellweger, Jonathan Lipnicki and Lucy Liu in pivotal roles.

PTI



Amanda Seyfried to voice Cinderella in 'Steps'

Hollywood star Amanda Seyfried has been roped in to voice the character of Cinderella for Netflix's original animated film 'Steps'. The film is an animated reimagining of the Cinderella story, focusing on her stepsisters and is scheduled for release in 2026.

The actress shared a picture of her character on her 'Instagram' account on



Wednesday, announcing the news. "STEPS @netflixfilm,"

she wrote in the caption.

It is directed by Alyce Tzue and John Ripa and revolves around stepsister Lilith (Ali Wong), who is wrongly blamed for a mishap at the royal ball. She must team up with Cinderella (Seyfried) and her sister Margot (Stephanie Hsu) to save the kingdom.

Tzue said Seyfried has the ability to make her characters

specific and relatable.

"Amanda has this incredible ability to make her characters specific and relatable and we absolutely needed that when taking on a character that's as legendary as Cinderella," the filmmaker said.

Tzue added, "We wanted to create a modern heroine complete with flaws and coping mechanisms."

PTI

Chris Hemsworth to return as Tyler Rake in 'Extraction 3'

Sam Hargrave is back as director with the third part

Hollywood star Chris Hemsworth is officially returning for the third part of his 'Netflix' action franchise 'Extraction'. The 'Avengers: Endgame' star has closed a deal to reprise his role of mercenary Tyler Rake in the new instalment, reported 'Deadline'.

Action director-turned-filmmaker Sam Hargrave will once again go behind the camera for the project, which will have a script penned by David Weil.

Actors Golshifteh Farahani and Idris Elba are also back on board.

Hemsworth shared the news in a post on 'Instagram' and wrote, "Fired up for the next instalment of 'Extraction'! Let's go."

Plot details remain under wraps, but the film promises another high-octane mission, with Rake and his team taking on a new, dangerous extraction.

The 'Extraction' franchise is based on the graphic novel 'Ciudad' by Ande Parks, Joe Russo, Anthony Russo and Fernando León González. It began with the 2020 film

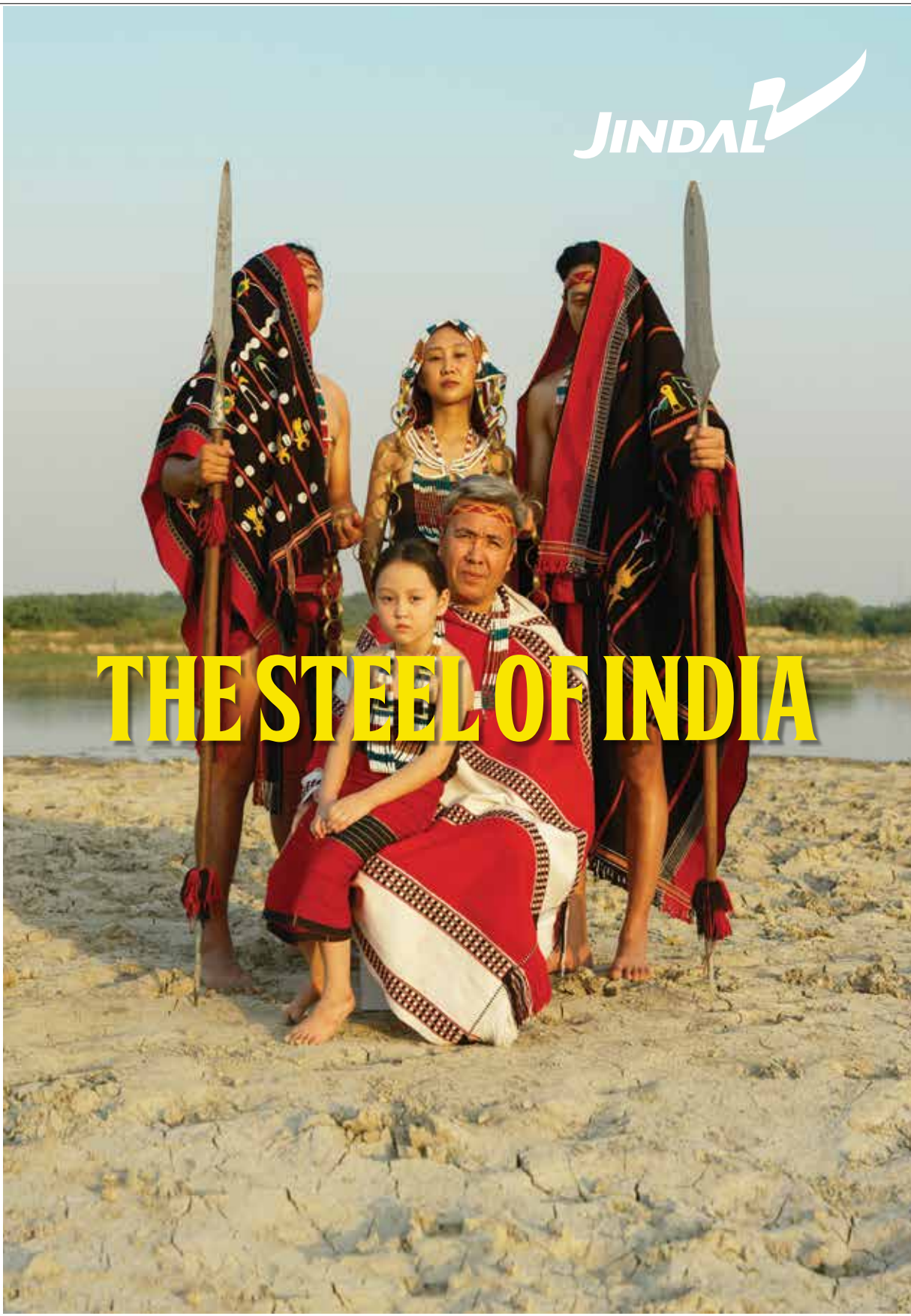


Hemsworth shared the news in a post on 'Instagram' and wrote, "Fired up for the next instalment of 'Extraction'! Let's go."

'Extraction', directed by Hargrave and produced by Joe Russo and Anthony Russo, best known for their work in the 'Marvel Cinematic Universe'.

Set largely in Dhaka, the first film follows Rake, a black-market operative tasked with rescuing an Indian crime lord's kidnapped son. It became one of Netflix's most-watched originals and was praised for its gritty tone and long-take action sequences.

PTI



Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS**
*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**
Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**
(1) Name of the Constituency - **105, Bhatpara Assembly Constituency**
(2) Name of the candidate – **Amit Gupta**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 448/323/354/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860 2. Sections 147/148/149/448/427/337/323/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860 3. Sections 147/148/149/448/427/337/326/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 4. Sections 341/323/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 5. Sections 465/468/471/120B/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 6. Sections 447/427/323/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1. G.R. No – 3424/2014, (arising out of P.S. No. 415/2010, dated 01.08.2010, Jagaddal Police Station). 2. G.R. No 4101/2008, (arising out of P.S. Case No. 519/2008, dated 23.12.2008, Jagaddal Police Station). 3. G.R Case No. 3951/2008, (arising out of P.S. Case No.518/2008, Jagaddal Police Station.) 4. G.R Case No. 3952/2008, (arising out of P.S. Case No.521/2008, Jagaddal Police Station.) 5. G.R Case No. 2464/2007, (arising out of P.S. Case No.334/2007, Jagaddal Police Station.) 6. G.R. Case No. 1921/2007, (arising out of P.S. Case No. 253/2007, Jagaddal Police Station).

	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned 5thJudicial Magistrate, 1st Class, at Barrackpore. 2. Learned 5thJudicial Magistrate, at Barrackpore. 3. Learned 5thJudicial Magistrate, at Barrackpore 4. Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, at Barrackpore 5. Learned 1st JudicialMagistrate , at Barrackpore. 6. Learned 5thJudicial Magistrate, at Barrackpore
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. Yes, on 24.01.2023 2. No 3. No 4. No 5. No 6. Yes, on 22.09.2017
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.		The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)	The candidate is an experienced-grassroot political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.		Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)	Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **105, BHATPARA ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY**
(4) Name of the candidate: **Amit Gupta**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS**
*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**
Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**
(1) Name of the Constituency - **274- Galsi (SC) Assembly Constituency**
(2) Name of the candidate – **Alok Kumar Majhi**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections341/504/323/325/326/307/448/379/427/354B/ 120B of Indian Penal Code 1860, Sections 25/27 of Arms Act, 1959, Sections 3/4 of the Explosive Substances Act, 1908. 2. Sections 447/323/354B/427/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3. Sections 341/323/325/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1. P.S. No. 127 of 2014, KhandagoshPolice Station. 2. G.R. Case No. 3794 of 2013. 3. G.R Case No. 2548 of 2012, arising out of FIR No. 181/2012, dated 02.11.2012,Khandaghosh Police Station.
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned CJM at PurbaBardhaman, 2. Learned5th Judicial Magistrate, PurbaBardhaman. 3. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, PurbaBardhaman.

	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.		The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)	The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.		Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)	Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **274- GALSI (SC) ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY**
(4) Name of the candidate: **Alok Kumar Majhi**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 260- Bardhaman Dakshin Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Khokan Das

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 448/341/323/427/379/354(B) /504/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2. Sections 448/427/504/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3. Sections 341/323/325/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 4. Sections 341/323/325/379/427/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 5. Sections 147/452/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 6. Sections 341/323/325/326/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 7. Sections 147/148/149/323/324/325/ 337/338/427/436/506/379 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 8. Sections 143/341/323/337/338/506/325/427 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 9. Sections 143/341/323/324/325/337/33 8/427/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	1. PS Case No. 287/2021, dated 18.04.2021, Burdwan Police Station 2. PS Case No. 368/2019, dated 31.05.2019, Burdwan Police Station 3. PS Case No. 346/2019, dated 24.05.2019, Burdwan Police Station 4. PS Case No. 343/2019, dated 24.05.2019, Burdwan Police Station 5. CR Case No. 581/2016, Burdwan Police Station 6. PS Case No. 585/2012, dated 23.07.2012, G.R. Case No. 57/2023, Burdwan Police Station 7. PS Case No. 729/2010, dated 26.10.2010, Burdwan Police Station 8. PS Case No. 728/2010, dated 26.10.2010, Burdwan Police Station 9. PS Case No. 727/2010, dated 26.10.2010, Burdwan Police Station

	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned C.J.M, PurbaBardhaman 2. Learned C.J.M, PurbaBardhaman 3. Learned C.J.M, PurbaBardhaman 4. Learned C.J.M, PurbaBardhaman 5. Learned 6thJ.M, PurbaBardhaman 6. Learned J.M 3rd Court, PurbaBardhaman 7. Learned C.J.M, PurbaBardhaman 8. Learned C.J.M, PurbaBardhaman 9. Learned C.J.M, PurbaBardhaman
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No 4. No 5. No 6. No 7. No 8. No 9. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is a well-known and veteran public figure with a strong presence in his electorate where he has consistently and untiringly put in efforts for amplifying the voices of underprivileged and marginalized groups. His relatability and dedication to public service make a strong case for his legislative candidacy.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 260- Bardhaman Dakshin Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Khokan Das

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 94- Bagda (SC) Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Madhuparna Thakur

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 341/323/325/509/506/34 Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2. Sections 341/323/509/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3. Sections 341/323/509/379/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	1. P.S. Case No. 670/2023, dated 28.06.2023, Gaighata Police Station, North 24 Parganas. 2. P.S. Case No. 671/2023, dated 28.06.2023, Gaighata Police Station, North 24 Parganas. 3. P.S. Case No. 672/2023, dated 28.06.2023, Gaighata Police Station, North 24 Parganas.
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned A.C.J.M Bangaon, North 24 Parganas. 2. Learned A.C.J.M Bangaon, North 24 Parganas. 3. Learned A.C.J.M Bangaon, North 24 Parganas.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/ No)	1. No 2. No 3. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable

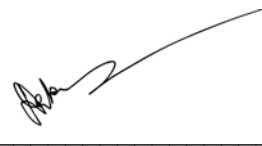
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experiencedgrassroot political worker with strong public engagement. She serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. Her accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make her a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 94 – Bagda (SC) Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Madhuparna Thakur

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7
 (for political parties to publish in the Newspapers,
 social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**

*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**

(1) Name of the Constituency - **138- Canning Paschim (SC)Assembly Constituency**

(2) Name of the candidate – **Paresh Ram Das**

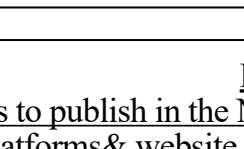
Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 506(ii)/ 34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 2. Sections 147/148/447/427/379/354/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3. Sections 147/148/149/427/326/307/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 4. Sections 147/148/149/427/448/379/506of Indian Penal Code, 1860, and Section 25/27 of Arms Act, 1959. 5. Under Sections 342/365/325/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 and Section 25/27 of Arms Act, 1959 6. Sections 147/148/149/427/379/506/325/308 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 7. Section 384 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 8. Sections147/148/149/447/427/186/353/334/326/307 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 9. Sections 143/341/427/379/323/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	1. Canning PS Case No. 753, dated 18.12.09 2. Canning PS Case No. 659, dated 15.11.09 3. Canning PS Case No. 628, dated 3.11.09 4. Canning PS Case No. 598, dated 23.10.09 5. Canning PS Case No. 593, dated 21.10.09 6. Canning PS Case No. 480, dated 17.08.09 7. Canning PS Case No. 479, dated 17.08.09 8. Canning PS Case No. 477, dated 17.08.09 9. Canning PS Case No. 323, dated 16.06.09
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Alipore District & Session Court 2. Alipore District & Session Court 3. Alipore District & Session Court 4. Alipore District & Session Court 5. Alipore District & Session Court 6. Alipore District & Session Court 7. Alipore District & Session Court 8. Alipore District & Session Court 9. Alipore District & Session Court
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No 4. No 5. No 6. No 7. No 8. No 9. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere "winnability" at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroot-level political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for the underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **138- Canning Paschim (SC) Assembly Constituency**

(4) Name of the candidate: **Paresh Ram Das**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
 Name and Designation



 Derek O'Brien
 Member, National Working Committee,
 All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7
 (for political parties to publish in the Newspapers,
 social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates
 (As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS**
 *Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**
 Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**
 (1) Name of the Constituency - **139-Canning Purba Assembly Constituency**
 (2) Name of the candidate – **Md Baharul Islam**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 342/325/364/307/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2. Sections 341/323/325/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3. Sections 302/341/427 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 4. Sections 324/825/326 of Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1. Case No. 276/2023, Bhangar Police Station. 2. Case No. 509/2022, Bhangar Police Station. 3. Case No. 113/2011, Kashipur Police Station. 4. Case No. 113/2011, Kashipur Police Station.
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned A.C.J.M at Baruipur Court. 2. Learned A.C.J.M at Baruipur Court. 3. Learned A.C.J.M at Baruipur Court. 4. Learned 1st Civil Judge Senior Division at Baruipur Court.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No 4. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere "winnability" at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **139-Canning Purba Assembly Constituency**
 (4) Name of the candidate: **Md Baharul Islam**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
 Name and Designation



 Derek O'Brien
 Member, National Working Committee,
 All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7
(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers,
social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS**

*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**
(1) Name of the Constituency - **199- PursurahAssembly Constituency**
(2) Name of the candidate – **Partha Hazari**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 115(2)/117(2)/3(5)/329(3)/351(2) of BNS 2023. 2. Sections 147/149/341/325/326/307/427/504/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3. Sections 348/323/354/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 4. Sections 302/201/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 5. Sections147/148/149/323/324/427/447/354/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 6. Sections 147/148/149/447/448/379/354/323/324/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 7. Sections 147/148/149/447/448/354/379/323/324/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 8. Sections 147/148/149/323/341/323/325/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 9. Sections 147/148/149/447/323/379/427/354/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 10. Sections 147/148/149/341/427/447/448/323/379/354/506 of Indian Penal Code 1860. 11. Sections 147/148/149/323/506/307 of Indian Penal Code, 1860and Sections 25/27 Arms Act 1959 and Sections 9(b) (ii)/ 9 (e) and Sections 3/4 of Explosive Substances Act, 1908. 12. Sections 147/148/149/323/307/506/ of Indian Penal Code, 1860 and Section 9 (b) of I.E. Act. 13. Sections 147/148/149/447/323/427/379/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 and Sections 3/4 of Explosive Substances Act, 1908. 14. Sections 323/326/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 15. Sections 406/420/323/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 16. Sections 147/148/149/447/323/325/341/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 17. Sections 147/148/149/323/325/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 18. Sections 143/341/323/325/379/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	1. G.R Case No. 374 of 2025 (arising out of FIR case No. 101/2025, dated 27.02.2025,)Arambagh Police Station. 2. G.R Case No. 1493 of 2022 (arising out of FIR case No. 356/2022, dated 12.12.2022,)Arambagh Police Station. 3. G.R Case No. 346 of 2019 (arising out of FIR case No. 122/2019, dated 30.03.2019), Arambagh Police Station 4. C.R Case No. Session Trail 21(7)/2023 Vide G.R. No. 606/2019 (arising out of FIR case No. 221/2019, dated 06.07.2017), Arambagh Police Station 5. G.R Case No. 1353 of 2017 (arising out of FIR case No. 731/2017, dated 28.06.2017), Arambagh Police Station 6. G.R Case No. 1351 of 2017 (arising out of FIR case No. 727/2017, dated 28.06.2017), Arambagh Police Station 7. G.R Case No. 1350 of 2017 (arising out of FIR case No. 726/2017, dated 28.06.2017), Arambagh Police Station 8. G.R Case No. 764 of 2017 (arising out of FIR case No. 399/2017, dated 10.04.2017), Arambagh Police Station 9. G.R Case No. 1352 of 2017 (arising out of FIR case No. 730/2017, dated 28.06.2017, Arambagh Police Station 10. G.R Case No. 754 of 2017 (arising out of FIR case No. 398/2017, dated 10.04.2017, Arambagh Police Station 11. G.R Case No. 1400 of 2017 (arising out of FIR case No. 749/2017, dated 06.07.2017, Arambagh Police Station 12. G.R Case No. 182 of 2017 (arising out of FIR case No. 98/2017, dated 29.01.2017, Arambagh Police Station 13. G.R Case No. 1998 of 2016 (arising out of FIR case No. 1019/2016, dated 26.10.2016, Arambagh Police Station 14. G.R Case No. 1996 of 2016 (arising out of FIR case No. 1020/2016, dated 26.10.2016, Arambagh Police Station 15. G.R Case No. 1476 of 2016 (arising out of FIR case No. 731/2016, dated 09.08.2016, Arambagh Police Station 16. G.R Case No. 213 of 2016 (arising out of FIR case No. 88/2016 dated 27.01.2016, Arambagh Police Station 17. G.R Case No. 332 of 2015 (arising out of FIR case No. 172/2015, dated 11.02.2015, Arambagh Police Station 18. G.R Case No. 1021 of 2011 (arising out of FIR case No. 451/2011, dated 20.08.2011, Arambagh Police Station

	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned A.C.J.M, G.R.O 2. Learned A.C.J.M, G.R.O 3. Learned A.C.J.M, G.R.O 4. Additional District & Session Judge, 1st Court 5. Learned A.C.J.M, G.R.O 6. Learned A.C.J.M, G.R.O 7. Learned A.C.J.M, G.R.O 8. Learned J.M, 2nd Court 9. Learned J.M, 2nd Court 10. Learned J.M.Additional Court. 11. Session Court. 12. Learned A.C.J.M, G.R.O 13. Learned A.C.J.M, G.R.O 14. Learned Judicial Magistrate Additional Court 15. Learned 3rd, JM 16. Learned A.C.J.M, G.R.O 17. Learned J.M, 2nd Court 18. Learned A.C.J.M , G.R.O
	d.	W h e t h e r charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No 4. Yes, on 25.07.2023 5. No 6. No 7. No 8. Yes, on 27.11.2025 9. No 10. No 11. Yes, 22.09.2025 12. No 13. No 14. No 15. No 16. No 17. No 18. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.		The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)	The candidate is an experiencedgrassroot political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.		Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)	Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **199- Pursurah Assembly Constituency**

(4) Name of the candidate: **Partha Hazari**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**

***Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

- (1) Name of the Constituency - **88- Krishnaganj(SC) Assembly Constituency**
(2) Name of the candidate – **Samir Kumar Poddar**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences Alleged Under: Sections 323/325/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	G.R Case No. 6155/23 (Arising out of FIR No. 1021/2021, dated 14.10.2021, Kotwali Police Station, Krishnanagar).
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned A.C.J.M Court, Krishnanagar
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experiencedgrassroot political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

- (3) Name of the Constituency – **88- Krishnaganj(SC) Assembly Constituency**

- (4) Name of the candidate: **Samir Kumar Poddar**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



Derek O'Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**

***Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**

- (1) Name of the Constituency - **263- Monteswar Assembly Constituency**
(2) Name of the candidate – **Siddiquillah Chowdhury**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: Section 341 of Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	GRN No. 1428 of 2007 (arising out of FIR Case No. 229/2001, Burrabazar Police Station.
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned 14 th M.M., Bankshall Court
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**

***Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

- (1) Name of the Constituency - **267-Bhatar Assembly Constituency**
(2) Name of the candidate – **Shantanu Koner**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 147/148/145/323/324/325/326/307of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2.Sections 341/342/365/325/379/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	1.PS Case No. 83/2010, dated 15.06.2010, Bhatar Police Station. 2.PS Case No. 253/2012, dated 30.11.2012, Bhatar Police Station
	c.	Name of the Court	1.Learned C.J.M, PurbaBardhaman 2.Learned C.J.M, PurbaBardhaman
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experiencedgrassroot level political worker with strong public engagement who has great empathy for the people of his electorate. He serves as a voice for the underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

- (3) Name of the Constituency – **267-Bhatar Assembly Constituency**

- (4) Name of the candidate: **Shantanu Koner**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party _____
Name and Designation _____



Derek O'Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)	The candidate has been selected on the basis of his public engagement, transparency, and commitment towards society. He has duly disclosed all assets, liabilities, and pending cases in accordance with law, reflecting accountability and adherence to statutory requirements. The candidate is actively involved in social work and has consistently contributed towards the welfare and development of the community. His background indicates sustained public interaction and service-oriented activities. The selection has been made on the basis of merit, integrity, and public service orientation, and not merely on electoral winnability.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)	Same as above.

- (3) Name of the Constituency – **263- Monteswar Assembly Constituency**

- (4) Name of the candidate: **Siddiqullah Chowdhury**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



Derek O'Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers,
social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 154-Behala Paschim (General) Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Ratna Chatterjee

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 427/323/506/114 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 2.Sections 143/147/149/283/341/506/188 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 3.Sections 448/506/114 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 4.Sections 506/406 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 5.Sections 120B/448/504/506/379 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 6. Sections 126(2)/324(4)/303(2)/54 of Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 r/w Section 123(2) of the Representation of the People Act 1951
	b.	Case no.	1.ACGR Case No. 849/21, FRT No. 43/21 dated 23.08.2021 (arising out of FIR Case No. 61/21, dated 01.03.2021, Parnasree Police Station) 2.CGR Case No. 2224/18, FRT No. 38/21 dated 03.08.2021 (arising out of FIR Case No. 83/18, dated 25.05.2018, Rabindra Sarobar Police Station) 3.ACGR. 845/18 (arising out of FIR Case No. 50/18, dated 20.02.2018, Parnasree Police Station) 4.ACGR Case No. 827/18 (arising out of FIR Case No. 48/18, dated 19.02.2018, Parnasree Police Station) 5.ACGR No. 5660/17 (arising out of FIR Case No. 256/2017, dated 07.11.2017, Parnasree Police Station) 6.FIR Case No. 166/2026, dated 05.04.2026, Parnasree Police Station
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned A.C.J.M at Alipore 2. Learned C.J.M at Alipore 3. Learned A.C.J.M at Alipore 4. Learned A.C.J.M at Alipore 5. Learned A.C.J.M at Alipore 6. Not Known
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No 4. No 5. No 6. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. She serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. Her accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make her a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 154-Behala Paschim (General) Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Ratna Chatterjee

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O'Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers,
social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 176 – UluberiaPurba Assembly Constituency

Name of the candidate – Ritabrata Banerjee

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 195A/214/506/120B/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2.Sections 417/376 (2) (a)/214/354/506/509 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3.Sections 186/353/147/149/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1.G.R. Case No. 1281/2017, arising out of FIR No. 458/2017, dated 7.11.2017, Balurghat Police Station, South Dinajpur. 2.G.R. Case No. 1205/2017, arising out of FIR No. 422/2017, dated 10.10.2017, Balurghat Police Station, South Dinajpur. 3.Criminal Case No. 4/2024, arising out of FIR No. 57/2013, dated 09.04.2013, Parliament Street Police Station, New Delhi.
	c.	Name of the Court	1.Learned Chief Judicial Magistrate, Balurghat. 2.Learned Chief Judicial Magistrate, Balurghat. 3.Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Rouse Avenue, Delhi.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced-grassroot political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(2) Name of the Constituency – 176 – UluberiaPurba Assembly Constituency

(3) Name of the candidate: Ritabrata Banerjee

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O'Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers,
social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE
LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 266- BurdwanUttar (SC) Assembly
Constituency

Name of the candidate – Nisith Kumar Malik

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	1.Sections 147/148/149/448/379/427/436 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2.Sections 341/323/325/379/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3.Sections 147/148/149/323/324/325/326 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1.P.S. Case No. 599 of 2014, dated 27.04.2014, bearing C.S. No. 776/2014, Burdwan Police Station. 2.P.S. Case No. 657/2013, dated, 03/06/2013, bearing C.S. No. 657 of 2013. 3.P.S. Case No. 704/2011, dated 25.09.2011, bearing C.S. No – 704/2011.
	c.	Name of the Court	1.Learned Chief Judicial Magistrate, Burdwan. 2. Learned Chief Judicial Magistrate, Burdwan. 3.Learned Chief Judicial Magistrate, Burdwan.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroot level political worker with strong public engagement who has great empathy for the people of his electorate. He serves as a voice for the underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(2) Name of the Constituency – 266- BurdwanUttar (SC) Assembly Constituency

(3) Name of the candidate: Nisith Kumar Malik

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers,
social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE
LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 265- Memari Assembly Constituency
(2) Name of the candidate – Rash Bihari Halder

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 341/323/325/435/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2.Sections 341/323/325/307/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1.G.R. Case No. 839/2018, (Arising out of FIR No. 206/2018, Dated -24.03.2018, Burdwan Sadar Police Station). 2.G.R Case No. 968/2019, (arising out of FIR No. 182/2019, dated – 19.03.2019, Burdwan Sadar Police Station).
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned 6 th J.M, PurbaBardhaman 2. Learned 5 th J.M, PurbaBardhaman
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate has been selected on the basis of his public engagement, transparency, and commitment towards society. He has duly disclosed all assets, liabilities,andpendingcasesinaccordance with law, reflecting accountability and adherence to statutory requirements. The candidate is actively involved in social work and has consistently contributed towards the welfare and development of the community. His background indicates sustained public interaction and service-oriented activities. The selection has been made on the basis of merit, integrity, and public service orientation, and not merely on electoral winnability.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 265- Memari Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Rash Bihari Halder

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**
*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**
Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**
(1) Name of the Constituency - **179-Shyampur Assembly Constituency**
(2) Name of the candidate – **Nadebasi Jana**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Section 23A of West Bengal Panchayat Act 2.Section23A of West Bengal Panchayat Act
	b.	Case no.	1.NGR No 547/2016 (arising in connection to NCRNo. 236/16, dated 03.04.16 at Shyampur Police Station). 2.NGR No. 549/2016 (arising in connection to NCR No. 210/16, dated 28.03.16 at Shyampur Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned J.M 1 st Court,atUluberia, Howrah 2. Learned J.M 1 st Court, at Uluberia, Howrah
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No2. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **179-Shyampur Assembly Constituency**
(4) Name of the candidate: **Nadebasi Jana**
* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**
*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**
Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**
(1) Name of the Constituency - **259- Khandaghosh (SC)Assembly Constituency**
(2) Name of the candidate – **Nabin Chandra Bag**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: Sections 341/323/506/34of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	G.R. Case No. 1137 of 2014 (arising out of FIR No. 73/2014, dated 06.04.2014 at Khandaghosh Police Station
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned 5 th J.M, PurbaBardhaman
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is a well-known and veteran public figure with a strong presence in his electorate where he has consistently and untiringly put in efforts for amplifying the voices of underprivileged and marginalized groups. His relatability and dedication to public service make a strong case for his legislative candidacy.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **259- Khandaghosh (SC)Assembly Constituency**
(4) Name of the candidate: **Nabin Chandra Bag**
* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**
*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**
Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**
(1) Name of the Constituency - **102 – Amdanga Assembly Constituency**
(2) Name of the candidate – **Mohammad Kasem Siddique**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under Sections 147/148/149/323/332/333/186/353/504/506/189/120B of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	G.R. Case No. 2011/2023, arising out of P.S. CaseNo. 270/2023, Jangipara Police Station, Hooghly.
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Srerampore.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable

(3) Name of the Constituency – **102 – Amdanga Assembly Constituency**
(4) Name of the candidate: **Mohammad Kasem Siddique**

	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experiencedgrassroot political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **102 – Amdanga Assembly Constituency**
(4) Name of the candidate: **Mohammad Kasem Siddique**
* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress